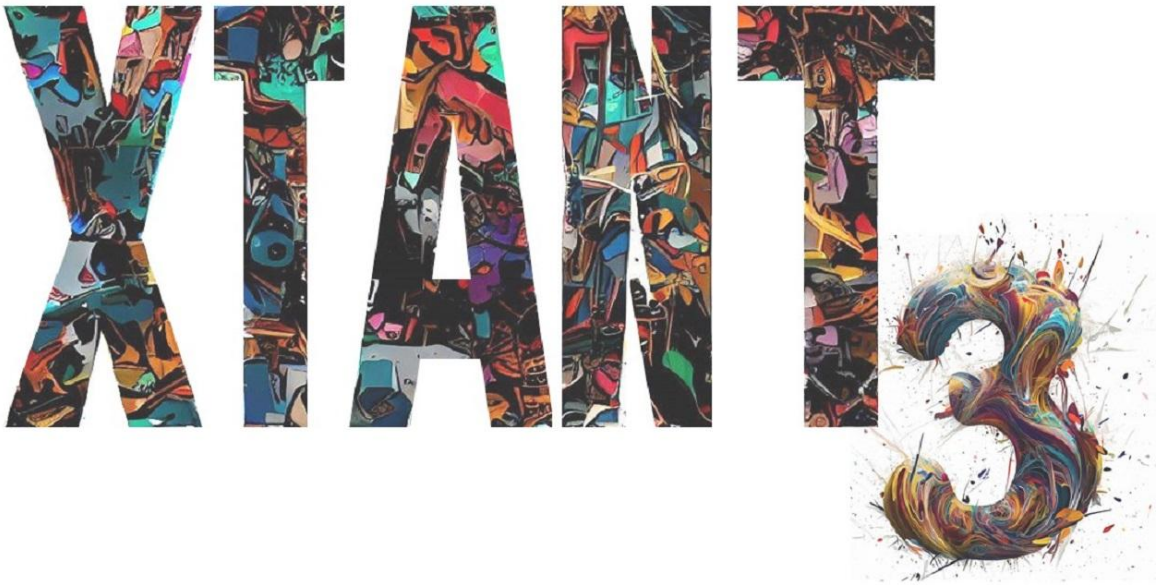


XTANT-3: X-ray-induced Thermal And Nonthermal Transitions in Matter

theory, numerical details, user manual

Current version: XTANT-3 update: 24.10.2026

Nikita Medvedev[1]

This is the user manual for the hybrid code XTANT-3, simulating intense femtosecond X-ray irradiation of matter. The code combines a few models into one with feedbacks: transport Monte Carlo simulation, Boltzmann collision integrals, and tight binding molecular dynamics. Such a combination allows the simulation of nonequilibrium, nonadiabatic, and nonthermal effects in electronically excited matter, and the synergy and interplay of these effects. This text contains a description of the theoretical basis of the model and the practical user manual. The detailed description should allow new users, students, and non-specialists to access the ideas behind the code and make the learning curve less steep.

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https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

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Although we endeavour to ensure that the code XTANT-3 and the results delivered are correct, no warranty is given as to its accuracy. We assume no responsibility for possible errors or omissions. We shall not be liable for any damage arising from the use of this code or its parts or any results produced with it, or from any action or decision taken as a result of using this code or any related material.

This code is distributed at DOI: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.8392569 (up-to-date version: https://github.com/N-Medvedev/XTANT-3) *as is* for non-commercial peaceful purposes only, such as research and education. It is explicitly **prohibited** to use the code, its parts, its results, or any related material for military-related and other than peaceful purposes, in addition to the terms specified in GPL-3.0 license agreement.

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N. Medvedev "*XTANT-3: X-ray-induced Thermal And Nonthermal Transitions in Matter: theory, numerical details, user manual*" (2023) https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

And the code XTANT-3 may be cited as:

N. Medvedev (2023). XTANT-3 (XTANT-3-v24.10.2026) https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.8392569

The journal citation that may be used is:

N. Medvedev, V. Tkachenko, V. Lipp, Z. Li, B. Ziaja, "Various damage mechanisms in carbon and silicon materials under femtosecond x-ray irradiation", 4open. 1 (2018) 3. https://doi.org/10.1051/fopen/2018003

Should you use electron-phonon coupling in the calculations, the following citation should be included in addition to the abovementioned one:

N. Medvedev, I. Milov, "Electron-phonon coupling in metals at high electronic temperatures", Phys. Rev. B. 102 (2020) 064302. https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevB.102.064302

In a publication, I recommend that at least the following parameters should be mentioned for the reproducibility of the results:

Material, its initial structure, the number of atoms in the supercell, the initial conditions (atomic and electronic temperatures), an ensemble used, a type of boundary conditions, a type of cross sections in Monte Carlo simulation, a type of tight binding parameterization, whether the electron emission was included or not and if yes, whether Coulomb potential for atoms was accounted for and what model for electron emission was used, whether an additional short-range repulsive potential was used, the time step of MD simulation, parameters of the incoming laser pulse (its photon energy, deposited dose, duration).

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Most of these parameters can be found in an output file !OUTPUT_[*Material*]_Parameters.txt described below.

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Acknowledgements

This code would not exist (certainly not in the way it does now) without help of many colleagues, contributing with discussions and helpful comments. First of all, I thank B. Ziaja for valuable contribution to the general philosophy of the code and discussions on the results and various applications, which helped to develop the appropriate models in the code, in particular on the usage of the tight-binding (TB) molecular dynamics (MD) method; H. Jeschke for helpful discussions on the TBMD method; B. Rethfeld for sharing her experience on Boltzmann collision integrals, together with O. Osmani for prior collaborative works on combining MC method with other approaches; Z. Li for joint work on the nonadiabatic coupling, optical coefficients evaluation (RPA implementation in TB), and correlation analysis in MD; O. Vendrell and R. Santra for discussions on Born-Oppenheimer approximation and nonadiabatic effects; V. Tkachenko for contributions into development of the RPA module and help in debugging the code; V. Lipp for discussions on debugging the code; A.E. Volkov for discussions on the Monte Carlo (MC) part, electron-ion coupling and scattering theory, and on the multiscale approaches and applications in general; Z. Jurek for discussions and comments on programming; M. Stransky for help with making the code compilable with gfortran and discussion on diffraction analysis; A. Artimez-Pena for discussions on code's features development and applications.

The XTANT-3 logo was created with help of Bing Image Creator (powered by DALL-E).

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

PART I: Theory

I. Introduction

This document is specifically on the code XTANT-3[2] [1–3] and its features, many of which are unique to this code. Note that XTANT-3 is a separate development from XTANT+ [4], the two codes should not be confused. Although both grew out of the original XTANT code [5], years of independent development since then resulted in many differences in their philosophy, global structure, models used, and functionality (a reader interested in XTANT+ may consult its developers[3]). Problems faced in the combined code development resulted in many innovative technical solutions that had to be invented and which were not described elsewhere. The most important ones are presented here in detail with the hope that they might be useful not only to the users of XTANT-3 but also to other code developers facing similar issues. As multiscale codes are gaining popularity in recent years [6], I believe solutions specific to this class of methods may be valuable.

I.1. Ultrafast irradiation problem

Ultrafast laser irradiation of materials plays an important role in both, fundamental and applied sciences [7–11]. Understanding of basic phenomena in the physics of solids, nonequilibrium kinetics, and highly excited states of matter, benefits from experiments accessing the natural time window of the involved processes (femtosecond timescales) such as electron kinetics, electron-ion (electron-phonon) coupling, and atomic response [11–13]. Laser irradiation experiments are vital for materials processing, nano and micro technology, and medical applications such as laser surgery [10,11,14,15]. In turn, the interpretation of experimental results requires detailed theoretical and model descriptions of the processes involved.

Those processes span multiple timescales, starting from attoseconds of the photon absorption from the incoming pulse to femtoseconds for electronic and holes kinetics, to picoseconds of the atomic/ionic response [6,16]. In photoabsorption, for photon energies above the bandgap, energy is delivered primarily to electrons of the matter [17]. The photoelectrons are excited to higher energy states, which drives the electronic ensemble out of equilibrium [17,18]. The electrons then scatter among themselves in the conduction band of material, with electrons from the valence band and deeper shell (for those shells whose ionization potential is below the electron energy), or elastically with the atoms of the target (also known as the electron-phonon scattering). Electron-electron scattering thermalizes the electronic ensemble towards equilibrium Fermi-Dirac distribution, whereas electron-atom scattering exchanges energy between the two systems, heating the lattice. Typical electronic thermalization in metals takes place at femtosecond timescales [7,19], while equilibration between the electronic and atomic temperatures may take up to tens of picoseconds [3,7].

Another important effect is, since the electrons form the interatomic potential of the material, the excitation of electrons modifies the potential energy surface [2,7,20]. Atoms, in their former equilibrium positions, now experience new forces, which may drive them into a different material phase – the processes known as nonthermal phase transitions, the most famous example of which is nonthermal melting in covalently bonded solids [21,22]. Furthermore, in the time window when the electronic

[2] https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.8392569 ; https://github.com/N-Medvedev/XTANT-3
[3] https://xm.cfel.de/research/scientific_software/xtant_amp_xtant/

temperature (or, more generally, parameters of the nonequilibrium electronic distribution) is different from the atomic one, this so-called two-temperature state departs from the equilibrium material phase diagram and may create states inaccessible under equilibrium conditions [23,24].

The variety of processes, taking place after ultrafast irradiation, may create synergy leading to nonlinear behavior [25]. For example, the nonthermal phase transitions were studied [26–28], in a few cases with nonadiabatic coupling included [2,29]. Effects of the electronic nonequilibrium were also analyzed separately [7,19,30,31]. The mutual effect of the electronic nonequilibrium and the electron-phonon coupling has also been demonstrated [32,33]. A combined effect of the interplay of the electronic nonequilibrium, nonadiabatic coupling, and nonthermal effects, was studied in Ref.[34] using XTANT-3 code.

The interplay of all these effects needs to be modeled in a unified framework – this is the main point of the XTANT-3 code. It combines on-the-fly a few appropriate models to address these most important effects taking place in the matter under ultrafast irradiation.

I.2. Multiscale (hybrid, combined) simulation methods

To model the abovementioned effects, the concept of multiscale (or hybrid, or combined) modeling is employed in XTANT-3 (here, we use these terms interchangeably, although one may say that, in general, 'hybrid' and 'combined' approaches are more general terms than the 'multiscale') [6]. The philosophy of this type of approach is to combine a few models into one interconnected, executed together, and exchange the data on the fly. This can be achieved best in the case when the parameter space is separable: e.g., different processes take place at different timescales (models divisible in time [35,36]), particles of notably different masses are involved (models divisible by mass, such as quantum-classical combinations [37], or atomistic-continuum ones [38]), difference in the momentum space (separating close and distant collisions [39]), etc.

XTANT-3 combines four major models (and a countless number of minor ones) under one umbrella, as described below.

I.3. XTANT-3 concept outline

XTANT-3 combines the following models to trace the essential effects in both, the electronic and the atomic systems of the target [1]:

(i) The electrons with energy above a certain chosen energy cutoff are modeled with the Monte Carlo (MC) simulation.
(ii) The fractional populations of low-energy electrons on the valence and conduction band energy levels are traced with the Boltzmann equation (BE).
(iii) The interatomic forces are calculated from the transferable tight-binding (TB) formalism, which also traces the evolution of the electronic energy levels (molecular orbitals).
(iv) The motion of atoms is traced with help of the molecular dynamics (MD). Below, we will discuss the relevant details of each model, and their interconnection on-the-fly, enabling to model laser irradiation of matter.

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

The interconnection of these models is schematically shown in **Figure I.1** [40]. On top of that, there are a few models used for data analysis on-the-fly (as well as in post-processing), and minor models used within each of these general modules. Below we describe each model in detail.

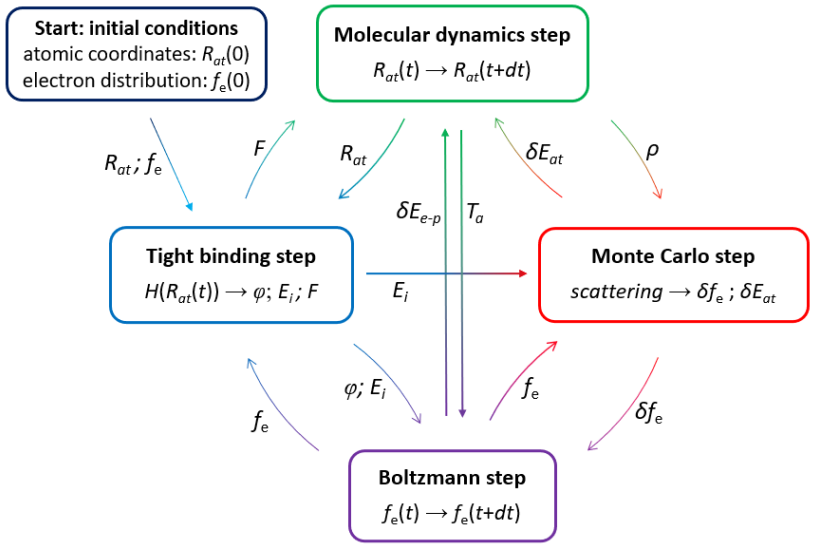


Figure I.1. Schematics of the XTANT-3 algorithms, interconnecting the main modules of the program. The initial conditions specify the coordinates of all the atoms in the simulation box $R_{at}(t=0)$ and electronic distribution function f_e. The molecular dynamics (MD) module propagates the atomic coordinates, using the forces, F, calculated with the help of the tight-binding (TB) module. It also uses the electron transfer from the electronic system, calculated in two steps: elastic scattering of a high-energy fraction of electrons within the Monte Carlo (MC) step, δE_{at}, and electron-ion (electron-phonon) coupling of low-energy electrons calculated with the Boltzmann equation (BE), $\delta E_{el\text{-}phon}$. TB also provides the BE module with the transient electronic energy levels (eigenstates of the Hamiltonian), E_i, and wave functions (eigenfunctions) φ. E_i are also used in MC. MC calculates the source terms for BE associated with the photoabsorption, Auger decays, and electronic scattering: δf_e. MD step supplies the BE with the atomic temperature Ta, and the MC with the transient material density ρ (if the supercell size is allowed to change in the simulation). Figure reproduced from Ref. [40].

II. Transport Monte Carlo simulation

II.1. Basic concepts

A method that uses (pseudo-)random numbers belongs to the class of Monte Carlo (MC) methods [6]. Generally, in an MC method, any probability appearing in the governing equations may be replaced with a sampled random number uniform in the interval [0,1). If the same procedure is repeated multiple times, the averaged results would reproduce a statistically significant distribution of the desired quantity [39].

For the problem of fast particle transport in the matter, the MC method is used to sample probabilities of scattering [39,41–43]. It involves a few random numbers to sample various effects and processes. Although we denote all the random numbers in this book with the same symbol γ (always uniformly distributed in the interval [0,1)), each time a different number is assumed, sampled with a random number generator. XTANT-3 uses standard FORTRAN random number generator. Even though there exist random number generators with proven randomness (e.g., [44]), since many different values are sampled in XTANT-3, possible artificial correlations introduced by the pseudo-randomness of the standard generators do not play a role here.

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

The following values are sampled randomly in XTANT-3: free flight distance of a mobile particle (photon, fast electron) or decay time of a core hole, type of scattering event (inelastic vs. elastic), the transferred energy in a scattering event, scattering partner in a collision. An MC schematic algorithm can be found, e.g., in Chapters 7 and 15 of Ref. [6].

The free flight time, used to calculate the time of the next scattering event of a particle, is evaluated from its free flight distance, λ, and particle velocity, v:

$$\mathrm{t} = \lambda / v, \tag{1}$$

where the free flight distance of a particle is sampled from the Poisson distribution (which assumes uniform homogeneous media for the target) [39,42,43]:

$$\lambda = -\lambda_0 \ln(\gamma), \tag{2}$$

where the mean free path – the distance a particle travels between successive collisions, λ_0, – is defined via the total cross-section of scattering, σ:

$$\lambda^{-1} = \sigma n_{at} = n_{at} \int_{W_-}^{W_+} \int_{Q_-}^{Q_+} \frac{d^2\sigma}{dW dQ} dW dQ, \tag{3}$$

here n_{at} is the density of target atoms; $W_\pm$ are the minimal and maximal transferred energy ($W = \hbar\omega$); the recoil energy Q is defined by the transferred momentum in a collision as $Q(1 + Q/2m_t c^2) = \hbar^2 q^2/(2m_t)$ (in the nonrelativistic limit $Q = \hbar^2 q^2/(2m_t)$, with $\hbar q$ being the transferred momentum and m_t being the scattering center (atom) mass). For the non-relativistic incident particle energy ($E \ll min(m_{in}, m_t)c^2$), the limits of the transferred momentum are [16,45]:

$$Q_\pm = \frac{m_{in}}{m_t}\left(\sqrt{E} \pm \sqrt{E - W}\right)^2, \tag{4}$$

with m_{in} being the mass of the incident particle (e.g., an electron, $m_{in} = m_e$ free-electron rest mass). The lower limit of the transferred energy (W_-) and the upper limit (W_+) for scattering on a particle (a target atom or an electron) are defined by the following formulae:

$$\begin{cases} W_- = I_p \\ W_+ = \dfrac{4 m_{in} m_t}{(m_{in} + m_t)^2} E \end{cases}, \tag{5}$$

where I_p is the ionization potential of the atomic shell an electron is being ionized from. The upper limit is written here for a free particle. For scattering on a bound particle with a given ionization potential, the expressions are more complicated, see Ref. [46], but the free-particle approximation works very well for $W_+ >> I_p$. In the case of ionization from the valence band $I_p = E_{gap}$. Here, E_{gap} is the material band gap, which is equal to zero in the case of metals. For the relativistic ones, the reader may refer, e.g., to Refs. [16,39].

An *event-by-event* (or analog) MC simulation traces each scattering event in detail, which is sufficient for tracing material response [47]. Transferred energy in a scattering act is sampled according to the following expression:

$$\gamma\sigma = \int_{W_-}^{W} \int_{Q_-}^{Q_+} \frac{d^2\sigma}{dW dQ} dW dQ, \tag{6}$$

here $\gamma \in [0,1)$ is another random number; Eq.(6) must be solved for the transferred energy W. In some cases, the differential equation allows for analytical integration and a closed solution for W [39,46]. In general, a numerical solution is required [48], or further approximations to the electron spectrum should be employed [39].

In the first-order Born approximation (linear response), the cross-section of scattering may be represented as a cross-section of scattering on the individual scattering center (Coulombic) and the factor responsible for the collective dynamics of the target particles [16,49]. It then may be represented in terms of the thermal factor and the inverse of the complex dielectric function (CDF, $\varepsilon(\omega, q)$) [16,49]:

$$\frac{d^2\sigma}{d(\hbar\omega)d(\hbar q)} = \frac{2(Z_e e)^2}{n_{at}\pi\hbar^2 v^2}\frac{1}{\hbar q}\left(1 - e^{-\frac{\hbar\omega}{k_B T}}\right)^{-1} \mathrm{Im}\left[\frac{-1}{\varepsilon(\omega, q)}\right] \qquad (7)$$

where e is the electron charge; $\hbar\omega$ is the transferred energy and $\hbar$ is Planck's constant; k_B is the Boltzmann constant, and T is the temperature of the sample; Z_e is the effective charge of the projectile penetrating through a solid (for an incident electron $Z_e = 1$); the particle velocity, v, and a transferred momentum, q. Relativistic cross sections may be found, e.g., in Refs. [16,39,49].

In XTANT-3, the following convention is used: n_{sc} is the atomic density for scattering on core electrons and is equal to the molecular density for the valence (or conduction) band electrons.

II.2. Photons

Photons in XTANT-3 experience only one type of interaction: absorption by target electrons in the linear regime (single-photon absorption). This limits the applicability of the code to the photon energies above the band gap of the material (since no multiphoton absorption via virtual levels is not included; note also that it limits the laser intensity at low photon energy to exclude non-linear effects). At high photon energy, it is limited by another approximation for decays of core holes (see below) by the energy of ~30 keV.

The number of photons per pulse is estimated from the user-given absorbed dose. The temporal profile of the pulse may be chosen as one of three options: (i) Gaussian pulse; (ii) flat-top pulse; (iii) spiky pulse mimicking SASE operation of free-electron lasers [50].

A photon, arriving at the supercell at a time sampled according to the chosen pulse profile, will be absorbed by an electron from the shell N_{sh}, chosen randomly according to the partial photoabsorption cross-sections for different atomic shells of all elements of the target from the condition:

$$\gamma = \sum_{i}^{N_{sh}} \sigma_i \Big/ \sigma_{tot} \qquad (8)$$

where the total cross-section of photon absorption is summed over all shells of all elements: $\sigma_{tot} = \sum_i^{N_{all}} \sigma_i$. The cross sections are taken from the EPICS database[4] (unless CDF-function is provided by the user, see below, in which case the CDF-base cross section is used instead of the atomic ones from this database [48]).

An electron is emitted with the kinetic energy $E_e = \hbar\omega - I_p$ (photon energy of $\hbar\omega$, the ionization potential of the chosen shell I_p). A hole in the corresponding shell is created, unless the absorbing shell

[4] https://www-nds.iaea.org/epics/

is the valence/conduction band of the material (in which case its particular energy level is sampled according to the transient electron distribution function traced within the Boltzmann equation as described in Section III), and its decay time is sampled, see below.

II.3. High-energy electrons

Electrons, excited by photons (as well as by impact-ionization by fast electrons or *via* Auger-decays of core holes) to the energy states above a chosen cutoff, E_{cut}, then may experience two kinds of scattering events: elastic (in which the total kinetic energy is conserved between the incident particle and the scattering center – meaning, no ionization), and inelastic (in which the kinetic energy is not conserved – a part of the energy is spent to ionization; an impact ionization event). Additionally, if allowed by the user, an electron may be emitted from the target and lost from the MC simulation.

II.3.a. Inelastic scattering (impact ionization)

Inelastic scattering (impact ionization) is described by one of the two possible cross-sections: CDF-based or binary-encounter Bethe (BEB) atomic cross-section (if CDF is not available). The CDF function (entering Eq.((7)) is approximated with the set of artificial oscillators according to the Ritchie-Howie formalism [45,51]:

$$Im\left(\frac{-1}{\varepsilon(\omega,0)}\right) \approx \sum_i \frac{A_i \gamma_i \hbar\omega_i}{((\hbar\omega_i)^2 - E_i^2)^2 + (\gamma_i \hbar\omega_i)^2} \tag{9}$$

This simple analytical representation depends on a set of parameters (A_i, E_i, γ_i) determined from the fitting procedure of the optical data [52]. The parameters represent the amplitude A_i, the position E_i, and the width γ_i of the ith oscillator, and may be interpreted as intensity, energy, and an inverse lifetime of collective excitation (plasmon or phonon) associated with the peaks [16]. CDF parameters may be reconstructed from the optical coefficients, as described in detail, e.g., in Refs. [16,45,52]. Many materials' CDF-files may be found in TREKIS-3 code[5]; alternatively, a single-pole approximation may be used for a rough estimation of the CDF coefficients [53]. The position of the oscillator may be chosen according to the position of a collective mode of the particles oscillations (the plasmon mode for inelastic scattering on the valence/conduction band electronic system; ionization potential for core shells):

$$\begin{gathered} E_{0_{sp}} = \hbar\Omega_p \\ \gamma_{sp} = E_{0_{sp}} \\ A_{sp} = (\hbar\Omega_p)^2 / \int_0^\infty W Im\left(\frac{-1}{\varepsilon(W, Q=0, A=1)}\right)_D dW \end{gathered} \tag{10}$$

Here, $\Omega_P^2 = 4\pi e^2 n_e / m_e$, the plasmon frequency, with n_e being the valence/conduction band electron density (or core-shell electron density). The A_{sp}, the normalization coefficient, is defined by the k-sum rule [53].

For materials, for which CDF coefficients are unavailable, as an alternative to the single-pole CDF approximation, the cross-sections of scattering on an independent atom (instead of a solid) may be used. XTANT-3 allows using of BEB cross-sections of impact ionization [54]:

[5] https://github.com/N-Medvedev/TREKIS-3

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

$$\frac{d\sigma}{dw} = S\sum_{n=1}^{3} F_n\left(\frac{1}{(1+w)^n} + \frac{1}{(K-w)^n}\right),$$
$$F_1 = -\frac{F_2}{K+1}, F_2 = \frac{1}{K+u+1}, F_3 = \frac{\ln(K)}{K+u+1}, \quad (11)$$
$$S = 4\pi a_0^2 N\left(\frac{Ry}{I_p}\right)^2;$$
$$\sigma = \frac{S}{K+u+1}\left[\frac{\ln(K)}{2}(1-K^{-2}) + (1-K^{-1}) - \frac{\ln(K)}{K+1}\right].$$

Here $w = dE/I_p$ is the energy transferred to the electron being ionized in this collision; I_p is the ionization potential of the shell being ionized; $u = U/I_p$ is the normalized mean kinetic energy of the shell from which the electron is ejected; $K = E_e/I_p$ is the kinetic energy of the incident electron normalized to the binding energy of the shell it is scattering on; N is the number of electrons in the corresponding shell, a_0=0.53 Å is the Bohr radius, and Ry=13.6 eV is the Rydberg constant.

Ionization potential and shell-kinetic energies used are taken from the EPICS database [55]. Note that in the case of BEB cross sections, atomic ionization potentials are used for the valence shells (instead of the bandgap of the material), since the parameters of the BEB cross sections were fitted to the atomic data. This may lead to certain problems in the mismatch of the parameters; these problems and solutions used in XTANT-3 will be discussed below in Section II.6.

The electron's energy is then updated, and the next collision is then sampled for this kinetic energy. The sampled energy lost by the incident electron is then transferred to a new electron, and a new hole is created (either in a core-shell or in the valence/conduction band). The new electron's next collision is sampled in the same manner as the primary electron.

If the electron loses energy below the predefined cutoff, it is eliminated from the MC simulation, and its energy is stored for further formation of the source term for the Boltzmann equation, see below. If the hole is created in the valence/conduction band, its energy level is then also used to form the source-term for BE.

II.3.b. Elastic scattering

At the relativistic energies, the cross-section of elastic (nuclear) scattering, and the corresponding energy loss, can be obtained, e.g., from the Mott or Wentzel-Moliere screened scattering cross sections [56–58]:

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}\sigma}{d\Omega} = \left(\frac{Z_t e^2}{p_e v_e}\right)^2 \frac{1}{(2\eta + 1 - \cos(\theta))^2}, \quad (12)$$

here Ω is the solid angle, p_e is the incident electron momentum and v_e is its velocity, θ is the scattering angle, and η is a screening parameter [42]. The screening parameter is used in the modified Moliere form [42]:

$$\eta = 1.7\times10^{-5} Z_t^{2/3}\left(\frac{1-\beta^2}{\beta^2}\right)\times\left(1.13 + 3.76\left(\frac{\alpha Z_t}{\beta}\right)^2\sqrt{\frac{E_e}{E_e + m_e c^2}}\right), \quad (13)$$

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Where c is the speed of light in vacuum, m_e is the free electron mass, $\beta^2 = 2E_e/m_e c^2$, and $\alpha = 1/137$ is the fine structure constant.

The corresponding total cross-section used to calculate the elastic mean free path (Eq.(3)) is then:

$$\sigma = \pi a_0^2 \frac{Z_t(Z_t+1)}{\eta(\eta+1)}\left(\frac{Ry}{E_e}\right)^2, \tag{14}$$

Where E_e is the incident electron energy, a_0=0.53 Å is the Bohr radius, and Ry=13.6 eV is the Rydberg constant (used for normalization of energy here).

The scattering angle can be sampled according to the differential and total cross sections (Eqs. (12)-(14)) as:

$$\cos(\theta) = \frac{\gamma(2\eta+1)-\eta}{\eta+\gamma}, \tag{15}$$

Transferred energy in a collision (connected to the recoil angle θ_r *via* $dE = \frac{4m_{in}m_t}{(m_{in}+m_t)^2}E_e\cos^2(\theta_r)$, where M_{at} is the mass of a target atom) can be then calculated from the energy and momentum conservation laws [16,39].

The electron loses the defined amount of energy in the collision. Its next time of collision is then calculated for the updated energy. The energy loss dE is stored, to be later averaged over MC iterations and delivered to atoms, see Section V.5.

If the electron loses energy below the predefined cutoff, it is eliminated from the MC simulation, and its energy is stored for further formation of the source term for the Boltzmann equation, see below.

II.4. Core holes

Considering the typical parameters XTANT-3 was developed for, the Auger of Koster-Kronig) decay is the dominant process of core-shell decay (not too high photon energies produce not too deep holes, for which radiative decays would be dominant). Thus, all decay in MC models is characterized by the atomic Auger (or Koster-Kronig) times [39,55,59–61]. In the MC simulation, the decay time is sampled with the exponential (Poisson) distribution:

$$t = -t_0 \ln(\gamma), \tag{16}$$

where t_0 is the characteristic Auger-decay time, which is taken from the EPICS database [53].

In such a case, the hole jumps into the closest higher shell. The energy release in such a transition is approximated as the difference between the ionization potentials of these shells involved. In the XTANT-3 algorithm, it is assumed that this energy is released as a (virtual) photon, which is then instantly absorbed by one of the atoms. Thus, the shell, absorbing this "photon" is sampled according to the photoabsorption cross-section – such a simulation allows for an interatomic Auger (Knotek-Feibelman) decay [62] since the "absorbing" shell may belong to a different element of a compound target. Its absorption then creates a free electron – the Auger electron – and the second holes, thereby completing the Auger decay.

The new excited electron then undergoes the same sampling procedure as a photo-electron, as well as both newly created holes.

If a hole is produced in the valence/conduction band, the hole is excided from the MC simulations. The level in which this hole appeared (sampled according to the transient electron distribution function defining populations on the transient valence energy levels) and its corresponding energy is then recorded to form the source term for the Boltzmann equation, as described below.

II.5. Electron emission

In simulations where electrons may be emitted from the surface of the material (such as thin layers, nano samples, near-surface regions), this process must be taken into account. It leads to a few effects to consider.

Two simplistic conditions for electron emission are available in XTANT-3 (set by the user):

i) Emission after a given number of collisions

ii) Emission of all electrons with energy above a defined threshold (e.g., work function)

When one of these conditions (chosen by the user) is satisfied, an electron is eliminated from the MC simulation, and its energy is essentially lost (tracked only for energy balance check, but no processes involving this electron are performed). The number of lost electrons is traced to account for the accumulation of the positive charge to be added to the Coulomb potential of atoms traced in MD, see Section V.4.

II.6. Exceptions, patches, numerical tricks

If the cutoff energy used is larger than the width of the conduction band of the material (which may be the case of small tight-binding bases in certain parameterizations, see details in Section IV), an electron falling below the cutoff may appear above the highest available conduction band level ($E_{CB} < E < E_{cutoff}$) and will not find the level to merge in the Boltzmann equation (see the next section). Such cases must be excluded from simulation, which is done by an automatic adjustment of the cutoff energy to be not larger than the width of the conduction band.

Another potential problem that may arise is if the cutoff energy is smaller than the material bandgap ($E_{cutoff} < E < E_{gap}$). In such a case, electrons may be stuck in limbo, as they would not be able to lose energy and join the low-energy fraction modeled with the Boltzmann equation. Such cases are excluded in XTANT-3 by automatic adjustment of the cut-off energy to be larger or equal to the transient bandgap.

III. Boltzmann equation

III.1. Basic concepts, collision integrals

The methodology, first introduced in XTANT-3 in Ref. [34], uses the following Boltzmann collision integral formulation:

$$\frac{df_e(\varepsilon_i,t)}{dt} = I_{e-e} + I_{e-a} + I_{MC}. \quad (17)$$

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Where the distribution function of electrons, f_e, is defined on the transient energy levels (the transient molecular orbitals defined in the tight binding module, see Section IV.2), and the source terms here are responsible for the electron-electron scattering $I_{e\text{-}e}$, electron-atom (or electron-phonon) $I_{e\text{-}a}$, and the source term or article and energy coming in or out to the valence/conduction energy levels from the MC module (high-energy electrons falling below cutoff, holes created in scattering events).

An explicit finite time difference scheme is used for solving the Boltzmann equation (15).

III.2. Electron thermalization

For the electron-electron scattering [34], XTANT-3 has two options.

(i) The easiest option is the relaxation time approximation (RTA) [63]:

$$I_{e-e} = -\frac{f_e(\varepsilon_i, t) - f_{eq}(\varepsilon_i, \mu, T_e, t)}{\tau_{e-e}}. \tag{18}$$

Here τ_{e-e} is the characteristic electron-electron relaxation time (defined by the user); $f_{eq}(\varepsilon_i, \mu, T_e, t)$ is the equivalent equilibrium Fermi-Dirac distribution with the same total number of (low-energy) electrons (n_e) and energy content (E_e) as in the transient nonequilibrium distribution:

$$\begin{cases} n_e = \sum f_e(\varepsilon_i, t) = \sum f_{eq}(\varepsilon_i, \mu, T_e, t) \\ E_e = \sum \varepsilon_i f_e(\varepsilon_i, t) = \sum \varepsilon_i f_{eq}(\varepsilon_i, \mu, T_e, t) \end{cases}. \tag{19}$$

Eqs. (19) define the equivalent electronic temperature (also called the kinetic temperature, T_e [64]) and the equivalent chemical potential (μ). Within this ansatz, the total number of low-energy electrons and the total energy (in electrons and atoms) are conserved within an MD timestep (changes in the number of electrons may only occur *via* the I_{MC} term).

Eqs. (17)-(18) naturally unify various widely used approaches to quantum-classical dynamics [34]. It recovers the limiting cases of the Born-Oppenheimer (BO) molecular dynamics (in the limit of infinite electronic thermalization time, $\tau_{e-e} \to \infty$, and no nonadiabatic electron-atom coupling, $I_{e-a} = 0$) in which the electronic populations are fixed; the Ehrenfest dynamics which includes average electron-atom energy exchange but no electron thermalization ($\tau_{e-e} \to \infty$, $I_{e-a} \neq 0$); instantaneous thermalization in the adiabatic microcanonical ensemble ($\tau_{e-e} = 0$, $I_{e-a} = 0$, used e.g. in Refs.[4,5]); and nonadiabatic dynamics with instantaneous electron thermalization ($\tau_{e-e} = 0$, $I_{e-a} \neq 0$, used in the previous versions of XTANT-3 [2,3]; the same assumptions are used in the two-temperature-based models, TTM-MD [38,65,66]). It was also noted that the BO approximation only assumes the decoupling of the electronic and atomic wave functions, but not necessarily the ground state – excited adiabatic states may also be calculated in many cases, where potential energy surfaces are far apart, thus suppressing electronic transitions between them (far from such situations as conical intersections or avoided crossings) [67]. The ground-state BO molecular dynamics is a separate additional approximation, which can be reproduced within the relaxation-time formalism as the zero-temperature instantaneous thermalization with no coupling ($\tau_{e-e} \to \infty$, $I_{e-a} = 0$, and $T_e = 0$) [34].

The RTA is commonly used for description of metals, however in semiconductors or insulators, the electron scattering is often divided into two different channels: the intraband (within the valence or the conduction band) and the interband (between the valence and the conductions band, such as three-body recombintation and impact ionization). The intraband electron thermalization is usually faster than the

interband one. The first channel leads to partial equilibration for electrons, separately within the valence band (often called holes thermalization) and the conduction band, each with their own tempereatures and chemical potentials. Then, the interband thermalization may take place at longer timescales.

To accommodate the possible different thermalization rates in the valence band, the conduction band, and the total thermalization between the bands, it is possible to introduce partial electronic temperatures and chemical potentials for the two bands, with the same Eqs.(18)-(19) with separate parameters: $f_{eq}^{b}(\varepsilon_i, \mu_b, T_{e,b}, t)$ (where b stands for the band index: valence or conduction) [68]. In this case, the Eq. (19) needs to be solved three times: for the valence band, conduction band, and total electronic ensemble, to defined the three equivalent temperatures and chemical potentials. Then, the separate equilibration rates can be used for each band (τ_{e-e}^{b}), and for the total equilibration (between the bands).

Note that an instantaneous global thermalization produces the conditions of the Two-Temperature Model: separate temperatures of the electrons and the atoms, whereas separate instantaneous thermalizations in the valence band and the conduction band (but not between the bands) reduces to the Three-Temperature Model: different temperatures for excited electrons (in the conduction band), holes (valence-band electrons), and atoms [68].

(ii) Another option is to use the electron-electron Boltzmann collision integral [7,19] (*this option is unfinished in XTANT-3*):

$$\frac{df(\varepsilon_i,t)}{dt} = \sum_j I_{e-e}^{ij} = \sum_{jfg} w_{fg}^{ij}\{f(\varepsilon_f)f(\varepsilon_g)[2-f(\varepsilon_i)][2-f(\varepsilon_j)] - f(\varepsilon_i)f(\varepsilon_j)[2-f(\varepsilon_f)][2-f(\varepsilon_g)]\} \quad (20)$$

where w_{fg}^{ij} is the rate of scattering of electrons from the levels i and j to the levels f and g, respectively. XTANT-3 uses the following approximation for the scattering rate:

$$w_{fg}^{ij} = \frac{2e}{\hbar}\left(\frac{e^2}{r_{e-e}}\right)^2 |S_{if}S_{jg}|^2 \quad (21)$$

Where S_{if} is the tight-binding overlap matrix between orbitals i and f (initial and final in the scattering act); and the characteristic distance between the electrons is approximated as

$$r_{e-e} = \frac{r_{ij} + r_{if} + r_{jg}}{3} \quad (22)$$

Where r_{ij} is the distance between the atoms, to which the levels i and j belong.
The radius is approximated this way to account for the overlap between the initial and final states of both of the scattering electrons, belonging to the corresponding energy levels. This way, if the atoms are too far apart, the electrons belonging to them will have lower probability of scattering. For example, this is particularly important in disintegrating material during ablation.
Note that for the orthogonal tight binding parameterizations we set a characteristic value $S_{if} = S_{jg} = 0.1$ [1/eV], for the lack of a better estimate.

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

III.3. Electron-ion (electron-phonon) coupling

For the nonadiabatic electron-atom (electron-ion, often called electron-phonon) coupling the scattering integral $I_{e-a}^{ij}$is defined as the time derivative of the electron distribution function,

$$\frac{df(\varepsilon_i,t)}{dt}=\sum_j I_{e-a}^{ij}, \tag{23}$$

For solids, the method based on the ideas of Tully's surface hoping is used, modified for efficient treatment of a large number of electrons in the modeled ensemble: it can be used to obtain matrix elements (or probabilities $W_{ij}=\left|\langle\psi_j(t)|\psi_i(t_0)\rangle\right|^2$ with the wave-function defined via the TB Hamiltonian, see Section IV) entering the scattering integral I_{e-a}^{ij} [3]:

$$I_{e-a}^{ij}=w_{ij}\begin{cases} f(\varepsilon_j)[2-f(\varepsilon_i)]-f(\varepsilon_i)[2-f(\varepsilon_j)]g_{at}(\varepsilon_{ij},T_a), \text{for i}>j \\ f(\varepsilon_j)[2-f(\varepsilon_i)]g_{at}(\varepsilon_{ij},T_a)-f(\varepsilon_i)[2-f(\varepsilon_j)], \text{otherwise}\end{cases}$$
$$w_{ij}=\frac{dW_{ij}}{dt}\approx 2\frac{\left|\langle\psi_j(t)|\psi_i(t_0)\rangle\right|^2}{\delta t}\approx\frac{4e}{\hbar\delta t^2}\sum_{\alpha,\beta}\left|c_{i,\alpha}(t)c_{j,\beta}(t_0)S_{i,j}\right|^2 \tag{24}$$

Here again $f(\varepsilon_i)$ is the electron distribution function, normalized to 2 due to spin degeneracy; $\varepsilon_{ij}=\varepsilon_i-\varepsilon_j$; the time derivative is approximated with the finite difference method for the molecular dynamics time step δt, and the wave functions are calculated correspondingly on two consecutive steps: t_0 and $t=t_0+\delta t$; using the linear combination of atomic orbitals (LCAO) basis set within the tight binding Hamiltonian, $\psi_i=\sum_\alpha c_{i,\alpha}\varphi_\alpha$, and $S_{\alpha,\beta}$ is the overlap matrix (in the case of an orthogonal Hamiltonian $S_{\alpha,\beta}=\delta_{\alpha,\beta}$). The exponential terms result from the Maxwellian distribution of the atomic ensemble, and, in general, may be replaced with an integral of the transient nonequilibrium atomic distribution. The factor of $2e/(\hbar\delta t)$ (e is the electron charge and $\hbar$ is the Planck's constant providing the dimensionality of time consistent with that of the MD timestep to render the multiplier dimensionless) is an *ad hoc* correction to eliminate the dependence on the time-step, see [3].

The integral of the atomic distribution counts the number of atoms with the kinetic energies above the given threshold (equal to the transferred energy to/from electrons). It can be defined in the thermodynamical equilibrium as the integral of the maxwellian function: $g_{at}(\varepsilon_{ij},T_a)=e^{-\varepsilon_{ij}/T_a}$, assuming averaging over ensembles. Alternatively, one may count exact number of atoms with the kinetic energies above the threshold in this realization of the ensemble (in the current simulation box).

Such a method of combining surface hopping with the Boltzmann collision integral (instead of a random sampling of electronic hops) enables direct calculation of energy flows between the quantum mechanical electrons and classical atoms in the simulation, and, by extension, the coupling parameter [3]. Note that the method is applicable for arbitrary atomic displacements, without assuming harmonic potential and crystalline solids (phonons) – it also works for amorphous materials, liquids, and rapidly changing structures.

III.4. Source terms

The influx or outflux of electrons from the valence and conduction band (low-energy electrons) *via* such processes as photoabsorption, scattering of high-energy electrons, and Auger decays, are traced in the MC as described above. In each scattering act involving the valence and conduction electrons, the energy level involved is sampled and recorded into the I_{MC}. The levels are sampled according to

probability following the Pauli blocking term in the Boltzmann collision integral: $w_i \sim f(\varepsilon_i)(2 - f(\varepsilon_i + \Delta E))$, where ΔE stands for the energy transferred in the collision under consideration (factor 2 is due to spin degeneracy). All the changes in populations in each energy level within the given timestep are then averaged over the MC iterations [34].

Since an incoming electron generally comes with energy somewhere in between the predefined discrete energy levels, the influx of the particles and energy is distributed between the two closest levels under the condition of conservation of the number of particles and energy: increasing the total number of low-energy electrons by one out of N_{MC} iterations and bringing energy ΔE in the scattering event [34]:

$$\begin{cases} \Delta f_e(\varepsilon_i, t) = \Delta n \dfrac{\varepsilon_j - \Delta E}{\varepsilon_j - \varepsilon_i} \\ \Delta f_e(\varepsilon_j, t) = \Delta n \dfrac{\Delta E - \varepsilon_i}{\varepsilon_j - \varepsilon_i} \end{cases} \tag{25}$$

Where for one incoming electron out of N_{MC}, the change in the number is $\Delta n = 1/N_{MC}$, and the corresponding energy change is $\Delta E = E_{el}/N_{MC}$ (E_{el} is the energy brought by this electron). This way, the total number of electrons and energy, in the low- *and* high-energy fractions (MC and BE modules), are conserved. In the case when one of the levels (i or j=i+1) is fully occupied, another set of levels can be chosen – Eqs. (25) hold for arbitrary levels i and j. The total change of the population on each level is then summed over all scattering acts within the given timestep: $I_{MC} = \sum \Delta f_e(\varepsilon_i, t)$ [34].

III.5. Exceptions, patches, numerical tricks

Since the source term is gathered from all the independent MC iterations to calculate average quantities, a situation may occur that the source term could lead to changes in the distribution function beyond the physically allowed limits (dropping below 0 or rising above 2). In such a case, the extra number of electrons (the part below zero or above 2) is then redistributed between the closest allowed levels under the conditions Eqs. (25).

In a rare case (typically occurring under extremely high photon fluences – high doses and short pulses), this may not be possible: changes in the distribution function may be too large to be accommodated by such a redistribution. In this case, extra thermalization steps are used (Eq.(18) with artificial time-steps introduced) until the distribution function smoothens closer to the equilibrium Fermi to be within the physical limits (between 0 and 2).

IV. Tight binding model

IV.1. Basic concepts, Slater-Koster approximation

XTANT-3 uses the classic Slater-Koster (SK) approximation [69] for evaluation of the Hamiltonian in the tight-binding approximation (using solid harmonics), see educational overview in Ref. [70]. XTANT-3 supports s, p, and d rotational subroutines, which currently allows for the construction of the LCAO basis sets s, sp^3, sp^3s^*, sp^3d^5 (and potentially $sp^3d^5s^*$). At present, basis sets containing f-orbitals are not supported.

Within this method, the Hamiltonian is written in the matrix form via pairwise interaction terms between the atoms (hopping integrals h_{ij}). It is generally written in the nonorthogonal basis set, thus overlap matrix S is also often necessary (that depends on the particular parameterization; XTANT-3 can deal with both, orthogonal and nonorthogonal parameterizations). The hopping integrals and overlap matrix in TB are split to the radial function depending only on the distance between the two atoms in the simulation, and the angular SK term $Y(l,m)$ (defined by the angular quantum numbers [69,70]):

$$h(R_{ij}) = V(R_{ij})Y(l,m) \tag{26}$$

Such a representation allows for analytical calculation of the derivatives of the potential energy surface, which is convenient for the MD simulations, see below.

IV.2. Electron energy levels (band structure; molecular orbitals)

Hamiltonian constructed from the on-site terms and hopping integrals is then diagonalized (either directly, or via the Löwdin method for nonorthogonal parameterizations [71]):

$$\varepsilon_i = \langle i|\hat{H}(\{R_{ij}(t)\})|i\rangle \tag{27}$$

Here ε_i are the electronic energy levels, or molecular orbitals, or electronic band structure – the eigenstates of the electronic Hamiltonian $\hat{H}$ that depends on all atomic positions in the simulation box, and $|i\rangle$ is an eigenvector of this Hamiltonian [70].

IV.3. Transferable tight binding parameterizations

To make the method transferable to multiple atomic structures, the radial part in the hopping integrals is a function depending on the interatomic distance, not merely constants fitted to reproduce a particular structure of the particular material [70]. XTANT-3 has a few modules to deal with several TB parameterizations: for elemental metals, NRL TB parameterization [72,73] is introduced, and for C and Si the Pettifor-type parameterization can be used, Refs. [74,75], or DFTB parameterization [76].

The potential energy of an atom in the second quantization tight binding formalism can be approximated as a contribution of the ionic repulsion and attraction to electrons [28,74]:

$$V(\{R_{ij}(t)\},t) = E_{rep}(\{R_{ij}(t)\}) + \sum_i f\left(\varepsilon_i(\{R_{ij}(t)\},t)\right)\varepsilon_i, \tag{28}$$

where the potential V depends on distances between all the atoms in the simulation box $\{R_{ij}(t)\}$, E_{rep} is effective ion-ion repulsion term (containing all contributions apart from the electronic band energies), and f_i is fractional electron occupation numbers (distribution function) on the transient molecular orbitals.

This is the so-called non-self-consistent TB or zero-order TB. The self-consistent-charge (SCC [77]) iterative subroutine is also included in XTANT-3, but only for Born-Oppenheimer simulation – it currently cannot be used for other types of simulation, since it is a nontrivial task to combine the SCC method with NVE ensemble of simulation or nonequilibrium evolution of the electronic distribution function. Note that the SCC typically assumes Mulliken charges [78] on various elements, and thus high-order TB terms exactly vanish for elemental materials.

Interatomic forces are calculated by analytical derivatives of the given potential energy surface (see e.g. Ref. [63]).

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

V. Molecular dynamics

V.1. Initial conditions

Maxwellian distribution for all atoms in the simulation box for the desired temperature T_{at} can be set with the help of three independent random numbers γ_1, γ_2, γ_3 (all uniformly distributed in the interval (0,1]):

$$E_i = 2T_{at}(-\ln(\gamma_1) - \ln(\gamma_2)\cos^2(\gamma_3\pi/2)) . \quad (29)$$

Where E_i is the kinetic energy of the ith atom, from where its velocity can be calculated; the direction of the velocity (or momentum) is then set uniformly in the solid angle.

This procedure creates a Maxwellian distribution of atomic energies/velocities with the temperature of $2T_{at}$, considering that energy will then be quickly redistributed equally between the kinetic and potential energies (the equipartition theorem), producing the kinetic temperature of T_{at}. This also assumes that the initial atomic coordinates must be set in the potential minimum, producing no additional configurational temperature (associated with the potential energy of atoms, see below) [64,79]. Atoms located not in the potential minimum will accelerate, thereby producing a higher temperature than required.

In practice, equilibration of the atomic ensemble to the temperature T_{at}, starting from these initial conditions, takes only a few atomic oscillations (typically, times of a few tens to a few hundred femtoseconds).

V.2. Atomic motion

As is typical for molecular dynamics simulations, we use Lagrange formalism for deriving equations of motion of atoms. Its advantage is in the fact that extended variables can be introduced straightforwardly in the equations of motion, defining, for example, the evolution of the supercell (simulation box) in the case of used barostats, as will be described below in Section V.7. The forces acting on the atoms are calculated as the gradients of the potential energy defined within the TB formalism (see Section IV.3) and possibly from additional classical potentials (see Section V.4):

$$M_i \frac{d^2\boldsymbol{R}_i}{dt^2} = -\frac{\partial V(\{R_{ij}\})}{\partial \boldsymbol{R}_i} . \quad (30)$$

Here M_i is the mass of a simulated particle (an ion or a target atom), $\boldsymbol{R}_i$ is its coordinate vector and R_{ij} is the distance between a pair of atoms i and j, $V(\{R_{ij}\})$ is interaction potential (collective potential energy surface or a pairwise potential, depending on all atoms j involved).

Equations of motion (30) for the ion-matter scattering may be solved using molecular dynamics (MD) simulations [80]. The set of Eqs. (30) is solved for all the atoms in the simulation box by numerical discretization of time into time steps, and propagating coordinates of all atoms accounting for the dynamical change of the potential of interaction among them.

XTANT-3 supports three integrators of atomic trajectories: Verlet (2nd order) [81], Yoshida (4th order) [82], and Martyna-Tuckerman (4th order) [83].

Additionally, the nonadiabatic energy transfer from the Boltzmann collision integral and the energy transfer from high-energy electrons elastic scattering are fed to atoms *via* velocity scaling at each

timestep, which ensures the energy conservation in the entire system: all electrons and atoms (microcanonical ensemble), see Section V.5.

Using Eq.(17) allows directly tracing an effect of the nonequilibrium electronic distribution function on the interatomic forces in Eq.(28) (as well as on the electron-atom coupling, I_{e-a} [3]), and thus the dynamics and stability of the material under such conditions. As mentioned above, various approximations for the relaxation time also enable comparisons of different standard methods (e.g., BO, instantaneous thermalization approximation).

Note that the formalism of coupled BE-TBMD, at its core, relies on the Ehrenfest dynamics, and not on the finite-temperature extension to *ab initio* simulations [84]. The difference is, the underlying physical picture of the finite-temperature models is that the constant electronic temperature is enforced by the interaction with the bath. In our case, however, even in the limit of the instantaneous electron thermalization ($\tau_{e-e} \to 0$), no interaction with the bath is assumed, and the electronic thermalization is an intrinsic process (non-mean-field effect added). The electronic temperature and chemical potential are not variables in this formulation but parameters. As was noted in Ref. [34], Eq.(18) could be replaced with the electron-electron Boltzmann collision integral, which does not employ any electronic temperature or chemical potential, even as parameters of the equivalent equilibrium distribution [19].

V.3. Artificial dynamics: coordinate path, zero-temperature MD

Instead of the MD simulation, XTANT-3 allows to calculate all the properties of the system over a given coordinates path between two chosen states of matter (by setting the initial and final states in the initial data). This may be helpful for the coordinate-path calculations, allowing to identify potential barriers along predefined paths.

XTANT-3 also allows nullifying of atomic velocities (and velocities of the supercell vectors in Parrinello-Rahman MD) in every given number of MD steps (quenching). This method reduces to the common zero-temperature (steepest descent) MD in the case if atomic velocities are being nullified at each time step of the simulation. Choosing a larger step of nullifying the velocities (once in N simulation steps) allows to speed up the search of the potential minimum, especially in case a barostat is used and the evolution of the supercell vectors needs to be modeled (which is typically significantly slower than the atomic motion and thus requires nullifying its "velocities" not as often as the atomic ones).

V.4. Interatomic potentials

TB-calculated potential energy surface in some cases needs to be augmented with additional classical potentials. It is very common to have additional short-range repulsive potential, which is typically included within the TB parameterization. In some cases, such short-range potential may be needed to be added externally. XTANT-3 supports a range of such potentials, in the form of polynomial, exponential, Coulomb, universal ZBL [85], and its improved version NLH [86] potentials (see details in Part II, Section VI. 4(e)).

Coulomb potential is softly truncated in the calculations [87]. In the case of electron emission included, XTANT-3 counts the average charge accumulated due to the emission and distributes it evenly

among all the atoms in the simulation, creating additional Coulomb potential, which thus evolves in time depending on the number of emitted electrons.

Long-range potentials may also be used in XTANT-3, e.g. to include dispersion corrections (London corrections, etc. [88]). Currently, only (improved) Lennard-Jones-type (LJ) potentials approximating van der Waals (vdW) forces are included [87]. Long-rage potential must be softly cut at short distances not to overlap with the TB-potential (a subject of further development to include models such as, e.g., d2, d3, and d4 dispersion corrections [89]). The vdW potential in the LJ form may be represented in three most common forms: 12-6 form (ε-σ form), AB form, and n-exp form:

The ε-σ form:

$$V_{LJ}(r) = 4\varepsilon\left(\left(\frac{\sigma}{r}\right)^{12} - \left(\frac{\sigma}{r}\right)^{6}\right) \tag{31}$$

The AB form:

$$V_{LJ}(r) = \frac{A}{r^{12}} - \frac{B}{r^{6}} \tag{32}$$

The n-exp form:

$$V_{LJ}(r) = \varepsilon\left(\left(\frac{r_0}{r}\right)^{2n} - 2\left(\frac{r_0}{r}\right)^{n}\right) \tag{33}$$

Which is the most convenient form since the coefficients have a clear physical meaning: r_0 is the equilibrium interatomic distance, and ε is the depth of the potential at this equilibrium distance.

It is also possible to use so-called improved Lennard-Jones (ILJ) potential [90]:

$$V_{ILJ}(r) = \varepsilon\left(\frac{m}{n-m}\left(\frac{r_0}{r}\right)^{n} - \frac{n}{n-m}\left(\frac{r_0}{r}\right)^{m}\right) \tag{34}$$

which reduces to the standard Lennard-Jones for n=12, m=6.

V.5. Source terms, electron-ion coupling (two-temperature MD)

Energy, transferred to atoms from high-energy electrons *via* elastic scattering (from MC module) and from the nonadiabatic coupling of low-energy electrons (from BE module), is distributed to atoms at each time-step of MD simulation. Three schemes of velocity scaling are implemented in XTANT-3: global and local.

i) Global velocity scaling rescales all atomic velocities with the same factor, proportional to the transferred energy:

$$v_i' = v_i\sqrt{1 + \frac{dE}{E}}, \tag{35}$$

Where $E = \sum_i E_i$ is the total kinetic energy of all the atoms in the simulation box, dE is the total energy transferred from electrons at this time step, v_i is the velocity of the ith atom before the scaling, and v_i' is its velocity after the scaling (corresponding to the total energy increased by dE). This Eq.(35) ensures that the total kinetic energy in the simulation box increases (decreases) by exactly the amount of dE while conserving the total momentum in the simulation box.

ii) Local velocity scaling assumes that the electron, hopping between two molecular orbitals, transfers energy to recoil atoms which form these molecular orbitals. This requires orbital-resolved tracing energy transfer in the nonadiabatic coupling. Each orbital is then spun on the basis of atomic orbitals (inherently available in Koster-Slater tight binding) according to Mulliken population analysis. Having the matrix of energy transfer for each pair of atomic orbitals (for initial and final states of an electron hopping), averaged over all levels according to Eq.(24), the following algorithm is implemented in XTANT-3.
For each pair of atoms (corresponding to each pairs of orbitals), their velocities in their center-of-mass are calculated. These velocities are rescaled according to Eq.(35), but using only the energy transferred to these two atoms and their summed kinetic energy in the center-of-mass system. Then, the velocities are converted back into the laboratory system.
This algorithm ensured pairwise momentum conservation, for given transferred energy. However, it cannot deliver energy to a single atom – meaning, diagonal elements of the energy transfer matrix, in which an electron transitions between the atomic orbitals of the same atom (say, *s* and *p* orbitals). This remaining unaccounted energy is then delivered to the atoms via global scaling.

iii) Individual-atom coupling is also implemented, in which the energy transferred to (from) atoms in the electron-ion coupling is traced atom-resolved. This can be achieved if the atomic distribution function in the collision integral is replaced with a set of delta-functions, restoring the individual atom contributions of all atoms. Then, knowing exactly how much energy each atom has received from electrons is added to the atom by rescaling its individual velocity (Eq.(35)). This scheme is most suitable to the situations where atoms are strongly out of equilibrium – such as a fast atom impinging on the sample, with velocity very different from the rest of the rest of atoms, or fragmented target with different parts having very different temperatures/velocities. However, this method of energy delivering to the atoms does not guarantee total momentum conservation.

V.6. Thermostats

If high gradients in the energy/temperature in the target are present, the effects of the transport of energy may be important. Simulation box sizes that can be modeled with ab-initio-like MD are too small to capture such transport effect. To account for energy transport out of the simulation box, thermostats may be used. They allow the temperature or the energy in the supercell to change towards a defined temperature over a given characteristic time.

XTANT-3 allows to use generalized Berendsen thermostat [91] for both, electronic and atomic systems (with independent parameters in the two systems). It is generalized in the sense that instead of a linear rate equation for the temperature, it uses a full exponential solution [53]:

$$T(t+\delta t) = T_0 + (T(t) - T_0)\exp(-\delta t/\tau), \tag{36}$$

Where $T(t+\delta t)$ and $T(t)$ are the atomic (kinetic) temperature on the current and previous time steps (before and after cooling), T_0 is the bath temperature (typically, room temperature, 300 K), τ is the characteristic cooling time, and δt is the MD time step. Note that Eq.(36) is an exact solution of the

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

equation for the temperature rate, in contrast to the linearized one in the original work [91], and thus it does not require the condition $\tau \gg \delta t$ [53].

From the change of temperature, we evaluate the corresponding change in the kinetic energy of atoms, and the energy difference is then delivered to the atoms via velocity scaling, see last section.

For electrons, in the case of instantaneous thermalization, the same Eq.(36) is used for the electronic temperature; in the case of nonequilibrium electron simulation, the same type of equation is used but for the distribution function instead of the temperature:

$$f_e(\varepsilon_i, t+\delta t) = f_{eq}(\varepsilon_i, \mu, T_0, t) + (f_e(\varepsilon_i, t) - f_{eq}(\varepsilon_i, \mu, T_0, t))\exp(-\delta t/\tau), \tag{37}$$

With the equilibrium distribution function to relax towards.

V.7. Barostats: variable supercell

For simulations, where the system needs to change the size and shape of the supercell, ensembles of constant volume do not do the job. Such situations arise, for example, when different phases of material are required to be modeled. A phase transition between phases with different densities and symmetry may be modeled with MD using a barostat allowing the simulation box to change adjusting to the changes in the pressure tensor. XTANT-3 uses the Parrinello-Rahman barostat [92], in which case the supercell vectors are introduced in the Lagrangian of motion as additional variables. Their equation of motion is then defined by the pressure tensor. In this method, the Lagrangian is written as follows [63,92]:

$$L = \sum_{i=1}^{N_{at}} \frac{M_i}{2} \dot{\boldsymbol{s}}_i^T h^T h \dot{\boldsymbol{s}}_i + K_{cell} - U(\{R_i\}, t) - U_{cell}, \tag{38}$$

Where K_{cell} and U_{cell} are kinetic and potential energies associated with the supercell vectors dynamics; h is the (3x3) matrix of the supercell vectors; s are the relative atomic coordinates in the basis of supercell vectors $\boldsymbol{R}_i = h\boldsymbol{s}_i$, and M are the atomic masses; $U(\{R_i\}, t)$ is the interatomic potential in the atomic system (in XTANT-3 calculated from the TB method).

In the Parrinello-Rahman method, the kinetic and potential energies of the supercell is defined as [63,92]:

$$\begin{aligned} K_{cell} &= \frac{w_{PR}}{2} Tr\left(\dot{h}^T \dot{h}\right) \\ U_{cell} &= p_{ext}\Omega, \end{aligned} \tag{39}$$

With the coefficient w_{PR} being the effective mass of the supercell ($w_{PR} = \frac{1}{\alpha}\sum_{i=1}^{N_{at}} M_i$, α is a free parameter chosen by the user); $\Omega = \det(h)$ is the supercell volume; p_{ext} is the external pressure (set by the user).

Then, the equations of motion of atoms and the supercell vectors are derived from the Lagrangian in Eq. (38) as:

$$\ddot{\boldsymbol{s}}_i = -\frac{1}{M_i}\sum_{j\neq i} \frac{\partial U(\{R_{ij}\})}{\partial R_{ij}} \frac{\boldsymbol{s}_i - \boldsymbol{s}_j}{R_{ij}} - g^{-1}\dot{g}\dot{\boldsymbol{s}}_i \tag{40}$$

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$$\ddot{h} = (\Pi - p_{ext})\frac{\sigma}{w_{PR}},$$

Where $\boldsymbol{R}_{ij} = \boldsymbol{R}_i - \boldsymbol{R}_j + h\boldsymbol{z}$ ($\boldsymbol{z}$ is unit vector running over {-1,0,1} in all three dimensions for the nearest-neighbor image supercell); $g = h^T h$; $\sigma = \{\sigma_{\alpha\beta}\} = \frac{\partial \Omega}{\partial h_{\alpha\beta}}$, and the microscopic internal pressure is defined as:

$$\Pi = \frac{1}{\Omega}\sum_{i=1}^{N_{at}} \frac{M_i}{2}\boldsymbol{v}_i\boldsymbol{v}_i^T - \frac{1}{\Omega}\sum_{i,j>i}\frac{\partial U(\{R_{ij}\})}{\partial R_{ij}}\frac{\boldsymbol{R}_{ij}\boldsymbol{R}_{ij}^T}{R_{ij}}, \quad (41)$$

With the atomic velocities $\boldsymbol{v}_i = h\dot{\boldsymbol{s}}_i$, and multiplication in dyadic notation forming a second rank pressure tensor.

Note #1: Supercell vectors' equation of motion in MD simulation requires small timesteps for appropriate energy conservation (in some cases, 0.01 fs or even smaller).

Note #2: Simulations with NPH and non-adiabatic electron-ion coupling may result in poor energy conservation, presumably due to velocity scaling used to deliver energy from electrons to atoms.

VI. Data analysis

VI.1. Excited electrons and holes

XTANT-3 traces the number of high-energy electrons and the number of core-shell holes within the MC module. Additionally, it defines the number of the conduction band electrons (per atom in the simulation) as the number of electrons on the TB energy levels above the LUMO (lowest unoccupied molecular orbital) state at T_e=0.

VI.2. Electronic structure

The electronic structure is calculated at the Gamma point according to Eq.(27) unless the calculation of DOS is specified by the user. In the calculation of the forces, however, only Gamma-point calculations are used in all cases. It limits the simulation size to a sufficiently large number of atoms. The particular number of atoms depends on the TB parameterization: e.g., for short-range orthogonal Goodwin-like parameterization (as used for C and Si), typically, for 64 atoms is sufficient; for NRL and DFTB, typically ~200 atoms is required.

VI.3. Mulliken charge and orbital-resolved data

Mulliken charge analysis [78] is performed by XTANT-3 for different elements in the target. Charges on individual atoms may be printed out, as well as the average charges on various chemical elements in the simulation. Knowing the Mulliken type spanning of the wave-functions on the LCAO basis, electron distributions on the orbital-momentum resolved levels may be calculated: a contribution from each orbital (*s*, *p*, *d* for each type of atom in the compound) into the fractional number of electrons is defined on each eigenstate of the Hamiltonian. This way, orbital-resolved distribution functions may be constructed. Summing over all states, the total numbers of electrons in each orbital may be calculated.

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

VI.4. Electron distribution function, thermalization and entropy

The electronic entropy $S_e = -k_B 2 \sum[(f_e/2)\ln(f_e/2) + (1-f_e/2)\ln(1-f_e/2)]$, with k_B being the Boltzmann constant, and factors of 2 due to the normalization of the distribution function according to the spin degeneracy. XTANT-3 prints out the transient entropy according to the transient distribution function, and according to the equivalent equilibrium distribution function (corresponding to the maximal entropy, to compare and identify the degree of the deviation of the electronic state from the equilibrium) [34].

VI.5. Temperatures, electronic and atomic

The electron temperature is used as the kinetic or equivalent temperature defined by Eqs. (19). The same equations may be used to defined partial temperatures, separately in the valence and conduction band of the material (where summation over the valence or conduction levels are used separately).

The atomic temperature may be defined in various ways in an MD simulation. The standard definition as the classical *kinetic temperature* in the periodic system is as follows (the factor of $\frac{2}{(3N_{at}-6)}$ accounting for the reduced number of degrees of freedom, instead of 2/3 for free particles) [16,64]:

$$T_{kin} = \frac{2}{k_B(3N_{at}-6)} \sum_{i=1}^{N_{at}} \frac{M_i v_i^2}{2} \tag{42}$$

Alternatively, one may define the temperature directly from the atomic distribution function, $f_a(\varepsilon,t)$. The distribution function is defined *via* binning the kinetic energies of atoms on an energy grid, normalizing thusly obtained distribution to one, following the standard normalization of Maxwell-Boltzmann (MB) distribution function, $f_a^{MB}(\varepsilon,t)$ (note that this normalization conditions differs from the normalization used for the electrons above). Once the transient atomic distribution function is constructed, one may construct the equivalent equilibrium distribution from the condition of the same energy content in the system:

$$E_{at} = \int_0^\infty \varepsilon f_a(\varepsilon,t)d\varepsilon = \int_0^\infty \varepsilon f_a^{MB}(\varepsilon,t)d\varepsilon\,, \qquad f_a^{MB}(\varepsilon,t) = \frac{2}{T_a^{3/2}}\sqrt{\frac{\varepsilon}{\pi}}e^{-\frac{\varepsilon}{T_a}}. \tag{43}$$

Integrating the equivalent MB distribution with energy numerically, using the condition that it must give $3/2T_a^{dist}$, we numerically obtain the value of the atomic temperature that we will call *distributional temperature*: $T_a^{dist} = 2/3E_{at}$.

Note that the numerical integration of the constructed distribution function provides more noisy temperature evolution than the kinetic temperature, however, it may be used for comparisons.

One may also define the temperature *via* the method of moments for a generalized Maxwell-Boltzmann distribution. Let us define the distribution with a shift of the energy scale by E_0:

$$f_a^G(\varepsilon,t) = \frac{2}{T_a^{3/2}}\sqrt{\frac{\varepsilon-E_0}{\pi}}e^{-\frac{\varepsilon-E_0}{T_a}}. \tag{44}$$

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Now, the generalized Maxwell distribution has two parameters to be defined: E_0 and T_a. As above, assuming that the distribution is Maxwellian, the first and second moments may be evaluated analytically:

$$E_1 = \int_0^\infty \varepsilon f_a^G(\varepsilon,t)d\varepsilon = \frac{3}{2}T_a - E_0\,,$$
$$E_2 = \int_0^\infty \varepsilon^2 f_a^G(\varepsilon,t)d\varepsilon = \frac{15}{4}T_a^2 + 3T_aE_0 + E_0^2\,, \tag{45}$$

From the parameters of the MD atomic ensemble, the moments can also be calculated:

$$\bar{E}_1 = \frac{1}{N_{at}}\sum_{i=1}^{N_{at}} E_i\,,$$
$$\bar{E}_2 = \frac{1}{N_{at}}\sum_{i=1}^{N_{at}} E_i^2, \tag{46}$$

Where $E_i = \frac{M_i v_i^2}{2}$, the kinetic energy of atoms in the simulation box. Equating the values defined by Eqs. (45) and (46), the two unknown parameters E_0 and T_a may be defined:

$$T_a^{fluct} = \sqrt{\frac{2}{3}\left(\bar{E}_2 - \bar{E}_1{}^2\right)} = \delta E\sqrt{\frac{2}{3}},$$
$$E_0 = \bar{E}_1 - \frac{3}{2}T_a, \tag{47}$$

Which, in the thermodynamic limit (for the case of the exact Maxwellian distribution with E_0=0), reduces to the definition of the kinetic temperature. Note that the fluctuation of the energy enters Eqs.(47): $\delta E = \sqrt{\left(\bar{E}_2 - \bar{E}_1{}^2\right)}$, thus, the temperature defined with Eqs.(47) ($T_a^{fluct}\sim\delta E$) will be referred to as *fluctuational temperature*.

Note that a comparison of the fluctuational temperature and the kinetic temperature may be used as a measure of equilibrium in the kinetic energy (velocity) distribution: they only coincide if the distribution is close to the Maxwellian, and may differ if the distribution is nonequilibrium. This is a different measure from the configurational temperature (see below), which uses equipartition theorem to identify if distributions of the kinetic and the potential energies have the same temperature [64], whereas both the moments and the kinetic temperatures are measures of the kinetic energy distribution only.

As an aside, another alternative definition may be used, demanding that the transient atomic entropy must coincide with the Boltzmann entropy (here defined *via* the Boltzmann H-function as an instantaneous entropy, without time or ensembles averaging):

$$S_{at} = -k_B\int_0^\infty f_a(\varepsilon,t)\left(\ln\left(\frac{f_a(\varepsilon,t)}{DOS(\varepsilon)}\right) - 1\right)d\varepsilon$$
$$= -k_B\int_0^\infty f_a^{MB}(\varepsilon,t)\left(\ln\left(\frac{f_a^{MB}(\varepsilon,t)}{DOS(\varepsilon)}\right) - 1\right)d\varepsilon\,, \tag{48}$$

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Where k_B is the Boltzmann constant, and the atomic density of states assumed to be that of free particles: $DOS(\varepsilon) = \sqrt{\varepsilon}$ (as in the Boltzmann's H-function definition) [93]. Plugging the MB distribution in Eq.(43), the equilibrium entropy can be calculated analytically:

$$S_{at}^{MB} = k_B \left(\frac{5}{2} - \ln\left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{\pi} T_a^{3/2}} \right) \right), \tag{49}$$

Note that the same definition of the entropy is used in XTANT-3 for the configurational entropy, constructed from the distribution of potential energies of atoms, *U*. This entails a problem that the $DOS(U)$ is, in fact, *not* $\sim\sqrt{U}$, and therefore, the configurational entropy is ill-defined, and is only shown for an estimate what it would be if the potential was perfectly harmonic (resulting in $DOS(U)\sim\sqrt{U}$).

Inverting Eq.(49), we may define the temperature value from the transient entropy (demanding $S_{at}^{MB} = S_{at}$ calculated *via* the transient atomic distribution) as follows:

$$T_a^{ent} = \left(\frac{4}{\pi} \right)^{1/3} \exp\left(\frac{2}{3} \frac{S_{at}}{k_B} - \frac{5}{3} \right), \tag{50}$$

Which below we will call the *entropic temperature*. Let us note that in practice, the entropic temperature (definition *via* Eqs.(48) and (50)) is rather sensitive to the calculation of the atomic entropy (due to the exponentiation) and to the deviations of the MD distribution from the exact Maxwell-Boltzmann distribution of the kinetic energies. Minor deviations on the tail (where there are only a few atoms, thereby always producing large deviations from the MB distribution) will always create lower entropy than the MB (which maximizes the entropy), and thereby lower the temperature: $T_a^{ent} \leq T_{kin}$ (slowly approaching it in the thermodynamic limit).

The *virial temperature* is defined via the equipartition theorem, which states that in thermal equilibrium the energy is distributed "equally" between the kinetic and potential energy, and thus both are connected to the thermodynamic temperature of the system. In a system out of equilibrium, the definition of the temperature *via* the potential energy, rather than the kinetic one, is called the virial temperature, and may be calculated as follows [64,94]:

$$T_{vir} = -\frac{1}{3} \left\langle \boldsymbol{r} \frac{d\boldsymbol{p}}{dt} \right\rangle = -\frac{1}{3N_{at}} \sum_i \boldsymbol{r}_i \boldsymbol{F}_i \,, \tag{51}$$

For practical applications, this definition *only* works for *nonperiodic* systems. Let us note that, in fact, Eq.(51) is a contribution of the potential energy in the pressure (P_{pot}) or microscopic stress tensor [94]. Thus, this part of the pressure (configurational pressure) may be reused in a simulation to define the virial temperature:

$$T_{vir} = \frac{P_{pot} V}{N_{at}}, \tag{52}$$

With *V* being the volume of the supercell. As noted above, the virial temperature may be used to check if the equipartition theorem is satisfied (in non-periodic calculations), thus providing another check for equilibrium in the system – this time, equilibration between the kinetic and potential energies.

Next, let us define the generalized temperature via an arbitrary vector field in the phase space $\boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R}, \vec{P})$, for a two-component system of electrons and ions (see Ref. [95] for a detailed derivation):

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$$T_i = \frac{\langle \boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R},\vec{P}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\vec{R}} \left[U_i + \frac{1}{2} V_{ei} \right] \rangle}{\langle \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\vec{R}} \cdot \boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R},\vec{P}) \rangle - \frac{1}{2T_e} \langle \boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R},\vec{P}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\vec{R}} V_{ei} \rangle}, \tag{53}$$

where $U_{i,e}$ is the potential energy of interaction within the ionic or the electronic subsystem; V_{ei} is the potential energy of interaction between two subsystems – the ionic and electronic ensembles; $T_{i,e}$ are the temperatures in the ionic and electronic ensembles.

As a consistency check, it was shown that the definition (53) reduces to the standard definition of a single atomic ensemble (interacting via a classical potential, not involving electrons as a separate ensemble, $T_e \equiv T_i$) [95]:

$$T_i^{(1)} = \frac{\langle \boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R},\vec{P}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\vec{R}} H_{tot} \rangle}{\langle \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\vec{R}} \cdot \boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R},\vec{P}) \rangle}, \tag{54}$$

Note that the kinetic temperature (42) and fluctuational temperature (47) may also be obtained from the generalized temperature definition (53) by using the fields $\boldsymbol{B}(\vec{P}) = \vec{P}$ and $\boldsymbol{B}(\vec{P}) = P^2\vec{P}$, respectively (and for the virial temperature (51), the field $\boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R}) = \vec{R}$ can be used) [95].

Using the generalized temperature (53), further definitions of the atomic temperature may be derived: the temperature in the configurational (real) space can be used as the so-called *configurational temperature* [64], applying the field $\boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R}) = \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\vec{R}} H_{tot}$ (H_{tot} is the Hamiltonian of the system) [95]:

$$T_{config} = -\frac{\langle \vec{F} \cdot \left[\vec{F}_i + \frac{1}{2} \vec{F}_{ie} \right] \rangle}{\langle \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\vec{R}} \cdot \vec{F} \rangle + \frac{1}{2T_e} \langle \vec{F} \cdot \vec{F}_{ie} \rangle}, \tag{55}$$

where $\vec{F}_i$ is the ion-ion contribution to the force acting on an ion/atom; $\vec{F}_{ie}$ is the electronic contribution to the force; and $\vec{F} = \vec{F}_i + \vec{F}_{ie}$ is the total force acting on the atom.

Introducing the field $\boldsymbol{B}(\vec{R}) = F^2\vec{F}$, the definition of the *hyperconfigurational temperature* is derived [95]:

$$T_{hyperconf} = -\frac{\langle \left(F^2\vec{F}\right) \cdot \left[\vec{F}_i + \frac{1}{2} \vec{F}_{ie} \right] \rangle}{\langle \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\vec{R}} \cdot \left(F^2\vec{F}\right) \rangle + \frac{1}{2T_e} \langle \left(F^2\vec{F}\right) \cdot \vec{F}_{ie} \rangle}, \tag{56}$$

Note that currently XTANT-3 can only calculate configurational and hyperconfigurational temperatures for the Pettifor parameterization (see below).

In the thermodynamic limit (a system of large number of particles in thermal equilibrium), all the definitions of the temperature must coincide [64]. In actual MD simulations, they may not. Their discrepancies may arise either due to physical reasons (the system being out of equilibrium, thus not coinciding with the MB distribution), or due to numerical reasons, such as finite number of atoms in the simulation box and finite binning in the energy grid for the atomic distribution. Thus, discrepancies in the plots of various temperatures must be interpreted carefully.

All of the definitions of the temperatures may be used for each degree of freedom. For example, the kinetic and virial temperatures may be defined for projections of velocities on X, Y, Z, using the projections of atomic velocities and components of the stress tensor, respectively.

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

VI.6. Energy balance and conservation

XTANT-3 traces the evolution of the total energy in the system, which must conserve in NVE simulations (without quenching, thermostats, or barostats), except for the laser pulse. At the time of arrival of the laser pulse, the energy increases by the value, defined by the deposited dose.

VI.7. Pressure and stress tensor

The pressure tensor is defined according to the Parrinello-Rahman method (Section V.7), which is calculated even in NVE simulations (without calculating the equation of motion for the supercell vectors) [92].

VI.8. Electronic heat capacity

The electronic heat capacity is calculated via the derivative of the electron entropy with respect to the electron temperature at a constant volume: $C_e(T_e, T_a) = T_e(\partial S_e/\partial T_e)_V$ [96]. Under the assumption of thermodynamic equilibrium, the electronic distribution function adheres to the Fermi-Dirac distribution, so the specific heat capacity (per volume of material) reduces to the following expression:

$$C_e(T_e, T_a) = \frac{1}{V_0}\sum_i \frac{\partial f_e(E_i)}{\partial T_e}(E_i - \mu(T_e)), \tag{57}$$

where the derivative of the Fermi-Dirac function by the (kinetic) electronic temperature is:

$$\frac{\partial f_e(E_i)}{\partial T_e} = \frac{2\exp((E_i - \mu(T_e))/k_B T_e)}{k_B T_e (1 + \exp((E_i - \mu(T_e))/k_B T_e))^2}\left(\frac{E_i - \mu(T_e)}{T_e} + \frac{\partial \mu(T_e)}{\partial T_e}\right) \tag{58}$$

Where the equivalent (kinetic) temperature and chemical potentials are used, and the derivative $\partial\mu(T_e)/\partial T_e$ is calculated numerically; the factor of two is due to spin degeneracy.

VI.9. Electron-ion (electron-phonon) coupling parameter

As described in Section III.3, in the one-particle approximation, the electron-ion coupling parameter G is defined *via* [19]:

$$G(T_e, T_a) = \frac{1}{V_s(T_e - T_a)}\sum_{i,j} \varepsilon_j I_{e-a}^{ij} \tag{59}$$

Where summation runs over all electronic states i and j. The volume V_s is the volume of the sample; in XTANT-3 it is defined as follows: $V_s = \min(V_0, V_{sample})$, and V_{sample} is the volume defined by the distances from the bordering atoms along each axis, plus padding equal to $d_s/\sqrt{3}$, where d_s is the shortest interatomic distance and $\sqrt{3}$ is from the projection on each axis equally.

The scattering integral is calculated as [19]:

$$I_{e-a}^{ij} = w_{ij}\begin{cases} f(E_i)\left(2 - f(E_j)\right) - f(E_j)\left(2 - f(E_i)\right)e^{-E_{ij}/T_a}, \text{for i} > \text{j} \\ f(E_j)\left(2 - f(E_i)\right)e^{-E_{ij}/T_a} - f(E_i)\left(2 - f(E_j)\right), \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{60}$$

Where the scattering probability is approximated as [19]:

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

$$w_{ij} \approx \frac{4e}{\hbar \delta t^2} \sum_{\alpha,\beta} \left| c_{i,\alpha}(t) c_{j,\beta}(t_0) S_{i,j} \right|^2 \quad (61)$$

Here $S_{\alpha,\beta}$ is the overlap matrix, and the coefficients c are the basis coefficients in the linear combination of atomic orbitals (LCAO) basis set within the tight binding Hamiltonian, $\psi_i = \sum_\alpha c_{i,\alpha} \varphi_\alpha$.

See an example of the coupling parameter, calculated and averaged over 10 simulation runs, in Figure VI.1, according to the methodology described in [97].

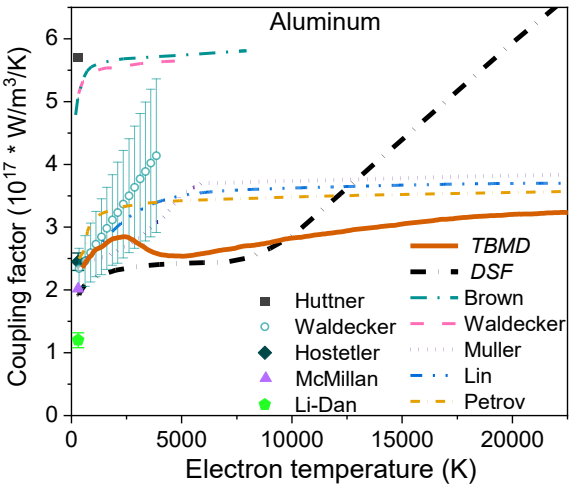


Figure VI.1. Electron-ion coupling parameter as a function of electron temperature in aluminum calculated within the XTANT-3 TBMD approach (Eq.(31)) [3]; DSF-based approach by Gorbunov et al. [98]; compared with other estimates by Lin et al. [99], McMillan [100], Allen et al. [101], Brown et al. [102], Petrov et al. [103], Muller et al. [104], Waldecker et al. [105]. Experimental data for comparison are from Huttner et al. [106], Waldecker et al. [105], Hostetler et al. [107], and Li-Dan et al. [108]. Reproduced from Ref. [3]

VI.10. Atomic structure and displacement

Atomic structure is printed out in various formats and then can be analyzed with the standard MD visualization tools such as OVITO [109], VMD [110], Mercury [111], etc. Mean atomic displacement (in arbitrary degree, e.g. linear or square displacement) may be printed out for all chemical elements of the target. This, e.g., allows to identity melting into a liquid phase, for which the average square displacement is proportional to time ($d \sim \sqrt{t}$).

Note that OVITO supports extended XYZ format, which allows to visualize further parameters of the atomic system, such as color coding atoms by the atomic charges (Mulliken charges described above).

VI.11. Pair correlation function

The pair correlation function (or radial distribution function) is defined as:

$$g(\boldsymbol{r}) = \frac{1}{4\pi r^2 N^2} \left\langle \sum \delta(\boldsymbol{r} - \boldsymbol{r_{ij}}) \right\rangle \quad (62)$$

For all pairs of atoms $\{i,j\}$.

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

VI.12. Phonon spectrum and atomic heat capacity

The phonon spectrum can be calculated with help of the Fourier transform of the velocity autocorrelation function (with the damping factor a) [112]:

$$g(\omega) = \frac{1}{\langle \mathbf{v}(0) \cdot \mathbf{v}(0) \rangle} \int_0^\infty \langle \mathbf{v}(t) \cdot \mathbf{v}(0) \rangle \exp(-at^2) \cos(\omega t)\ dt \tag{63}$$

Knowing the phonon spectrum, we can use it to obtain the atomic specific heat capacity:

$$c_V(T) = \frac{k_B}{N} \int_0^\infty g\ (\omega) \left(\frac{\hbar\omega}{k_B T}\right)^2 \frac{\exp(\hbar\omega/k_B T)}{[\exp(\hbar\omega/k_B T) - 1]^2}\ d\omega \tag{64}$$

Or the molar one:

$$C_{V,m}(T) = R \int_0^\infty \frac{g(\omega)}{N} \left(\frac{\hbar\omega}{k_B T}\right)^2 \frac{\exp(\hbar\omega/k_B T)}{[\exp(\hbar\omega/k_B T) - 1]^2}\ d\omega \tag{65}$$

where R is the universal gas constant; k_B is the Boltzmann constant; T is the atomic temperature (e.g. kinetic temperature in MD simulation); N is the number of atoms.

VI.13. Classical Debye temperature

The classical limit of the Debye temperature may be calculated directly from the mean square displacements:

$$\Theta_D^2 = \frac{9\hbar^2 T}{M k_\mathrm{B} \langle u^2 \rangle}. \tag{66}$$

However, it is important to keep in mind that the mean square displacement (MSD) must be calculated with respect to the thermal mean of the atomic positions: $\langle u^2 \rangle = \frac{1}{N} \sum_i \langle |\mathbf{r}_i(t) - \overline{\mathbf{r}}_i|^2 \rangle$. The mean atomic position here may not exactly coincide with the perfect crystal lattice, or the initial atomic positions may not coincide with it, which will noticeably affect the evaluated MSD, and, by extension, the Debye temperature.

VI.14. Diffraction

Knowing atomic coordinates, it is possible to calculate the intensity of diffraction peaks of an X-ray probe, and powder diffraction spectrum. The diffraction peak intensities are proportional to the structure factor, and can be evaluated as follows:

$$I(\boldsymbol{q}) = \sum_{j=1}^{N_{at}} \sum_{k=1}^{N_{at}} f_j(\boldsymbol{q}) f_k(\boldsymbol{q}) \exp\left(-i\boldsymbol{q}(\boldsymbol{R_j} - \boldsymbol{R_k})\right) \tag{67}$$

Where $f_j(\boldsymbol{q})$ is the atomic form-factor of atom j (summation is running through all the atoms in the supercell, N_{at}); $\boldsymbol{R_j}$ are coordinates of the atoms j; and $\boldsymbol{q}$ is the transferred momentum from the scattering X-ray photon.

Choosing particular diffraction peaks according to Miller indices (*hkl*), the transferred momentum is then fixed by this choice, and Eq.(67) reduces to the following:

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

$$I_{hkl}(\boldsymbol{q}) = |F_{hkl}(\boldsymbol{q})|^2$$
$$F_{hkl}(\boldsymbol{q}) = \sum_{j=1}^{N_{at}} f_j(\boldsymbol{q}) \exp\left(-2\pi i(hs_{xj} + ks_{yj} + ls_{zj})\right) \tag{68}$$

With the relative coordinates of all atoms j in the supercell (s_x,s_y,s_z), and the Miller indices defined via the reciprocal vectors of the lattice, normalized to the number of the unit cells the supercell is constructed from.

Alternatively, averaging Eq.(68) over all direction, assuming that the target is constructed of randomly oriented crystallites (powder), produces the Debye scattering formula (see e.g. here[6]):

$$I(\boldsymbol{q}) = \sum_{j=1}^{N_{at}} \sum_{k=1}^{N_{at}} f_j(\boldsymbol{q}) f_k(\boldsymbol{q}) \frac{sin\left(q|\boldsymbol{R_j} - \boldsymbol{R_k}|\right)}{q|\boldsymbol{R_j} - \boldsymbol{R_k}|}$$
$$q = 4\pi \frac{sin(\theta)}{\lambda} \tag{69}$$

In which case the transferred momentum is connected to the scattering half-angle θ; and λ is the wavelength of the X-ray probe.

Within the Debye-Waller harmonic approximation, Eq.(68) may be reduced to the following:

$$I(\boldsymbol{q}) = I_0(\boldsymbol{q}) \exp\left(-\frac{1}{3} q^2 \langle u^2 \rangle\right) = I_0(\boldsymbol{q}) \exp\left(-q^2 \frac{3\hbar^2 T_{at}}{M k_B \theta_D^2}\right) \tag{70}$$

Where I_0 is the room-temperature diffraction intensities; $\langle u^2 \rangle = \frac{1}{N_{at}} \sum_{k=1}^{N_{at}} (\boldsymbol{R_k} - \boldsymbol{R_k}(t=0))^2$ is the mean square atomic displacement. M is the atomic mass; k_B is the Boltzmann constant; θ_D is the Debye temperature.

Note, however, that the mean square displacement for Eq.(70) needs to be calculated with respect to the average atomic position $\langle u^2 \rangle = \frac{1}{N_{at}} \sum_{k=1}^{N_{at}} (\boldsymbol{R_k} - \bar{\boldsymbol{R}}_{\boldsymbol{k}})^2$ as described above, instead of the one with respect to the initial positions $\boldsymbol{R_k}(t=0)$; the two are only equal in the case when the simulation starts exactly from $\boldsymbol{R_k}(t=0) = \bar{\boldsymbol{R}}_{\boldsymbol{k}}$; otherwise (for example, if the simulation starts from a thermalized state), the diffraction peaks intensities may not be properly normalized, and will require careful reanalysis for appropriate interpretation.

VI.15. Neighbors' analysis and fragmentation

XTANT-3 simulation package allows us to evaluate the number of nearest neighbors within the given radius. Separate radii for different chemical elements can be used. In this case, XTANT-3 counts the average number of atoms (total, and chemical-element resolved) for each specified chemical element in the compound.

XTANT-3 can also count the number of fragments in case the system may break up in the simulation (e.g., ablation). Those fragments are then sorted by mass to create a mass spectrum.

To create a spectrum in units of m/z (mass over charge of the fragments), as observed in experiments, an average charge of the fragments can be used. In XTANT-3, fractional Mulliken charge on each atom

[6] https://debyer.readthedocs.io/en/latest/

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

may be calculated, and then summed for each fragment. In this case, the integer charge is calculated by splitting the total fragment charge between the two neighboring states to calculate the weights and add two "effective fragments" to the spectrum: One with the mass/charge ratio as M/($\lfloor Z \rfloor$) and one with M/($\lfloor Z \rfloor$+1), where $\lfloor Z \rfloor$ is the nearest integer smaller than the fractional charge Z. The weight of the first fragment is then (Z-$\lfloor Z \rfloor$), and of the second one is ($\lfloor Z \rfloor$-Z+1).

VI.16. Optical coefficients

XTANT-3 can evaluate transient optical properties: complex dielectric function (CDF), complex index of refraction, and optical coefficients (transmittance, reflectance, and absorbance), within the random phase approximation (RPA, or, equivalently, Kubo-Greenwood approach [113]). The complex dielectric function within RPA is defined as follows [114]:

$$\varepsilon^{\alpha\beta}(\omega) = \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \frac{e^2\hbar^2}{\Omega m_e^2 e_0}\sum_{nn'}\frac{F_{nn'}}{E_{nn'}^2}\frac{f_{n'} - f_n}{\hbar\omega - E_{nn'} + i\gamma} \tag{71}$$

Here Ω is the volume of the simulation box, $E_{nn'} = E_{n'} - E_n$ is a transition energy between two eigenstates $|n'\rangle$ and $|n\rangle$; $f_{n'}$ and f_n are the corresponding transient occupation numbers (electron distribution function) normalized to two accounting for the spin degeneracy; m_e is the free-electron mass; e is the electron charge; ħ is the Planck constant; and e_0 is the vacuum permittivity (in SI units). The parameter γ is an inverse electron relaxation time (in XTANT-3 set as $\gamma = 1.5\times10^{14}$ 1/s; a particular choice of γ does not affect the results beyond the broadening of peaks in the CDF [114]). $F_{nn'}$ are the oscillator strength corresponding to the energy transition [115]:

$$F_{nn'} = |\langle n'|p|n\rangle|^2 = \left|\sum_{R,R',\sigma,\sigma'} B_{\sigma n}(\boldsymbol{R})P(\boldsymbol{R},\boldsymbol{R}')B_{\sigma' n'}(\boldsymbol{R}')\right|^2 \tag{72}$$

where $\boldsymbol{R}$ are the coordinates of atoms; σ are the atomic orbitals; and $B_{\sigma n}(\boldsymbol{R})$ and $B_{\sigma' n'}(\boldsymbol{R}')$ are the corresponding eigenvectors of the TB Hamiltonian matrix $H(\boldsymbol{R},\boldsymbol{R}')$. There are two approaches to *approximately* calculate the momentum operator with the TB formalism:

1) directly using nonorthogonal Hamiltonian and overlap matrix (see [116]), in which case:

$$P(\boldsymbol{R},\boldsymbol{R}') = \frac{m_e}{\hbar}\left(\frac{\partial H(\boldsymbol{R},\boldsymbol{R}')}{\partial k} - E_n\frac{\partial S(\boldsymbol{R},\boldsymbol{R}')}{\partial k}\right) \tag{73}$$

2) Or, first orthogonalizing it (e.g., with Löwdin method [71]); then, using the operator identity, the momentum operator matrix elements can be calculated within the TB as [115]:

$$P(\boldsymbol{R},\boldsymbol{R}') = i\frac{m_e}{\hbar}[\boldsymbol{R}-\boldsymbol{R}']H_{orth}(\boldsymbol{R},\boldsymbol{R}')$$
$$|\langle n'|p|n\rangle|^2 = \left|\sum_{R,R',\sigma,\sigma'} B^{orth}_{\sigma n}(\boldsymbol{R})P(\boldsymbol{R},\boldsymbol{R}')B^{orth}_{\sigma' n'}(\boldsymbol{R})\right|^2 \tag{74}$$

This simple representation allows to calculate the CDF within the TB method. Knowing the CDF, optical coefficients can be obtained *via* the complex refractive index: $n(\omega) = \sqrt{\varepsilon(\omega)}$. The optical coefficients depend on the polarization of light (of the probe pulse), its angle of incidence, and the

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

thickness of the layer, according to the standard theory of light propagation in multilayer systems (see [117]).

Currently, XTANT-3 can only calculate either single-ray coefficients, or a coherently summed infinite number of reflections. The first case describes well the limit of thick material (if the absorption is high enough so that the rays reflected from the back surface do not contribute significantly). The latter case corresponds to the limit of ultrathin layer, so that many reflections are possible within the duration of the probe-pulse to create interference.

VI.17. Electronic heat conductivity

The total electronic conductivity consists of two terms: the electron-atom (or electron-phonon, κ_{e-a}) and electron-electron (κ_{e-e}) scattering contributions combined using the Matthiessen's rule [118]:

$$\kappa_{tot} = \left(\frac{1}{\kappa_{e-a}} + \frac{1}{\kappa_{e-e}}\right)^{-1} \tag{75}$$

The electron-phonon part of the electronic heat conductivity dependent on the electronic temperature (T_e) may be approximately calculated within the Kubo-Greenwood formalism [119]:

$$\kappa_{e-a} = L_{22} - T_e \frac{L_{12}^2}{L_{11}} \tag{76}$$

Where the Onsager coefficients are [119]:

$$L_{ij} = -\frac{(-1)^{i+j}}{\Omega m_e} \sum \frac{df}{dE_k} (E_k - \mu)^{i+j+2} \left|\langle k|p|k'\rangle\right|^2 \tag{77}$$

The momentum matrix elements in the Onsager coefficients used for calculation of the conductivity may be approximated with Eqs.(74). Since only the atomic displacements are used for evaluation of the momentum matrix elements with this representation, this term only describes the electron-atom heat conductivity.

The electron-electron scattering probabilities are not accessible within the TB formalism, but its contribution to the conductivity can be evaluated with the electron-electron scattering cross sections instead. We use the same formalism with the Onsager coefficients replaced with the following classical expression:

$$L_{ij}^{e-e} = -\frac{(-1)^{i+j}}{\Omega m_e^2} \sum \frac{df}{dE_k} (E_k - \mu)^{i+j-2} \frac{v\lambda}{3} \tag{78}$$

For the electron-electron scattering, the electron velocity, v, may be approximated as a free-particle velocity (here counted from the bottom of the valence/conduction band), and the inelastic mean free path, λ, can be obtained with the cross section of electron-electron scattering. We use the same cross-sections as in the MC module of XTANT-3, namely, the complex dielectric function formalism (Eqs.(7)-(10)) [51].

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

PART II: User Manual

I. Limits of applicability of XTANT-3

The code has the following limitations due to approximations of the model:

- The photon absorption is modeled in the linear regime only. Since no simultaneous multi-photon absorption is included, the lowest allowed photon energy is limited by the material bandgap (for insulators). When modeling photon energy that is smaller than the energy cut-off (see description below), nonequilibrium electron kinetics may be included via the relaxation time approximation.
- The upper limit for the photon energy is ~20-30 keV (no radiative decays of core holes are included, which becomes important for heavy elements at higher photon energies; no relativistic effects for electrons are included).
- The deposited dose is limited to ~5 eV/atom, depending on the TB parameterization of the material. The code *may be* used at higher doses, if you understand the risks, limitations, and shortcomings – such as, e.g., the results at ultrashort timescales may still be reliable, or ultrafast cooling or electron emission that may quickly reduce the dose, etc.
- At low deposited doses, the electron-phonon coupling model is unreliable, it is limited to electronic temperatures above some ~2-3 kK.
- The number of atoms in the simulation box must be larger than some 200-300, defined by the two factors: 1) the TB cut-off radius must be smaller than half of the simulation box with periodic boundaries; 2) the electron-phonon coupling, calculated at the gamma-point only, requires a few hundred atoms for convergence (must be checked for each material).
- Duration of simulation is typically limited to a few picoseconds, due to possible accumulating MD instabilities – they must be checked by the energy conservation in the simulation. Poor convergence (non-conserved energy) should be corrected by reducing the MD time step. Note: the energy drift may be mediated by using Berendsen thermostats.

II. Compiling XTANT-3

If the executable (e.g. XTANT.x, or XTANT.exe) does not exist, compile the source files.

Note: The code was tested with intel and gfortran compilers only; other compilers may require some modification.

1. Compilation with OpenMP parallelization

In Linux, the compilation with Makefile is as follows: go into the directory with the code (all necessary files that must be present are described below), and execute the command

```
make
```

in a terminal. It will compile the code and create an executable named XTANT.x in the same folder. It might take a few moments. It automatically compiles the code with ifort compiler and OpenMP[7].

To compile the code with gfortran, use the command:

make c=gf

Then execute the corresponding shell-script, which specifies paths to MKL libraries on your computer/cluster.

In Windows (with Intel Fortran compiler, OpenMP, and MKL-library installed, and paths set in the environmental variables; e.g. use intel-command line for compilation and execution of the code[8]), rename the file Make.bat.txt into Make.bat, and execute it as

make or make.bat

It will create an executable XTANT.exe.

Run this XTANT.exe in case you are using Windows.

Note #1: In case the program cannot find libraries required for OpenMP parallelization, you might have to specify the paths to them manually by executing commands similar to these (insert your current paths accordingly; example for linux):

```
export LD_LIBRARY_PATH=/opt/intel/2011/lib/intel64:$LD_LIBRARY_PATH
export LD_LIBRARY_PATH=/opt/products/mkl/11.0/mkl/lib/em64t:$LD_LIBRARY_PATH
```

Some other libraries might be missing on your workstation. In this case, find the paths to them and export them analogously.

In Windows, in OneAPI command prompt, all the paths and variables are already written, so that is the easiest way to compile and run the code in Windows.

Note #2: In case of having problems with a lack of memory (which XTANT-3 usually does), you must set it unlimited by executing

```
ulimit -s unlimited
limit stacksize unlimited
```

(For Windows, use the compiler option /F9999999999)

These four commands usually are not necessary since they are already inside of the XTANT.sh

Note #3: If you wish to recompile the code without OpenMP, first you have to clean up all the old compiled files with the command

make clean

After that, you can compile the code without OpenMP by specifying

make OMP=no

[7] More on OpenMP with fortran: http://www.openmp.org/presentations/miguel/F95_OpenMPv1_v2.pdf

[8] https://www.intel.com/content/www/us/en/docs/oneapi-hpc-toolkit/get-started-guide-windows/2024-0/run-a-sample-project-using-the-command-line.html#GUID-124746B8-BA22-4311-9937-768521CB7841

Again, new recompilation with OpenMP must be preceded by making clean, because there are pre-processing options included. So, each recompilation that changes the involvement of OpenMP must be done *only after cleaning up* the files. This option is mainly for code-developing, since executing is much faster with parallelization with OpenMP.

Note #4: Compilation for debug: for debugging during the development of the code is compiling with:

In Linux (after executing '*make clean*'):

make db=y

which will create an executable XTANT_DEBUG.x.

In Windows, a user may compile it in the following way: Make.bat X or make X, where X is one of the following options (no '*make clean*' needed for recompiling):

DEBUG - for debugging during the developing of the code (such as checking arrays boundaries, undeclared variables, etc.), compiles XTANT_DEBUG.exe.

DEBUGOMP or db - to compile parallel version with all debug options on, compiles XTANT_DEBUG_OMP.exe.

FAST or slow – to compile parallelized code with no optimizations and no debug (fast compilation, not-the-fastest execution), compiles XTANT_OMP.exe.

2. Compilation with MPI parallelization

Note: MPI-version of the code is significantly slower, i.e., for an execution on a single (multiple cores with shared memory) machine, it is advisable to use OpenMP version. The MPI version should only be used for running large simulations that cannot be handled by a single machine.

Note #2: in most cases, the MPI-version has only a marginal advantage over the OpenMP version, while consuming significantly more memory; thus, it is advisable to always use the OpenMP version, unless the MPI version is really-really needed.

In Linux: compile with the option

make c=mpi

which uses mpif90 compiler and MKL=cluster options for compilation and creates XTANT_MPI.x executable.

To execute, run the code as:

mpirun -np *[n]* ./XTANT_MPI.x

where *[n]* is the number of processors to be executed on.

In Windows: compile the code with the option

make mpi or make.bat mpi

which uses mpiifx compiler and MKL=cluster options for compilation and creates XTANT_MPI.exe executable.

To execute XTANT-3, run the code as:

mpiexec -np *[n]* ./XTANT_MPI.exe

where *[n]* is the number of processors to be executed on (if compiler and executed with Intel OneAPI; for OpenMPI, use mpirun instead of mpiexec, analogous to the linux case above).

Note #1: MKL=cluster option is used to access ScaLAPACK[9] subroutines for matrix diagonalization etc.

III. Compiling additional post-processing programs

XTANT-3 package has additional useful programs for data analysis, saved in the folder !XTANT_ANALYSIS_SUBROUTINES. They can be compiled all together by using Make.bat (under Windows) file *in this* directory. Under Linux, they can be compiled all together by calling make add in the main directory.

IV. Running XTANT-3 with additional options

To include additional options in the code, you can run it with some additional options as follows:

./XTANT.x X (or XTANT.x X, or XTANT.exe X; in case of MPI compilation, correspondingly, use the call: mpirun -np *[n]* ./XTANT_MPI.x X, or mpiexec -np *[n]* ./XTANT_MPI.exe X)

where X is an option available:

1) help – If you need some short info on the XTANT-3 when starting the code, you can also call the following help-commands: help (so, run it as ./XTANT.sh help, or correspondingly ./XTANT.x help or XTANT.exe help). It will printout the numbers and meaning of possible errors in the error-file (see below), how to communicate with the program on-the-fly (see below), etc. This flag will only print some info and stop the execution of the code; no calculations will be performed.
2) info – Before running the code will print out some basic information about the XTANT. Running with this option will tell you some information about references, disclaimers, how to cite the code, and similar info. This flag will only print some info and stop the execution of the code; no calculations will be performed.
3) size – If you want to create the file with cohesive energy of the material as a function of the nearest neighbor distance (to compare with other works), run XTANT-3 with this option will create an output file named OUTPUT_Energy.dat with the energy as a function of the nearest neighbor distance, see a description below. Note: this file is overwritten every time you run the program with the flag "size".

Note: if the size option is specified in the input file (INPUT.txt or INPUT_MATERIAL.txt, see below), then the user may (optionally) specify the parameters of the grid for the variable size change in the next line in the following format:

[9] https://www.netlib.org/scalapack/
https://www.intel.com/content/www/us/en/docs/onemkl/developer-reference-c/2024-1/scalapack-routines.html

min_a, max_a, points

where min_a and max_a are real(8) parameters setting the minimal and maximal sizes in the units of the supercell, and points is the number of grid points to be used.

The default options are: min_a=0.7, max_a=2.1, points=300. They are used if there is no line with alternative parameters provided.

4) allow_rotation – By default, initializing MD removes the total angular momentum of the system. If you want to start MD simulation without removing it, which will allow the whole system to rotate (e.g. might be useful for modeling individual molecules), use this flag.

5) matter or material – To list all available materials in the directory INPUT_DATA. XTANT-3 will read out the existing directories with the corresponding material parameters, create the file List_of_materials.txt and also print it on the screen. After that, the code terminates; no calculations will be performed.

6) verbose – If you want to see a lot of information on the screen during the simulation run (such as, when which subroutine was called, etc.), which may be useful for debugging and testing, use this option.

7) nonverbose – If you want switch off printing out the timestep information on the screen, which may be useful for debugging and testing in which other info needs to be printed out on the screen uninterrupted.

8) For a regular simulation run without additional options simply call:

./XTANT.sh or XTANT.exe for Windows; or, if compiled with MPI, use

mpirun -np *[n]* ./XTANT_MPI.x or mpiexec -np *[n]* ./XTANT_MPI.exe in Windows.

Note that XTANT-3 supports as many flags at a simulation run as you need, they can be combined.

Also note that all these additional options may be listed at the end of the input file INPUT_MATERIAL.txt, as described below.

V. Files of the code

This code XTANT-3 is contained in several files that have to be compiled together, plus additional files for post-processing of the data if needed. All the files listed below must be in the same directory for XTANT-3 code compilation and execution:

- Makefile – this file uses a standard Linux program make[10] to create links between the compiler and source files, compile all the modules, and the final program: XTANT.x. Use it for Linux-based systems. For Windows, alternatively, rename Make.bat.txt to Make.bat and execute the file Make.bat in the command line (assuming all the paths to needed libraries such as OpenMP are provided in your system, or the libraries themselves are in the same folder).

[10] Details on what is 'make': http://linux.about.com/library/cmd/blcmdl1_make.htm

By default, it uses the Intel Fortran-2013 compiler (ifort2013; or ifort.exe for Windows); this can be changed in the Makefile. Note that the code uses some of the intel-features, that would need to be corrected, should you want to compile the code with gnu-fortran (gfortran).

- XTANT.sh – this is the shell script to be executed for running the XTANT-3 (executable XTANT.x) under Linux. Alternatively, under Windows run the created XTANT.exe.
- Directory Source_files containing all the code files:
  - XTANT_MAIN_FILE.f90 – this file contains the main part of the XTANT-3 code. It assembles the program into one piece and performs the dynamics of atoms and electrons by calling all necessary subroutines. Also, all initialization of variables, reading input files, and creating output files are called from here.
  - Algebra_tools.f90 – this file contains linear algebra necessary subroutines (also with references to the LAPACK library[11]).
  - Atomic_thermodynamics.f90 – this file contains subroutines used for extracting thermodynamical properties from the atomic simulation.
  - Atomic_tools.f90 – this file contains subroutines used for the atomic subsystem within the molecular dynamics method.
  - BS_Basis_sets.f90 – this file contains subroutines to deal with Gaussian basis sets that are required for xTB calculations (*unfinished*)
  - BS_Cartesian_Gaussians.f90 – this file contains subroutines to deal with Cartesian Gaussian basis sets that are required for xTB calculations (*unfinished*)
  - BS_Spherical_Gaussians.f90– this file contains subroutines to deal with Spherical Gaussian basis sets that are required for xTB calculations (*unfinished*)
  - Coulomb.f90 – this file contains Coulomb potential and forces for modeling the Coulomb explosion of finite-size systems.
  - Dealing_with_3TB.f90 – this module contains subroutines for reading and interpreting files in 3TB format [120]. Note that currently XTANT-3 only supports the 2-body part of the parameterization, the 3-body part is unfinished.
  - Dealing_with_BOP.f90 – this module contains subroutines for reading and interpreting files in BOP format [121]. Note that this parameterization only supports dimer molecules, not solids.
  - Dealing_with_DFTB.f90 – this module contains subroutines for reading and interpreting files in the Slater-Koster format[12], as provided by DFTB [122].
  - Dealing_with_EADL.f90 – this file contains subroutines to read from the EPICS (former EADL and EPDL) databases[13], needed for naming atomic shells, extracting information on Auger-decay rates, ionization potential, photoabsorption cross sections (used in one of the options of MC, see below).

[11] http://www.netlib.org/lapack/
[12] http://www.dftb.org/parameters/introduction/
[13] See details of this database here: https://www-nds.iaea.org/epdl97/libsall.htm, physical details and references for the database are here: https://www-nds.iaea.org/epdl97/document/epdl97.pdf

- Dealing_with_eXYZ.f90 – this file contains subroutines to read from extended XYZ format[14].
- Dealing_with_files.f90 – this file contains useful subroutines to deal with files, such as counting lines and columns, reading, checking for errors, etc.
- Dealing_with_mol2.f90 – this file contains subroutines deal with mol2 format[15].
- Dealing_with_output_files.f90 – this file contains all subroutines to create and prepare output directories and files, communicate with the program, and interpret the user's commands.
- Dealing_with_POSCAR.f90 – this file contains subroutines to read input atomic coordinates in POSCAR format[16].
- Dealing_with_xTB.f90 – this module contains subroutines for reading and interpreting files in the extended tight binding, xTB, format [89] (*unfinished*)
- Electron_tools.f90 – this file contains subroutines to deal with the Fermi function of low-energy electrons.
- Exponential_wall.f90 – this module contains short-range exponential repulsive potential and forces needed in case TB parameterization provides too low barrier for atoms at short distances.
- Gnuplotting.f90 – this module contains subroutines to create gnuplot shell scripts.
- Initial_configuration.f90 – this file sets up the initial conditions, such as constructing initial atomic positions and velocities and so on.
- Little_subroutines.f90 – this file contains useful subroutines, such as for approximations, search in arrays, resizing arrays, etc.
- MC_cross_sections.f90 – this file contains subroutines for the calculation of electron cross-sections and the mean free path used in the Monte Carlo part. It uses complex dielectric function formalism [51,52], or BEB cross sections [54,123].
- Monte_Carlo.f90 – this file contains all Monte Carlo model subroutines for photons, high-energy electrons, and core holes Auger decays.
- MPI_subroutines.f90 – this file contains subroutines to deal with MPI calls, such as wrappers of the library functions, and calls used in the code.
- Nonadiabatic.f90 – this file contains subroutines for Boltzmann collision integrals and nonadiabatic electron-ion energy exchange [124,125].
- Objects.f90 – this file contains all the introduced objects in the framework of object-oriented programming[17]and some subroutines to deal with these objects.
- Optical_parameters.f90 – this file contains subroutines for the calculation of the optical part of the complex dielectric function within the tight binding and RPA [115], or within the Drude model [126].

[14] Original XYZ format: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/XYZ_file_format, its extension used in XTANT is described below
[15] https://www.structbio.vanderbilt.edu/archives/amber-archive/2007/att-1568/01-mol2_2pg_113.pdf
[16] https://www.vasp.at/wiki/index.php/POSCAR
[17] Quick introduction into object-oriented programming in FORTRAN: http://www.pgroup.com/lit/articles/insider/v3n1a3.htm and http://www.pgroup.com/lit/articles/insider/v3n2a2.htm

- Periodic_table.f90 – this file contains subroutines to extract information about each elements from the periodic table (must be attached as one of the input files, see below).
- Plots_gnuplot.f90 – this file contains subroutines for creating gnuplot scripts for all the figures.
- Plots_python.f90 – this file contains subroutines for creating python scripts for all the figures.
- Read_input_data.f90 – this file contains subroutines to read all necessary input files (see below).
- TB.f90 – this file contains general subroutines to deal with tight binding (TB) formalism.
- TB_complex.f90 – this file contains subroutines that assemble subroutines requiring complex tight binding Hamiltonian, such as DOS, CDF and electronic heat conductivity calculations over multiple *k*-points (parallelized *via* OpenMP).
- TB_3TB.f90 – contains subroutines to calculate the TB Hamiltonian within one of the following basis sets: s, sp^3, sp^3d^5, and corresponding forces, according to the 3TB model [120].
- TB_BOP.f90 – contains subroutines to calculate the TB Hamiltonian within one of the following basis sets: s, sp^3, sp^3d^5, and corresponding forces, according to the BOP method [121]. *Note that this parameterization only supports dimer molecules, not solids (unfinished).*
- TB_DFTB.f90 – contains subroutines to calculate the TB Hamiltonian and the repulsive term within one of the following basis sets: s, sp^3, sp^3d^5, and corresponding forces, according to the DFTB method [122].
- TB_Fu.f90 – contains subroutines to calculate TB Hamiltonian within the sp^3-basis set and repulsive energy, and corresponding forces, as a combination of Pettifor's parameters, according to Fu *et al.*[127]. Note that the tests showed unstable systems, even though with correct band structure; *not recommended for using until solved*.
- TB_Koster_Slater.f90 – contains some subroutines for the Koster-Slater angular parameterizations up to *d*-orbital [69].
- TB_Molteni.f90 – contains subroutines to calculate TB Hamiltonian within the sp^3s^*-basis set and repulsive energy, and corresponding forces, according to Molteni *et al.*[128].
- TB_NRL.f90 – contains subroutines to calculate TB Hamiltonian within the sp^3d^5-basis set and corresponding forces, according to NRL format [129].
- TB_Pettifor.f90 – contains subroutines to calculate TB Hamiltonian within the sp^3-basis set and repulsive energy, and corresponding forces, according to Pettifor *et al.*[130].
- TB_xTB.f90 – contains first attempts to introduce xTB parameterization [89] (*unfinished, cannot be used*)
- Transport.f90 – contains simple rate equations mimicking heat transport out of the system using a Berendsen thermostat [91].

- XTANT_Analyses.f90 – this file contains subroutines for cohesive energy, split-target cohesive energy, and coordinate-path analysis (instead of the dynamics called from the main XTANT file).
- Universal_constants.f90 – this file contains all universal constants.
- Use_statements.f90 – contains 'use' statements included in the main file.
- Van_der_Waals.f90 – this file contains all subroutines to deal with van der Waals potential.
- Variables.f90 – this file contains all global variables (mainly as defined objects) used throughout the code.
- ZBL_potential.f90 – core-core repulsion in the form of the Universal ZBL potential [85] and its improved version, NLH potential [86].

Additionally, the following modules for post-processing of the data can be compiled (stored in the directory !XTANT_ANALYSIS_SUBROUTINES, require separate compilation as described above):

1) XTANT_atomic_data_analysis.f90 – program to analyze atomic data: pair correlation function
2) XTANT_autocorrelators.f90 – program to analyze atomic motion: velocity autocorrelation and phonon spectrum
3) XTANT_average_diffraction.f90 – program to calculate average diffraction peaks intensities from a set of simulations
4) XTANT_coupling_parameter.f90 – program to extract the coupling parameter (and electronic chemical potential, heat capacity, and pressure) as a function of the electronic temperature from a series of XTANT-3 calculations
5) XTANT_dielectric_function_analysis.f90 – program to extract the optical coefficients from the calculated CDF for the given incident pulse and layer parameters
6) XTANT_el_distribution_analysis.f90 – program to analyze electronic distribution function, plot its evolution
7) XTANT_entropy.f90 – program to analyze electronic entropy
8) XTANT_fragmentation.f90 – program to analyze atomic fragmentation for given separation distance in the simulation

VI. INPUT FILES

The code requires input files stored in the directory: INPUT_DATA. This name cannot be changed. When running the code, this directory *must* be in the same directory as the XTANT.exe (or XTANT.x), for the code to find its relative path.

The directory contains the following files and subdirectories:

- INPUT_MATERIAL.txt or INPUT.txt – input file with all the parameters of the material and laser pulse (and, optionally, numerical parameters).
- NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt – optional input file with all the numerical parameters of the calculations (can be included in the INPUT.txt, or set in this separate file).

These files cannot be renamed, the program has to be able to find them by these exact names.

The directories with the following names must also be present:

- Atomic_parameters must contain the following databases:
  - EADL2025.ALL – Electronic atomic database (ionization potentials, Auger- and radiative decay rates, kinetic energies of atomic electrons, etc.)
  - EPDL2025.ALL – Photoionization cross sections database for all elements.
  - INPUT_atomic_data.dat – periodic table of elements.
  - INPUT_Hubbard_U.dat – table with Hubbard U parameters for (chemical hardness) for selected elements, according to the ThreeBodyTB model[18] [120].
- DFTB containing directories with Slater-Koster files within DFTB format, e.g. matsci-0-3, and others. Inside the directories .skf files must be present, named [*El*]-[*El*].skf, where [*El*] stands for the element which overlap parameters with the second listed element this file contains[19].
- DFTB_no_repulsion optional directory with Slater-Koster files within DFTB format without the repulsive potential fitted, such as, e.g., can be found in [20]. Inside this folder must be a directory with the parameterization name specified in the TB_Parameters file (e.g., "2elements"). In the directory, .skf files must be present, named [*El*]-[*El*].skf, where [*El*] stands for the element which overlap parameters.
- 3TB_PARAMETERS – files containing ThreeBodyTB parameterizations for elemental solids and binary compounds in xml format (*unfinished, do not use*)
- BASIS_SETS – files with Gaussian basis sets in the gbs format[21] (*currently unused, since xTB or ab-initio model is unfinished, do not use*)
- BOP_data – all the dimer parameters in BOP format in the file models.bx [121] (*unfinished, do not use*)

A few other folders with the names of the materials must be there. The material name given in the INPUT_MATERIAL.txt (see below) must exactly coincide with the name of the folder, such as e.g.:

- Diamond, Silicon, Gold, etc. directories with material properties. Each of the folders contains a few files describing the material properties, used in the code as described below.

1. File INPUT_MATERIAL.txt or INPUT.txt

File INPUT_MATERIAL.txt or INPUT.txt contains the following mandatory lines, which must be exactly in this order, with exactly as many numbers inside each line, as described below.

Note that the name INPUT_MATERIAL.txt takes precedence over the name INPUT.txt, so if both files are present, the INPUT_MATERIAL.txt will be read and INPUT.txt will be ignored.

[18] The ThreeBodyTB code and its parameters can be found here: https://github.com/usnistgov/ThreeBodyTB.jl

[19] Detailed description of the files format is provided here: http://www.dftb.org/parameters/introduction/ The skf files can also be downloaded from there with the format that can be read by XTANT, no alterations needed.

[20] Download files from https://github.com/by-student-2017/Slater-Koster-parameters-no-repulsion_v1, place in the INPUT_DATA folder and rename the directory Slater-Koster-parameters-no-repulsion_v1-main into DFTB_no_repulsion

[21] Basis set files can be downloaded from: https://www.basissetexchange.org/

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

```
Cu_on_Si    Setting_cell_Si.xyz        ! material name directory; file with supercell and atomic coordinates
CuSi                ! chemical formula
273.0             ! initial electron temperature [K] / filename with electron distribution
273.0             ! initial atomic temperature [K]
0.0             ! start of simulation [fs]
-1.0              ! end of simulation [fs]
1                 ! number of laser pulses
d   1.0e0   !40.0d0  38.0e0   ! f/d (fluence [J/cm^2]/dose[eV/atom]); value (min, max, step);
92.0e0 eV  1.5   %  ! hw, mean photon energy (or wavelength); units; spectral FWHM; units (% vs. abs)
15.0e0              ! pulse FWHM-duration [fs]
1                   ! type of pulse to be analysed: 0=rectangular, 1=Gaussian, 2=SASE
0.0e0               ! position of the maximum of the laser pulse [fs]
!size
!0.8    2.0 100
!verbose
!print_CDF
!redo_MFP
!print_MFP
NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS
```

Figure VI.1 INPUT_ MATERIAL.txt or INPUT.txt example.

- Line 1: One or two char-variables must be present in this line:

  Column #1 (mandatory): material name, must exactly coincide with the name of the folder, where the material parameters are stored (mentioned above, described below).

  Column #2 (optional): name of the file with atomic coordinates and supercell vectors (the file with this name must be present in the directory, specified by the first variable, the material name; note the formats supported, as specified in Section 4.f)

- Line 2: contains the description of the chemical formula of the material. There are two options to set it:

  1) the chemical formula itself (character). If chemical composition or element is specified in the line, each element **must** start with a capital letter, followed by the small letters and/or a number corresponding to the contribution of this element to the compound – that is how the program parses the names into separate chemical elements to be used for the periodic table reading. For example, diamond or graphite must be set as C; silicon – Si; gallium arsenide – GaAs (e.g., "Gaas", "Ga As", "GAAS", "Ga_As" or "gaas" will not be interpreted correctly); quartz – SiO2, etc.

  2) the file with the chemical formula of the material. The file with this exact name must be present in the directory specified in the first line (above). Inside this file, the chemical formula must be provided (character, following the same rules as described in option 1). Alternatively, if the symbol "-" is provided in the Line 2, the default name of the file will be used, "Chemical_formula.txt"; in this case, this file *must* be present in the directory with the material parameters and contain the chemical formula.

  This file may contain additional optional lines:

  Second line in this file may contain the name of the file with atomic coordinates and supercell vectors. Note that this name is superseded by the filename provided in the second column of the first line of the INPUT.txt file – so, to use the name from this file, the INPUT.txt should *not* contain the name of the file with the supercell parameters. For example, "material.xyz".

  Third line in this file may contain the name of the file with atomic velocities in the XYZ format. If no name of the file with atomic velocities is provided, the default name is assumed, which is: [*file_with_coordinates*]_vel.xyz. For example, if you used material.xyz for the coordinates, the default name for the file with velocities would be material_vel.xyz.

  If no optional lines are provided, the default names for the coordinates files are used, and the default sampling of the velocities is used according to the specified distribution, see below.

- Line 3: setting the initial electron distribution function can be done in two ways:
  - If a number is provided in this line, it sets the initial electron temperature in [K]. Then, the initial electron distribution is assumed to be the Fermi function, defined by the given temperature and the number of electrons in the valence band of the material (calculated from the atomic valence electrons, given in the database INPUT_atomic_data.dat, see above).
  - If the name of the file is given, XTANT-3 will attempt to read the electron distribution function from this file. The file must be located in the directory, containing all the material parameters (as provided in the first line). If the file with the given name cannot be found in the directory, then the Fermi distribution will be assumed instead, with the electronic temperature equal to the atomic one (see next line). The file with the distribution function must be in the following format:

    The first line is the comment line that will be skipped while reading.

    Second and all the other lines will be read. The last column in the file is assumed to contain the distribution function (compatible with the output file with the distribution function created by XTANT: OUTPUT_electron_distribution.dat, see below).

    This option can be used for setting nonequilibrium electron distributions that can be run in BO approximation (see flag setting it below, file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt); currently, no other simulation option supports nonequilibrium distributions – the initial one will be thermalized in all but BO simulations.
- Line 4: initial atomic temperature in [K]. If SAVE-files are used to set the initial atomic configuration, the atomic temperature may be used to control the initial atomic velocities:
  - If the provided temperature is different by more than the factor of 1.5 from the one that corresponds to the kinetic energy from the SAVE file (calculated from the atomic velocities), the atomic velocities will be resampled randomly with the Maxwellian distribution to match the temperature given in this line.
  - If the value provided here is negative (or is within the factor of 1.5 of the kinetic temperature corresponding to the velocities in the SAVE files), the velocities from the SAVE files will be used, and the atomic temperature recalculated from the corresponding kinetic energy.
- Line 5: starting time of simulation in [fs].
- Line 6: total duration of the simulation in [fs]. *Can be later changed during the simulation, see below description of the Communication file.*
- Line 7: number of laser-pulses to be simulated (multiple-pulses allowed). A number of next lines depends on this. In this example of Figure VI.1, there is only 1 pulse to be modeled. In case you want to model two pulses, set here 2.
- The next lines specify the parameters of each FEL-pulse:
  - Line 8: specifies the incoming fluence or the absorbed dose of the pulse
  - Column #1: marker (text), may optionally specify if the numbers given are the incoming fluence or the absorbed dose. The marker may be:

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

d or D: for absorbed dose; then the following numbers are interpreted in [eV/atom]

f or F: for incoming fluence; then the following numbers are interpreted in [J/cm^2]

Note #1: XTANT-3 uses the absorbed dose internally, so if the incoming fluence is specified, it is converted into the absorbed dose prior to simulation, according to the assumption of the normal incidence of the laser pulse along the Z axis [2]:

$$D = F\,(1 - exp(-d/L))/(e\,n_{at}\,(d \cdot 10^{-8})) \quad (79)$$

Here D is the absorbed dose in [eV/atom]; F is the incoming fluence in [J/cm^2]; d is the thickness of the sample along Z axis in [Å] (simulation box, or a layer of material); L is the photon attenuation length for the given photon energy in [Å]; n_{at} is the atomic concentration in [atoms/cm^3]; e is the electron charge for conversion between [J] and [eV]; and the factor 10^{-8} is for conversion between [Å] and [cm]. This expression assumes linear absorption, and the program will not work in the nonlinear regime (too low photon energy, or too high fluence).

Note #2: if there is no marker given but a number instead, it is assumed by default that the number corresponds to the absorbed dose (to be back-compatible with the legacy format).

Note #3: the output directory name contains the absorbed dose value, not the incoming fluence (if needed, converted according to Eq.(42); so, don't be surprised by the folder name containing the dose value).

- Column #2: the absorbed dose in [eV/atom] (or the incoming fluence in [J/cm^2] depending on the marker in the Column #1) used for energy deposition from this pulse.
Setting it equal to 0 gives NO laser pulse, modeling the dynamics of the unirradiated system (for example, for relaxation of the system, or for electron-ion thermalization, if the nonadiabatic coupling is included).
There are two options to set the absorbed dose:

  (i) if a single number is given in this line, the single absorbed dose is set in [eV/atom] (or incoming fluence in [J/cm^2])

  (ii) if there are three (real) numbers in this line they are interpreted as a grid in dose (or fluence): *first dose (or fluence), last dose (or fluence), step* (all in [eV/atom] for dose, or in [J/cm^2] for incoming fluence). In this case, the program will create a set of input files with all identical parameters, except for the dose, which will be varied between the first and the last number, by the *step* given in this line. The program then will run a sequence of simulations one after another automatically for all set doses, see below section VI.3.

- Line 9: parameters of the photon spectrum.

  This line can either specify the filename with the incoming photon spectrum, or the photon energy (with up to four numbers specified below).

  a) Setting the photon energy: In this case, the line setting the photon spectrum parameter may contain from 1 to 4 columns. Only the first column is mandatory, the other 3 are optional. If only one column is provided, it is assumed to be photon energy in eV; otherwise, the parameters of the incoming pulse may be specified in the next 3 columns.

Column 1: sets the photon parameters: the photon energy, or wavelength, or frequency (real).

If there is only one column in this line, it is assumed to be the photon energy in the units of [eV] (making it back-compatible with old versions of XTANT code). To specify that the value provided here is not photon energy but the wavelength or frequency, the second (or third) column must contain the units of this value (e.g., nm, THz, etc. see below).

Note #1: XTANT-3 uses frequency in hertz [1/s], and not angular velocity in [rad/s].

Column 2: may specify either the units of the photon energy (wavelength or laser frequency) (character), or the FWHM of the photon spectrum (real).

Note #2: width of the spectrum uses FWHM assuming a Gaussian distribution of the photon energies (wavelength or frequency) around the mean.

Note #3: If the FWHM number is not given (in columns 2 or 3), then zero-FWHM is assumed, and all the photon energies will be equal to the mean (ideal monochromatic pulse).

The following units specified in this column (or column 3) are supported in XTANT-3:

Marker	Units	Comment
eV	eV	Photon energy; electron-Volt
keV	keV	Photon energy; 1000 eV
au, a.u.	atomic units	Photon energy; assuming a.u.=27.2 eV
Ry	Rydberg	Photon energy; Ry=13.6 eV
nm	nm	Wavelength; 10^{-9} m
A	Å	Wavelength; angstrom, 10^{-10} m
m	m	Wavelength; meter
mkm, micron	micron	Wavelength; 10^{-6} m
cm	cm	Wavelength; 10^{-2} m
mm	mm	Wavelength; 10^{-3} m
pm	pm	Wavelength; 10^{-12} m
a0, Bohr	Bohr radius	Wavelength; atomic length unit, 0.53 Å
Hz	hertz	Frequency; hertz=1/s
GHz	Gigahertz	Frequency; 10^{9} 1/s
THz	Terahertz	Frequency; 10^{12} 1/s
PHz	Petahertz	Frequency; 10^{15} 1/s

Column #3: if column 2 set the FWHM than column 3 may set the units of the both, the mean and the FWHM spread (see the table above).

Note #4: if one sets the percent symbol here '%' than it is assumed that column #1 is in eV, and the percent refers to the width of the spread (FWHM).

If column 2 set the units of the mean than column 3 may set the value of the spectral spread (FWHM) in the same units.

Column #4: column 4 may specify to use the relative width of the spread (in percent of the mean); if anything but the percent symbol is used in column 4, it is assumed that the width (FWHM) uses the same units as the mean.

b) Filename. The file with the provided name must be present in the same folder INPUT_DATA. In that file, two columns must be given: Column #1 with the photon energy in [eV]; column #2 with the spectrum (photon probability for this energy).

- Line 10: duration of the pulse, τ, in [fs] (FWHM for Gaussian pulse, total duration for flat-top or SASE [131]).
- Line 11: type of the pulse to be used: 0 means flat-top pulse, 1 gives Gaussian, and 2 mimics SASE-like spiky pulse [131].
- Line 12: position of the center, t_0 (Gaussian maximum) of the laser pulse [fs].
- If you want to set a second pulse, repeat the same lines 8-12 (with different pulse parameters) in the same order.

- Optional lines:

To provide additional options for calculations, one may use optional lines at the end of the file.

- Any of the additional options that may be passed to XTANT-3 *via* the command line (see Section IV) may also be specified here (e.g., size, info, help, etc.).

- Output_name (or outname): to set the name of the output directory; the name will then include the words OUTPUT_[*material*]_[*Output_name*], instead of the standard output directory name (see below, Page 95).

  The name of the directory must be provided in the same line after the marker, e.g.:

  Output_name test_run_42

  Note #1: Special symbols (such as @#..$*|</>\"%:?) in the *Output_name* are not allowed and will be replaced with underscores automatically.

- Output_add (or outadd): to add text to the default name of the output directory (default name is described below, Page 95).

  The additional text for the directory must be provided in the same line after the marker, e.g.:

  outadd test_run_42

- Set_V0: option to set initial atomic velocities all equal to the mean square one defined by the temperature (uniform distribution in solid angle), instead of Maxwellian distribution. May be used for testing and checks of nonequilibrium atomic distributions.

- Set_V1: option to set initial atomic velocities randomly (uniform distribution of velocities along each coordinate), instead of Maxwellian distribution. May be used for testing and checks of nonequilibrium atomic distributions.

- Exact_Ta: option to set the precise atomic temperature, exactly equal to the one provided in the input file. It rescales the atomic kinetic energy to match the exact given temperature, but skews slightly the distribution function. So, if you want to use the exact temperature and neglect initial slightly non-Maxwellian distribution, use this flag.

- V_scaling [*ind*]: option to choose which scheme to use for rescaling atomic velocities in electron-ion (electron-phonon) energy exchange. ind=0 means global atomic velocities rescaling; ind=1 means local (pairwise for all atoms) velocity rescaling; ind=2 means individual-atom energy rescaling (see description of the three possibilities in Section V.5). The default option is global scaling (used if this keyword is absent). To set local velocity scaling scheme, use the following marker:

  V_scaling 1 ! velocity scaling: 0=global; 1=local; 2=atom-resolved

- redo_MFP: option to enforce recalculation of mean free paths of electrons and photons. Should be used if any parameter of the material was changed.

- print_MFP: option to printout mean free paths of electrons and photons.

- print_Ta: option to printout various definitions of the atomic temperature: kinetic, fluctuational, virial, configurational; and projections of the kinetic and virial temperatures on X, Y, Z.

- print_fragments: option to printout data on fragments of material, if any exist or produced during the simulation. E.g., if a finite sample is modelled (layer, cluster, molecule) which may disintegrate into fragments upon irradiation, such fragments may be analyzed and their individual data printed out, such as the number of atoms in each fragment, their atomic temperatures (kinetic and fluctuational).

- print_spectrum: option to printout photon spectra: incoming and absorbed; for the first laser pulse, it also contains the spectrum sampled in the Monte Carlo simulation (for multiple pulses, only the first one will be printed, not the others).

- Save_CDF (or print_CDF, or get_CDF): option to print out the cdf-file with the Ritchie-Howie parameters used for the specified material. This option does not require any additional specifications.
  Note #1: this option is particularly useful if you use single-pole approximation for Ritchie-Howie CDF to see the automatically fitted coefficients.

- EADL_name: to set the name of the file with the EADL database (from EPICS; the default one is EADL2025.ALL; the corresponding file should be present in the directory INPUT_DATA/Atomic_parameters). The name of the directory must be provided in the same line after the marker, e.g.:

  EADL_name EADL2017.all

- EPDL_name: to set the name of the file with the EPDL database (from EPICS; the default one is EPDL2025.ALL; the corresponding file should be present in the directory INPUT_DATA/Atomic_parameters). The name of the directory must be provided in the same line after the marker, e.g.:

  EPDL_name EPDL2017.ALL

- test_mode (testmode): to printout a lot of optional output – those described above (MFPs, CDF, distributions, energy levels, atomic temperatures), and additionally the file 'OUTPUT_testmode_data.dat' containing the data on the center of mass velocity, inertial tensor, and total forces in the supercell (which must all be zero within the computer precision in a regular simulation, so it can be used for testing).

- Diffraction: to calculate diffraction patterns. This keyword must be followed by 3 numbers in the same line, separated by TAB:

  1) Number of selected diffraction peaks to be calculated: N_{peaks}
  2) Photon energy of the probe in [eV]
  3) Step in the 2θ of powder diffraction calculation [deg] (if this number is not specified, 1.0 deg step is used by default)

  Optional lines: number of lines must follow, equal to the specified number of peaks N_{peaks}. In each line, 3 Miller indices for each peak must be specified (separated by space or tab).

  E.g. if you would like to calculate diffraction intensities for 3 peaks [(111), (311), (333)] at the photon energy of 8 keV, the following lines must be defined in the input file:

  Diffraction 3 8000.0 0.5
  1 1 1
  3 1 1
  3 3 3

Note: Miller indices should correspond to the unit cell in the material. That means, if you are using a method of setting up the simulation box that does rely on the unit cell (see below), you

must nevertheless specify the correct number of unit cells out of which the supercell is constructed (see below the section NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS). Otherwise, the Miller indices may not correctly correspond to the diffraction peaks you would like to calculate, and, most likely, it will result in the evaluation of the diffraction intensities in the regions between the peaks (diffuse scattering, or background noise).

Additionally, one can specify the marker DW, which (if the Diffraction is also specified) will calculate and print out the given diffraction peaks within the Debye-Waller harmonic approximation.

- Probe: specifies that calculation of the optical parameters of a probe pulse is required. Optional line 1: probe. Below this marker, the following three lines in the given order (and no empty lines in between) must be provided:

  Optional line 2: this line contains 5 numbers (2 integers + 3 reals):

- first one sets whether you want to calculate the evolution of the optical properties (set 0 if not), and within which model:

a) 1 for the Drude model. If the Drude model is used, it requires additional parameters to be set in the file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS using the optional block of data "DRUDE", see below. If this block is not specified, the default values are used: n=1, k=0, m_{e_eff}=m_{h_eff}=m_e, and t_e=t_h=1 fs.

b) 2 for the RPA model (in Trani *et al.*'s approximation) at many k-points, distributed according to the user-defined grid or to the Monkhorst-Pack grid [132] (this option requires many diagonalizations of TH Hamiltonian which are currently not parallelized, and thus is very slow). It uses nonorthogonal Hamiltonian representation, see Eq.(73).

c) 3 for the RPA model (in Trani *et al.*'s approximation) [115] at the Gamma-point only.

d) 4 for Kubo-Greenwood (KG) model (equivalent to RPA) using orthogonalization for momentum operator calculations, Eq.(74).

e) 5 for KG model using non-orthogonal momentum operator calculations, Eq.(73). *This should be the default option.*

Note #1: The two formalisms – KG in a non-orthogonal representation and RPA – produce nearly identical results. However, KG implementation is parallelized with OpenMP, while Trani's RPA is not; thus, option 5 is recommended as the default choice, while option 2 is obsolete. Option 4 produces worse results than 5.

- The second number in this line indicates whether you want to calculate the complex dielectric function only for a given (probe-photon) energy (set 0), or for the whole spectrum (set 1). The default choice is 0.

- The next three numbers define the interval of the spectrum you'd like to calculate, in case the previous number is set to 1: The third number is the starting point in [eV], the fourth is the ending point in [eV], and the fifth is the energy step in [eV] to make a uniform grid. If any of these three numbers is set to negative, then default values for the interval are used, which are: from 0 to 50 eV with the step of 0.05 eV.

Optional line 3: contains three numbers:

- First one sets for how many rays propagation you want to calculate the optical parameters (transmission, reflection, and absorption of the probe-pulse): set 1 for the first ray, or a value larger than 1 for summing up all rays. For femtosecond probe pulse, the default choice is 1 (however, for very thin samples, thinner than ~50 nm, sum up all).
- The second number sets the wavelength of the probe pulse in [nm].
- The third one is the duration of the probe pulse in [fs]. If the number if set to a positive value, the output files will be additionally convolved with the Gaussian probe pulse of the given duration. A set of additional convolved output data will be created with the tag 'CONVOLVED' (see below). To exclude this option, set the duration to zero or a negative value.

Optional line 4: contains two numbers:

- The first one sets the angle of incidence of the probe-pulse [in degrees] *with respect to the normal*.
- The second one sets the thickness of the material layer through which the probe pulse absorption and reflection are calculated in [nm]. Must be equal to the experimental target thickness, if it is thinner than the FEL photon attenuation length; or may be to the FEL-photon attenuation length otherwise.

- Kappa: option to calculate the electronic heat conductivity (and together with it, the electronic chemical potential and the electronic heat capacity) vs. the electronic temperature.

Optional line 1: Kappa (or kappa, or do_kappa, or get_kappa) – the marker to include static calculation: as a function of electron temperature. Use this *only* in static calculations (without MD, which can be done by setting simulation end time smaller than the start time).

Note #1: the calculations are performed for multiple k-points, grid for which is defined in the last line in the NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS block described below; for single gamma-point calculations, set there 1x1x1 points (3*1).

Optional line 2: three real numbers, specifying the grid in the electronic temperature:

Te_min Te_max step

Where Te_min is the start of the grid in [K]; Te_max is the end of the grid in [K]; step is the grid step in [K]. This line is optional. If it is not defined, the default values are used: Te_min=300 K; Te_max=30000 K; step = 100 K.

- Coupling: option for automatic preparation of XTANT-3 input for calculations of the average electron-phonon coupling (see details in Section (VIII.5)) may be passed here. To set it, use the following command (2 lines):

Optional line 1: Coupling – the marker, identifying that input files for electron-phonon coupling calculations should be prepared.

Optional line 2: N is the number of simulations to be used for average electron-phonon coupling calculations. If N is not specified, the default value of N=10 is used.

If the marker "Coupling" is found in the file, the code will create automatically N copies of the input files (INPUT_DATA_i.txt and NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS_i.txt, for i=1..N), in which the following parameters will be set:

- the start of simulation t_0 $(1 \pm 0.1RN)$, where RN is a random number in the interval [0,1]

- end of simulation t_f $(1 \pm 0.25RN)$, where RN is a different random number in the interval [0,1]

- absorbed dose D $(1 \pm 0.1RN)$, where RN is a different random number in the interval [0,1]

- pulse FWHM duration will be equal to the end of simulation time.

The values of t_0, t_f, and D are taken from the existing input file, and in each successive file their own characteristic values are written, sampled around these ones. This way, slightly different initial conditions, and the absorbed dose will be used in each calculation, which then allows us to average the data for reliable calculation of the electron-phonon coupling parameter, see Section (VIII.5) for details.

This option allows for more convenient calculations of the electron-phonon coupling parameter, instead of the manual creation of input files.

- Water: option for the automatic embedding of the material or molecule into water. It will set randomly water molecules around the given material. The following lines must be specified:
  Optional line 1: water, the keyword specifying that the target will be embedded in water.
  Optional line 2: number of water molecules to be placed around the target material (integer).

  This option performs the following procedure: sets the target material as specified above (by the unit cell or supercell parameters). Then, extends the size of the supercell, and places the specified number of water molecules around it. The molecules are randomly placed and randomly oriented but checked not to be placed too close to each other or the given target atoms.

  Note, however, that there is no guarantee that thusly constructed water environment will make the supercell relaxed (in fact, it never does). If the code would be unable to place all the water molecules at the first attempt (it performs a certain number of iterations), then it will increase the size of the supercell and try again. A message about it will be displayed on the screen. Randomly placed water molecules will not be in an equilibrium state, and will need a two-step relaxation: (1) with quenching, attempting to find the equilibrium positions minimizing the potential energy (note that some molecules may break apart at this stage and the code may need to be run again!); (2) thermalization with Berendsen thermostat (to reach thermal equilibrium). See below options for quenching and thermostat.

  This option is convenient for setting bio-molecules in water, without manually specifying all the water molecules.

- NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS (or NUMERICS, or NUMPAR): the option to specify that all the numerical parameters will be provided in this file, just under this line, instead of the separate file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt described below. After this flag, the entire

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set of parameters in exactly the same order must be provided, as described below. This is just an option for the user to choose where to set numerical parameters for convenience: in a separate file, or all in one file, see an example in Figure VI.2.

Note that this option takes precedence over the separate file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt: if both are present, the parameters will be read from here, and the separate file will be ignored.

- All optional parameters at the end of the NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt (described below) may also be used here (e.g., MASS, AUGER, etc.).

```
W    ! material name directory; file with supercell and atomic coordinates
W               ! chemical formula
300.0            ! initial electron temperature [K] / filename with electron distribution
300.0            ! initial atomic temperature [K]
-100.0             ! start of simulation [fs]
100.0             ! end of simulation [fs]
1                ! number of laser pulses
d  2.0d0          ! absorbed dose [eV/atom]
10.0    !eV  1.5   %  ! hw, mean photon energy (or wavelength); units; spectral FWHM; units (% vs. abs)
5.0e0             ! pulse FWHM-duration [fs]
1                  ! type of pulse to be analysed: 0=rectangular, 1=Gaussian, 2=SASE
0.0e0              ! position of the maximum of the laser pulse [fs]
print_Ta
!verbose
!nonverbose
print_CDF
!redo_MFP
print_MFP
!output_add BO
!outname hw_10.0_t_5.0_F_1.20_NVE_nonBO
!Set_V0
NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS
3   3   3       ! number of unit-cells in X,Y,Z
1   1   1       ! periodicity along X,Y,Z directions (1=yes, 0=no)
CDF 0.0e0       ! where to take material parameters from (EADL, CDF); E_gap [eV]; file with cdf (optional)
-1.0d0          ! [g/cm^3] density of the material (used in MC in case of EADL parameters), if <0 uses data from MD supercell
10000            ! number of MC iterations
```

Figure VI.2 INPUT_ MATERIAL.txt or INPUT.txt example with option NUMERICS included.

2. File NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt

File NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt (or the block "NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS" in the INPUT.txt file) contains the following lines, which must be exactly in this order, with exactly as many numbers inside each line, as described below:

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```
3   3   3        ! number of unit-cells in X,Y,Z
1   1   1        ! periodicity along X,Y,Z directions (1=yes, 0=no)
CDF 0.0e0        ! where to take material parameters from (EADL, CDF); E_gap [eV]; file with cdf (optional)
-1.0d0           ! [g/cm^3] density of the material (used in MC in case of EADL parameters), if <0 uses data from MD supercell
10000             ! number of MC iterations
-1                ! number of threads for OPENMP (<1 = max threads available)
2                ! MD algorithm: 0=Verlet (2d order); 1=Yoshida (4th order, slow); 2=Martyna (4th order, fast)
1                ! frozen atoms (=0), or moving normally (=1)
25.0d0            ! Parinello-Rahman super-cell mass coefficient
0.1d0   dt_grid.txt     ! time step for MD [fs] (or a file name with the variable time-grid)
1.0d0            ! printout data into files every 'dt_save_time' [fs]
1                ! it's = 1 if P=const (NPH), or = 0 if V=const (NVE)
0.0d0            ! external pressure [Pa]
F   0   0.35     ! include SCC (True, False), model of gamma (default 0); mixing factor (default 0.35)
4   1.0e0   -10.0e0    -50.0e0   ! 0=decoupled; 1=E_tot=const; 2=T=const; 3=BO; 4=Relaxation time; full tau [fs]; tau_CB; tau_VB
-1  1              ! -1=nonperturbative (default), 0=no, 1=dynamical, 2=FGR (don't use) | 0=Maxwel, 1=nonequilibrium
-1.0d+3    4.0d0     ! [fs] when to switch on the nonadiabatic coupling; scaling factor (if needed; default=4.0)
5.0d0   0.001d0      ! [eV] acceptance window for nonadiabatic coupling; [eV] tolerance for quasidegenerate levels
0   -50.0   1.0      ! quenching (0=no, 1=yes); starting from when [fs]; how often [fs]
0   1500.0   50.0     ! Berendsen thermostat for atoms (0=no, 1=yes); bath temperature [K]; cooling time [fs]
0   1500.0   50.0     ! Berendsen thermostat for electrons (0=no, 1=yes); bath temperature [K]; cooling time [fs]
15.0d0           ! [eV] cut-off energy in MC (<0 means Ecut=top of CB)
1.0d30           ! [eV] work function, for electron emission (>0 eV; <0 - number of collisions)
0                ! printout electron energy levels (1) or not (0)
0   0.1   1      ! printout DOS (0=no,1=Gamma,2=k-points); smearing of gaussian; print PDOS yes (1) or no (0)
0                ! printout Mulliken charges for types of atoms
0   1.0 100.0  !fa!   0.02   1.0   ! fe: N, dE, Emax: N = 0=no, 1=fe on Ei(TB), -1 orb., 2=fe, -2=fs on grid only, 3=incl.orb. (opt: dEa, Eamax)
0           ! printout atomic pair correlation function (1) or not (0)
1   qe       ! printout atomic positions in XYZ (1) or not (0); additionally: q=charge, e=E_kin, m=mass
0           ! printout atomic positions in CIF (1) or not (0)
0           ! printout raw data file OUTPUT_coordinates_and_velosities.dat (1) or not (0)
name:all    power:1     !Atomic_masks.txt    ! displacement to print out (set integer N: <[R(t)-R(t=0)]^N>) or filename
1.7e0       ! printout numbers of nearest neighbors within the given radius (<=0 No, >0 = radius in [A])
png          ! which format to use to plot figures: eps, jpeg, gif, png, pdf
3*1          ! number of k-points in each direction (used only for Trani-k!)
!probe
4   1   1.0d-1   40.0d0   1.0d-1   ! optic coefs: 0=no, 1=Drude, 2=Trani-k, 3=Gamma, 4=KG; spectr (1) w/ KK (2), or no (0); min, max, d_hw (eV)
2   800.0    -10.0    ! how many rays (0=exclude, 1=1st ray, (>1)=sum all); probe-pulse wavelength [nm]; FWHM probe pulse [fs]
0.0     50.0d0       ! angle of prob-pulse with respect to normal [degrees]; material thickness [nm]
!size
!0.8     2.0 100
```

Figure VI.3. NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt (or optional lines in INPUT.txt after the flag NUMERICS) example.

Line 1: the number of unit-cells used in the code along each direction X, Y, Z. If one unit cell contains Nat atoms, the total number of atoms in the supercell will be **Ntot**=Nat*Nx*Ny*Nz.

Note: The numbers should be above 0.

Line 2: three integer numbers specify conditions at surfaces along X, Y, and Z axes:

0 creates an open surface along the axis (by adding empty space around the sample),

1 means periodic boundaries. For example: 1 1 0 means periodic boundaries along X and Y, but free boundary along Z (thin layer of material).

2 is absorbing/sticky boundaries (freezing atoms that cross the boundary with this condition)

3 sets reflecting boundary (absolutely elastic collisions with the box boundaries)

4 means white boundaries (reflecting in a random direction, preserving energy but randomizing the momentum of the atom crossing boundary)

Note #1: Non-periodic simulation uses a periodic boundary in a supercell, in which the sample is surrounded by empty space. The code increases the size of the simulation box by 50 times its given value and places the atoms in the middle.

Note #2: Any non-periodic boundary (2-4) only specifies the conditions for the atoms crossing the boundary, but all the forces in the simulation are still calculated assuming periodic boundaries (hypertorus geometry of the simulation box). As a result, the total energy is not conserved in these types of simulations.

Line 3: May use one or three columns (one mandatory, and two optional):

a. Column 1: flag (character), specifying which cross sections to use in the MC module. The following flags are supported:

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Flag	Meaning
BEB, EADL, EPICS	Using atomic EPICS database for atomic ionization potentials, photoabsorption cross sections (and other atomic parameters); and BEB inelastic scattering cross sections for electrons [54,123]
CDF	Use cdf-file to read atomic parameters and the CDF-parameters from; CDF-based cross-section (Ritchie-Howie formalism) for inelastic electron scattering cross sections is used [48]
CDF_sp, CDFsp	Use single-pole approximation, which automatically constructs the Ritchie-Howie CDF for electron inelastic scattering [53]; the same CDF is used to construct photon-absorption attenuation length
CDF:EADL, CDF:EPICS	Means single-pole approximation is used for electron scattering; EPICD database is used for photon absorption, and for atomic parameters

Note #1: that only single-pole approximation can be interpreted consistently with EPICS database; cdf-file may not be consistent with it, and thus it is not possible to use cdf file for electron scattering while using EPICS database for atomic parameters and photoabsorption.

b. Column 2 (optional): the materials bandgap in [eV]; this value is used if single-pole approximation for CDF is specified. In this case, the bandgap value is required for using CDF cross sections – without it, XTANT-3 will use an atomic energy level, which is a very poor approximation for the bandgap of a material.
Note #2: the provided value is unused in case of BEB cross section, since for consistency it requires the atomic energy levels, and won't work correctly with others.

c. Column 3 (optional): name of the cdf-file (character). This column may specify a full path to the file with cdf, or a name of the cdf-file to be found in the directory with the input material data (if this file name does not have an extension, the default extension '.cdf' will be assumed). If this column is not provided, or the file with the given name is not found, the default name of the cdf-file is checked: [*material*].cdf (see below, Section 8)1)f).
If no file with CDF is found, the single-pole approximation will be used, with the coefficients automatically fitted, following the procedure described in Ref. [53].

Note #3: specifying 'CDF', but no file and no bandgap (using atomic ionization potential) results in cross sections close to BEB, which means it has no advantages, but much slower calculations (because CDF cross section employ numerical integration, whereas BEB has analytical solution). So, this option is not recommended for use – instead, provide a correct band gap, this will provide significant advantage over the BEB cross-sections, since CDF-formalism accounts for collective effects, and thus describes solids much better than the atomic approximation.

Line 4: the density of the material in [g/cm^3] to be used in the MC simulations. This value overwrites the default value given in the cdf-file (see below) if set positive. If you wish to use

the default value (defined by the number of atoms and size of the supercell), set here any negative number (this must be the default choice).

Line 5: number of iterations to be performed within the Monte Carlo module. A small number of iterations gives not smooth curves. Too large numbers give too long computation times. The optimal value empirically determined is ~2,000,000/(Dose * Ntot).

Note #1: large values here result in large arrays taking a lot of memory. In case you don't need MC simulations but only TBMD, set here 0 or 1.

Line 6: number of threads used for parallel calculation via OpenMP. Set 1 for nonparallel calculations. Set any non-positive number to make it automatically equal to the number of available threads on your machine.

Line 7: which MD integrator to use: 0 = velocity Verlet algorithm (2^d order) [81], 1=Yoshida algorithm (4th order; *it is ~4 times slower than Verlet*) [82], 2 = Martyna predictor-corrector algorithm (4th order, *about as fast as Verlet*) [83]. The default option is 2.

Note #1: Martyna's algorithm is included only for atomic coordinates, while for the supercell vectors, Verlet is used (2d order).

Line 8: This line specifies whether atoms should be allowed to move or not. There are two options to do so:

Option one: set here an integer number for:

exclude the MD module, freezing the atoms in their equilibrium positions (if set 0), or allow the atoms to move (set 1). The default option is 1.

Option two: set here a file name with the specified mask of which atoms should be frozen, and which should be moving normally (*note, this option is experimental and quite inefficient*).

In the case of option two, the file with the provided name must be present in the directory INPUT_DATA. The file must be constructed as follows:

Line 1 must specify how many different masks or filters for atoms will be defined below. After that, the number of blocks must be equal to the number of masks specified. Each block must be defined according to the fortran namelists specifications, in the following format (see example below):

```
&Freeze_masks
Filter%z_min = 0.5d0          ! Atoms with Z-coordinates below this value will be frozen
Filter%z_max = 6.5d0          ! Atoms with Z-coordinates above this value will be frozen
/
```

(Note that it must start with the definition of the block as &Freeze_masks and end with the slash).

The following keywords for freezing atoms are available in the type "Filter":

x_min – atoms with the x-coordinates (in [Å]) smaller than this value will be frozen.
x_max – atoms with the x-coordinates (in [Å]) larger than this value will be frozen.
y_min – atoms with the y-coordinates (in [Å]) smaller than this value will be frozen.
y_max – atoms with the y-coordinates (in [Å]) larger than this value will be frozen.
z_min – atoms with the z-coordinates (in [Å]) smaller than this value will be frozen.
z_max – atoms with the z-coordinates (in [Å]) larger than this value will be frozen.
sx_min – atoms with the relative x-coordinates (in supercell units) smaller than this value will be frozen.
sx_max– atoms with the relative x-coordinates (in supercell units) larger than this value will be frozen.
sy_min – atoms with the relative y-coordinates (in supercell units) smaller than this value will be frozen.
sy_max – atoms with the relative y-coordinates (in supercell units) larger than this value will be frozen.

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sz_min – atoms with the relative z-coordinates (in supercell units) smaller than this value will be frozen.
sz_max – atoms with the relative z-coordinates (in supercell units) larger than this value will be frozen.
KOA – atoms of the given king will be frozen (index specifies number of the atom in the chemical formula).
r_center(:) – to specify the radial center (3 coordinates), from which the radial distance should be counted (in [Å]).
r_min – atoms with the radial coordinate (in [Å]) smaller than this, counted from the given center, will be frozen.
r_max – atoms with the radial coordinate (in [Å]) larger than this, counted from the given center, will be frozen.

Line 9: the effective mass of the super-cell in [atomic mass] used in the framework of the Parrinello-Rahman MD [92] (only used in case of constant-pressure simulation, see below).

Line 10: time-step for the MD calculations.

It can be set in two ways:

a. Constant time-step: write any real(8) number of dt in [fs]. The default value is 0.1 fs (or smaller for P=const simulations, see below), but in some simulations can be as large as 1 fs or even larger (especially for V=const simulations). Larger steps can lead to instabilities, smaller steps conserve energy better but run the program slower.

b. Variable time-step: write here a name of a file where the array of timesteps is provided. The file must be present in the same folder INPUT_DATA. The file must contain two columns. First column: time instant in [fs], when to change the timestep to the one given in the second column.

E.g., if the file contains the following lines:
-1.0e10 1.0
-50 0.2
100 0.5
At the first timestep of the simulation, the timestep is set to 1.0 fs. At the time instant of -50 fs, the timestep is changed to 0.2 fs. At the time instant of 100 fs, it is changed to 0.5 fs.

Note: the file cannot contain empty lines, those will not be interpreted correctly.

Line 11: time step how often the output data files must be saved in [fs] of the simulation time. Does not have to be equal to the MD time step, and can be larger to sparse the output data (but cannot be smaller). The default choice is 1 fs.

Line 12: here 1 means constant pressure simulations (P=const; Parrinello-Rahman scheme of the super-cell motion, NPH ensemble); 0 means constant volume (V=const, NVE ensemble) [133]. For femtosecond dynamics, V=const (0) is the default choice.

Line 13: external pressure applied (set 0 to use for normal atmospheric pressure). Used only in case of P=const simulation.

Line 14: contains 3 numbers to set self-consistent-charge (SCC) calculations parameters:

a. Column 1: to use or not the SCC (*T* or *F* - for True or False)

this option works only with the Born-Oppenheimer approximation (option 3 in the next line), but not with any other simulation scheme, so cannot be combined with irradiation!

b. Column 2: which model for gamma to use: -1 is bare Coulomb (*do not use, only for testing*)

0 = Wolf's method of softly truncated Coulomb (this is the default choice) [134]

1 = Klopman-Ohno [77]

2 = Mataga-Nishimoto [77]

c. Column 3: mixing factor for self-consistent calculations: weight of the new charge in the next iteration. Recommended values are between 0.2 and 0.7. Smaller values lead to too slow convergence, whereas higher values may not converge at all. The empirically found optimal value is 0.35, which should be the default choice.

Note #1: the default option must be *F* (no SCC). It should only be used with TB parameterizations that are specifically fitted to account for SCC (such as 3TB, and some of DFTB parameterizations) and with BO simulation *only*, while in most cases, the parameterizations cannot account for the SCC effects, and including this option may lead to qualitatively incorrect potentials.

Line 15: contains 4 numbers:

a. The first one describes which scheme of simulation to use:

0 sets a scheme of decoupled electrons and ions, with instant electron thermalization (something like Two-Temperature Model).

1 sets enforced total energy conservation. *Obsolete, do not use!*

2 sets here fixed electron temperature instead of total energy (*does not work well with a pulse on or with an electron-ion coupling on, use only for tests of unirradiated material*).

3 uses the true Born-Oppenheimer (BO) scheme – constant electron populations.

Note #1: if the laser pulse is on, the populations will change; also, if the electron-phonon coupling is on, it will affect the populations, so the simulation instead of BO will be Ehrenfest-like dynamics.

4 uses the relaxation time approximation to trace the evolution of the electron distribution function. *This should be the default choice.*

5 uses the electron-electron Boltzmann collision integral to trace the evolution of the electron distribution function (see Eqs.(20)-(22)). *Unfinished, not recommended for use!*

The next columns depend on the model choice made in the first column.

b. If "4" used in the first column, then:

The second number sets the characteristic relaxation time in [fs], used in the relaxation-time approximation only.

Note #1: To turn the simulation into instantaneous thermalization (equivalent to option 0 in "a", the Two-Temperature-Model conditions), set here time = 0.0e0 (*this is the default choice*). To turn the simulation into Ehrenfest-like (or BO, if the electron-ion coupling is off), set here infinite time, e.g., 1.0e20.

If "5" used in the first column, then:

The second number sets the number of extra steps in-between the MD time-steps to use for integration of the electron-electron Boltzmann collision integral. *The default choice is 1.0 (no extra steps)*.

c. If "4" used in the first column, then:

The third number sets the characteristic relaxation time of electrons in the conduction band (CB) in [fs], used in the relaxation-time approximation only.

If "5" used in the first column, then:

The third and fourth columns together set if the output of the partial valence band and conduction band electrons temperatures, chemical potentials, and distribution functions, should be printed out: set any positive value; to exclude printing out partial electron band parameters, set negative values in 3^{d} or 4th columns.

d. If "4" used in the first column, then:

The fourth number sets the characteristic relaxation time of electrons in the valence band (VB) in [fs], used in the relaxation-time approximation only.

Note #1: the separate band-resolved thermalization times are only meaningful in bandgap materials (semiconductors or insulators); to switch the separate thermalization off, set any negative number in the third or fourth number.

Note #2: to leave only the separate band-resolved thermalization, but not the interband thermalization, set the second number to a very large number, and use only the 3^{d} and 4th numbers to set separate thermalizations.

Note #3: one may model instantaneous thermalization in each band separately, by setting 3^{d} and 4th numbers equal to zero, but finite time (or infinite) by setting a positive number in the 2^{d} position (interband thermalization) – this setup results in the Three-Temperature Model: different temperatures for excited electrons (in the conduction band), holes (valence-band electrons), and atoms.

Line 16: One or two columns defining the parameters of the nonadiabatic coupling model. The 1st one defines, which electron-phonon coupling to use:

0 means no coupling included;

-1 generalization of dynamical coupling as described in Ref.[3] (this must be the default choice);

1 means first-order dynamical coupling as described in Ref.[135];

2 uses Fermi's Golden Rule, which might overestimate the coupling rate (*do not use*).

The 2^{d} column is optional, it defines which atomic distribution to use in the collision integral (coupling):

0 means Maxwellian distribution with equivalent (kinetic) temperature

1 means counting number of atoms with energies above the transferred ones in the simulation box (transient nonequilibrium distribution; *does not exactly equilibrate, most likely due to final-number-of-atoms effects; not recommended for use*)

2 means using delta-functional distribution for atoms, restoring each individual atom contribution to the coupling, and thus tracing and delivering the transferred energy to each atom individually (may not obey momentum conservation, but could be important in case of strongly nonequilibrium atomic system, such as an ion impact simulations).

If the second number of absent, the default option 0 is used (for back-compatibility with earlier format of the input).

Line 17: Coupling model; has two numbers:

a. Sets the time, when the nonadiabatic coupling switches on (for test purposes, one can first thermalize the system, and only later let it exchange energy). The default choice for real simulations: 1d-3.

b. Set the scaling factor for coupling calculations. For numerical reasons, must be equal to 4.0 for producing correct results with dynamical coupling. Can be smaller to artificially reduce coupling in the calculations of the coupling parameter (as described in section Calculation of electron-ion coupling parameter g(Te), Ce(Te), μ(Te)), but the results must then be rescaled back manually!

Line 18: The coupling model (continuation); contains two numbers:

a. acceptance window for nonadiabatic coupling in [eV]. It excludes electron transitions between the levels separated by more than this specified value. E.g. set 5 eV by default to separate over-band-gap nonadiabatic transitions in diamond.

b. tolerance for quasi-degenerate levels in [eV]. It excludes transitions between too-close levels, separated by smaller energy than this given number, to exclude degenerate states. The default value is 0.001 eV.

Line 19: Quenching; three numbers here specify:

The first number defines whether to include artificial quenching, (0=no, 1=yes), the 'yes'-option must be used *only* for relaxation or the construction of amorphous materials. Any 'real' simulation must have 0 here. 'Yes' here means that once in a time-step specified by the next numbers of the line, atomic velocities will be set to zero. Similar to the method known as "zero-temperature molecular dynamics".

The second number in this line is defining when to start cooling from in [fs].

The third number means how often set the atomic velocities to zero (in [fs]).

Line 20: Berendsen thermostat for atoms; it can be set in two ways:

Option #1: If three numbers are given here, they define a simple model (rate equation) for artificial cooling mimicking transport effects [136], using the Berendsen thermostat [91]:

First number: include electron heat transport out of the atomic system (1), or not (0).

Second number: in case there is transport, sets the atomic bath temperature towards which the cooling/heating will be made until temperatures equilibration in [K].

The third one is the characteristic time of cooling/heating of atoms in [fs].

Option #2: If a file name is given here, the file with the parameters of the Berendsen thermostat must be provided in the directory INPUT_DATA. The file may contain an arbitrary number of lines. Each line must specify 3 parameters:

First column: time of simulation in [fs], when to switch to the Berendsen thermostat parameters given in the next two numbers.

Second column: the atomic thermostat temperature [K].

Third column: the characteristic time of the Berendsen thermostat for atoms in [fs].

E.g., if the file contains the following lines:

-1.0e10 300 1.0e15

0.0 500 100.0

100 1000 700.0

It will be interpreted as follows: at the beginning of the simulation (at a time larger than -1.0e10 fs), the thermostat is off (essentially infinite characteristic time, 1.0e15 fs). Then, at the time instant of 0.0 fs, it switches on with the bath temperature of 500 K and the characteristic time of 100 fs. At the time instant of 100 fs, it changes to the bath temperature of 1000 K and characteristic time of 700 fs.

Note: to switch off the thermostat, set either infinite coupling time (>1e14) or negative bath temperature.

Note #2: the file cannot contain empty lines, those will not be interpreted correctly.

Line 21: Berendsen thermostat for electrons; it can be set in two ways, analogous to the atomic thermostat:

Option #1: If three numbers are given here, they define a simple model (rate equation) for artificial cooling mimicking transport effects [136], using the Berendsen thermostat [91]:

First number: include electron heat transport out of the electronic system (1), or not (0).

Second number: in case there is transport, sets the electronic bath temperature towards which the cooling/heating will be made until temperatures equilibration in [K].

The third one is the characteristic time of electronic cooling/heating in [fs].

Option #2: If a file name is given here, the file with the parameters of the Berendsen thermostat must be provided in the directory INPUT_DATA. The file may contain an arbitrary number of lines. Each line must specify 3 parameters:

First column: time of simulation in [fs], when to switch to the Berendsen thermostat parameters given in the next two numbers.

Second column: the electronic thermostat temperature [K].

Third column: the characteristic time of the Berendsen thermostat for electrons in [fs].

Note that if an electronic thermostat is used, it will equilibrate the electronic distribution function towards the given temperature, and electronic nonequilibrium simulation is thus affected.

Note 2: to switch off the thermostat, set either infinite coupling time (>1e14) or negative bath temperature.

Note 3: the file cannot contain empty lines, those will not be interpreted correctly.

Line 22: energy cut-off in [eV] that separates the low-energy and high-energy subspaces for electrons within MC and Boltzmann-equation [5]. The default value is 10 eV. If set negative, it uses dynamical evolution of the cut-off, adjusting it to the transient top-most CB level at each time-step (*only meaningful for small basis sets that do not include a lot of CB orbitals*).

Line 23: the work function, setting whether we want to allow for electron emission and build-up of an unbalanced charge in the system, which may lead to a Coulomb explosion. If the work function here is set higher than 1.0d25 [eV], no emission will take place. This must be the default choice.

a. If the work function is set smaller, an electron with energy above the set number will be considered emitted from the sample and will disappear from the calculations (will forever stay in the high-energy domain, making no collisions).

b. If the work function is set to a negative value, another model for electron emission is used: an electron is considered to be emitted after a certain number of collisions that is specified by the absolute value of the number set in this line. E.g. if -2.0 is set here, an electron will be emitted after performing 2 collisions (unless is falls below the cut-off energy and joins the low-energy fraction).

c. If electrons are emitted, it builds up an uncompensated charge for the atomic system, inducing additional Coulomb repulsion of atoms (ions), if a file with Coulomb parameterization is present (see below) [87].

Line 24: to print out electron energy levels (eigenvalues of the TB Hamiltonian) as output (set 1) or not (set 0) at each saving time step. *Produces large files.*

Line 25: the three numbers here specify parameters of the density of states, DOS, and calculations at each saving time step:

First column: First number sets: to calculate total DOS or not. Use the following parameters: (0) exclude DOS calculations; (1) calculate DOS on the *k*-points grid set below (in line 35).

Second column: spreading to use for constructing the DOS out of the discrete energy levels in [eV].

Third column: to printout partial DOS (PDOS) for the atomic shells of each element in the compound (1), or not (0).

Line 26: to save Mulliken charges for types of atoms (set 1), or not (set 0)

Line 27: Defining the distribution functions of electrons and atoms to print out.

Definition of the electron distribution: First three numbers defining printout of the electron distribution function at each saving timestep.

a. First is the flag that defines what to print out:

0 means no printing out of electron distribution (this should be the default choice because printing out the distribution produces large files, which are usually unnecessary);

1 means to printout the electron populations on the energy levels only (below E_{cutoff});

-1 means to printout the electron populations on the energy levels only (below E_{cutoff}) and orbital-resolved distribution according to the basis set used (each atomic type and each orbital, e.g., sp^3d^5);

2 means to also printout the electron distribution on a grid with the parameters set in the other two numbers in this line (produces twice the large files; not recommended to be used);

-2 means to printout only the distribution on the given grid, with the parameters defined by the two other numbers in this line;

3 means printout all three types of the distributions: on the energy levels, orbital-resolved, and on the grid;

-3 means printout only the orbital-resolved distribution, and the one on the grid, but not the total one on the energy-levels.

b. The second number in the line defines the step in the energy grid in [eV], on which the distribution is printed out if flag 2 or -2 is set.
c. The third number defines the maximal energy for the grid in [eV], used if the flag 2 or -2 is set.

Most of the time, it is not necessary, thus use the default value 0. Option 1 is useful in case of nonequilibrium electron distributions, such as BO or relaxation-time approximation simulation. Option -2 is useful for modeling the electron emission. Option 2 may be useful for code development and debugging. Option -1 is only useful to check electronic distributions in orbital-resolved calculations.

After that, the atomic distribution function printout may be defined (optional):

a. The flat to printout atomic distribution: 'fa ' (3 characters). If exactly this flag is specified, atomic distribution will be printed out, if not – not.
b. Energy grid step for atomic distribution in [eV] (real, optional). If no step specified, the default value of 0.01 eV is used.
c. Maximal energy in the grid in [eV] (real, optional). If no value is specified, the default value of 10 eV is used.

Line 28: to save the atomic pair correlation function (set 1), or not (set 0) at each saving timestep. Produces large files. Most of the time, it is not necessary, thus the default value is 0.

Line 29: Line defining the printout of XYZ format. May contain two columns:

Column #1: (integer) defining the format of the output atomic coordinates in the extended XYZ-format[22] .

Here, 0 means to exclude XYZ printout.

[22] See description here: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/XYZ_file_format (in XTANT-3, the extended format defined in OVITO is used, in which the comment line is used to specify the supercell size and parameters for coordinates, see https://www.ovito.org/docs/current/reference/file_formats/input/xyz.html)

1 means printout atomic trajectories in the extended XYZ-format. This format is used for plotting and making movies of atomic positions e.g. with VMD[23], OVITO[24] , or a similar program.

2 means printout the atomic trajectories, and also SAVE files, in XYZ format.

3 means printout the atomic trajectories, SAVE files, and also atomic velocities in the XYZ format.

-1 means printout only the SAVE files in XYZ format instead of the internal XTANT format, but no atomic trajectories or velocities in XYZ format.

Column #2: (character) a flag defining if additional atomic parameters need to be printed out. May include the following flags:

m: to printout atomic mass.

q: to printout atomic charge (Mulliken charge for each atom).

e: to printout atomic kinetic energy.

For example, if the user wants to save XYZ file and additionally include kinetic energy and charge in it, the line 29 may look like:

1 qe ! comment: printout XYZ-file with the charge and the kinetic energy included

Note #1: the second column is optional. By default, no additional output is included, with only atomic coordinates in the XYZ file.

Line 30: save atomic positions additionally in CIF-format[25] (set 1), or not (0). This format is used for powder diffraction patterns calculations e.g. with Mercury[26] software.

Line 31: to save raw data file OUTPUT_coordinates_and_velosities.dat (1) or not (0). This file is necessary for post-analysis calculations of atomic velocity autocorrelations and phonon spectra (see below). If not needed, do not save it, as it produces very large files.

Line 32: defines the mean displacement parameters. It can be done in 3 ways:

Option #1: sets *N* (integer number), the power of mean displacement to print out (set integer *N*: <u^*N*>-<u_0^*N*>). For example, for mean square displacement, set 2.

Option #2: set here a character line defining the mask for atoms to use. The mask definition can use 2 of the following keywords, followed by the parameters separated by the colon:

name – defining the name of the atomic mask. The name starting with 'all' defines that all atoms are included in this mask.

power – defining the *N*, the power of mean displacement to print out.

For example, the following line can be used to print out the mean displacements:

name:all power:1

[23] VMD: http://www.ks.uiuc.edu/Research/vmd/
[24] OVITO: https://www.ovito.org/
[25] See description here: http://www.iucr.org/resources/cif
[26] Mercury: https://www.ccdc.cam.ac.uk/solutions/csd-system/components/mercury/

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

If option#2 is used, the mean displacements along X, Y, and Z axes will also be printed out (for each kind of atom in the compound).

Option #3: filename can be provided here, in which the definition of several atomic masks can be given (see an example in **Figure VI.4**). The file with the provided name must be present in the INPUT_DATA directory.

```
MASK    2
name:all    power:2
name:section    power:1
3.5<Z
```

Figure VI.4. Example of optional file defining two atomic masks: all and section of atoms in the bottom of the supercell.

Inside the file, masks can be defined in the following format:

Line 1: keyword 'MASK', and the number of masks (integer).

For example, to specify two masks, use the line

MASK 2

Line 2 may contain the options defining the mask. The following keywords are supported:

power – defining the *N*, the power of mean displacement to print out.

name – defining the name of the atomic mask.

The name starting with 'all' defines that all atoms are included in this mask.

The name starting with 'section' defines spatial section of the simulation box to be included in this mask. If the mask name includes the word 'Section' in it, there must be another line included under it, defining the spatial section. Currently, only the cartesian sections are supported.

The following format of the section can be used:

Line 3 (for 'section' option):

Maximum of three columns may be used separated by semicolon. Each column may set the section along each axis specified by a corresponding inequality, where the numbers are in [Å].

For example, to select the bottom half of the supercell, it suffices to use only one column defining the values of Z-coordinates:

Z<6.0 (for a supercell of size 12 Å)

For a central section of the supercell, section along all three axes can be defined:

1.5<X<9; 2<Y<7 ; 1.5<Z<8.4

For a section of atoms at the borders of the supercell, logical 'or' can be used in defining the section:

X<1.0 or X>10.0; 1.0>Y or Y>10.0

Also, logical 'and' is allowed to use to combine sections, if needed.

Note #1: only one logical 'or' or 'and' per column is currently allowed.

Note #2: 'or' and 'and' currently cannot be combined – the same operator must be used for all axes (e.g., option X>1 and X<10; Y<1 or Y>10 would not work; instead, set it as 1<X<10; Y<1 or Y>10).

Name #3: if a few masks are provided with the same name, a number will be added to the mask name, and the corresponding output files.

Line 33: save numbers of nearest neighbors within the given radius: to exclude optional set a number <0, a number >0 means the radius within which the atoms are considered to be neighbors in the units of [Å].

Alternatively, a filename may be provided here, specifying the file in the directory INPUT_DATA, with the file where chemical-element resolved radii may be provided. The file with the element specific radii must contain 2 columns:

Column #1 must contain the chemical element name (character(3)) from the periodic table.

Column #2 must provide the radius in [Å].

The chemical elements do not necessarily have to be in the same order as in the chemical formulae provided; also, not all of them may be present, if you only want to print out some elements but not the others.

If the input file option is used, the average radius for printing out the total average number of nearest neighbors is then calculated as the weighted average of the provided radii with the stoichiometry of the given chemical formula of the compound.

For example, for Al_2O_3 the following file may be used:

Al 2.42
O 1.32
Where, for this example, doubled valent radius of the atoms is used.

Line 34: may contain one, two or three columns (all character), defining the format of the output plots.

The first column is mandatory, it sets the format to plot output figures. If gnuplot is used for plotting, the following formats are supported: eps, jpeg, gif, png, pdf.

If no plots are requested (e.g., if your system has no gnuplot and no python), one can use keyword “no” in this line in the first or second column.

The second column (optional) may set to use gnuplot (ketword ‘gnu’) or python (keyword ‘py’) for preparing the output script. Gnuplot is the legacy format, and thus is used by default, if the second column is not present. Python scripts support all the formats that matplotlib.pyplot.savefig can export to.

The third column (optional) sets the output of animated figures to be used. It can only be animated gif for Gnuplot (default option); python scripts support ‘gif’, ‘mp4’, ‘avi’, ‘mov’, and ‘mkv’ formats, creating them with help of FFmpeg (which must be installed in your system to create videos automatically[27]).

[27] For Windows, follow the instructions for installations in https://www.gyan.dev/ffmpeg/builds/ - for example, it can be installed from the command line with the command: winget install "FFmpeg (Essentials Build)"

For example, if you want XTANT-3 to created python scripts for plots, to save the plots in png format, and animated plots in mp4 format, use the following line here:

png py mp4

Note #1: on Windows, the python scripts are run by XTANT-3 with the command "python", on Linux it uses "python3".

Line 35: contains three numbers (integers): numbers of k-points in each direction x, y, z; used only with the 'Trani-k' or 'Kubo-Greenwood' options (numbers 2, 4 or 5 in line 12 in the file INPUT_MATERIAL.txt), and ignored with other options.

Note #1: all numbers must be odd for more reliable results, even numbers do not work well.

Note #2: FORTRAN allows specifying repeating numbers in the input by using "*" (times) symbol; e.g., the line

3*5

is equivalent to

5 5 5

Line 36: This and the next lines are optional, each block may be written in arbitrary order or skipped altogether (recommended). The optional blocks allow the user to set model-specific data, and to overwrite the default atomic data, such as the atomic mass, Auger decay times, kinetic energies of shell electrons, electronic populations, and the name of the element if needed. The default values are taken from the EPICS database, and recommended for use, so only replace them if you are absolutely sure of what you are doing.

- DRUDE: to set the parameters of the Drude optical model (if in the file INPUT_DATA above, option "Probe" is set to use the Drude model for the calculation of the optical coefficients of the probe pulse). The following lines must be exactly in the following order and format:

Line Op1: DRUDE – the keyword, indicating that the following three lines set the parameters of the Drude model

Line Op2: two real numbers: initial values on unexcited materials optical coefficients *n* and *k*.

Line Op3: two real numbers: effective mass of the conduction band electrons and valence band holes [in units of the free-electron mass].

Line Op4: two real numbers: mean scattering times of electrons and holes in [fs].

- MASS: To replace an atomic mass, the following block of data must be used:

Line Op1: MASS – the keyword, indicating that the following line defines the atomic mass

Line Op2: must contain two numbers: *atom* (integer), and *mass* (real).

The *atom* must correspond to the number of the element in the used compound, as defined by the chemical formula in line 2 of the file 'INPUT_MATERIAL.txt'. For elemental targets, the number 1 still must be present.

The *mass* sets the mass of the element in the atomic mass units. See the example of a compound SiAu, setting the mass of Au (element #2) to "infinity" (1.0d30), in **Figure VI.5**. Note that such a mass

will essentially freeze all the atoms of the chosen element (which will not speed up the calculations, since the force is still calculated for them, just they are too heavy to move).

```
MASS
2   1.0d30

NO_AUGER

AUGER
1       1       1d25
```

Figure VI.5. Example of optional lines in the file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt

- NAME: to replace the name of the element, the following block of data must be used:

Line Op1: NAME – the keyword, indicating that the following line defines the name of the element

Line Op2: must contain two numbers: *atom* (integer), *name* (character(3)).
The *atom* is analogous to the one from the block MASS above.
The *name* sets the new name of the element.

- NO_AUGER: to switch off all Auger decays in the MC module, use the one-line option NO_AUGER, see an example in **Figure VI.5**.

- AUGER: to replace Auger decay times of selected shells of selected elements, use the optional block (see an example in **Figure VI.5**):

Line Op1: AUGER – the keyword indicating overwriting of Auger decay times in this block.

Line Op2: three numbers: *atom* (integer), *shell* (integer), *time* (real) [fs].

The number *atom* sets the number of the element in the compound, analogously to the block MASS above, following the numbers set in the chemical formula in the input file.

The number *shell* sets the atomic shell, for which the Auger decay time must be replaced. The shell indices are printed out in the output file !OUTPUT_[*material*]_Parameters.txt, see below. The index of the shell must coincide with the number printed out in this file.

The number *time* sets the Auger decay time for the given shell of the given element in [fs].

- Ip: to replace ionization potentials of selected shells of selected elements, use the optional block:

Line Op1: Ip – the keyword indicating overwriting of ionization potentials in this block.

Line Op2: three numbers: *atom* (integer), *shell* (integer), *ionization_potential* (real).

The numbers *atom* and *shell* are analogous to those in the block Auger (see above).

The *ionization_potential* sets the ionization potential in the shell in [eV].

- Ek: to replace the kinetic energy of electrons in selected shells of selected elements (this value is only used in the BEB cross sections in the MC module), use the optional block:

Line Op1: Ek – the keyword indicating overwriting of kinetic energies in this block.

Line Op2: three numbers: *atom* (integer), *shell* (integer), *kinetic_energy* (real).

The numbers *atom* and *shell* are analogous to those in the block Auger (see above).

The *kinetic_energy* sets the kinetic energy of electrons in the shell in [eV].

- Ne: to replace the number of electrons in selected shells of selected elements (electron population of the atomic shell), use the optional block:

Line Op1: Ne – the keyword indicating overwriting of electronic populations in this block.

Line Op2: three numbers: *atom* (integer), *shell* (integer), *population* (real).

The numbers *atom* and *shell* are analogous to those in the block Auger (see above).

The *population* sets the number of electrons in the shell of a given element.

3. Executing consecutive runs of the program automatically

If you want to run XTANT-3 program several times in a raw with different parameters (useful, e.g., for finding damage threshold by varying only the pulse fluence while keeping all others parameters the same, or for calculations of electron-phonon coupling parameter vs. electronic temperature), you can (apart from setting corresponding optional parameters in the INPUT file) create several input files – either automatically (see below), or manually in the following manner:

1) Manual creation of multiple input files:

The first simulation run will use as input files INPUT_MATERIAL.txt (or INPUT.txt) and possibly NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt

After the end of the simulation, the program will check the presence of the next input files in the same folder named with consecutive integer numbers at the end of file names:

INPUT_MATERIAL_1.txt (or INPUT_1.txt) and possibly NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS_1.txt

If they are present, XTANT-3 will read the data from these files and start the simulation over from the beginning automatically. The next automatic simulation run must have the next integer number at the end of the files (…_2), and so on.

Note #1: that if the file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS_1.txt with the numerical parameters for the second run is absent, XTANT-3 will use the original file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt instead. So, if the numerical parameters are identical in the simulation runs, there is no need to copy the same file – the original file will be reused.

Note #2: if the numerical parameters are provided in the INPUT_PARAMETER.txt (or INPUT.txt), the file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt is unnecessary (as well as its numbered copies).

Note #3: if in the INPUT_PARAMETER.txt (or INPUT.txt) file you set a grid for the absorbed dose, several input files will be created automatically with the varying doses, corresponding to the grid given. In this case, all existing numbered files (INPUT_MATERIAL_*i*.txt (or INPUT_*i*.txt) and possibly NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS_*i*.txt) will be overwritten, so make sure there is no conflict between the pre-existing files and the given dose or coupling grid.

2) Automatic creation of multiple input files:

To create copies of the INPUT.txt with only a few lines modified, you can specify how many copies to create, and what lines should be replaced, in an optional file Copy_input.txt, placed in the same directory as INPUT.txt.

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

The file Copy_input.txt must contain blocks of data with the following lines:

Line #1: 'new' or 'copy', which specifies the beginning of the block with the lines to be replaced in a copy of the INPUT.txt file. XTANT-3 will create as many copies of the input files, as there are lines containing the flag 'new' (or 'copy'), each file named INPUT_*i*.txt, as described above.

Line #2 and all the other lines within the block: must contain two columns:

Column #1 (integer) sets the number of the line to be replaced in the file INPUT.txt that you are using (which may differ, depending on the optional words and blocks used, see above).

Column #2 (character) specifies the line to be used as the replacement instead of the corresponding line in the file INPUT.txt.

For example, in file shown in Figure VI.6, two copies of the input file will be created. In the first one (INPUT_1.txt), the first line will be replaced with 'Aluminum', the second one with 'Al', the line #26 (which in this example is responcible for setting number of unit-cells in the block NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS) will be replaced with '3 2 2', and the line 60 will be replaced with '3*1', setting the number of k-points. The second file (INPUT_2.txt) will be created with only first two lines replaced, setting Gold as the material to be modelled.

```
1   new
2   1   Aluminum
3   2   Al
4   26  3   2   2       ! number of unit-cells in X,Y,Z
5   60  3*1         ! number of k-points in each direction (used only for Trani-k!)
6
7   new
8   1   Gold
9   2   Au
```

Figure VI.6. Example of file Copy_input.txt

Note #1: It is allowed to replace as many lines as necessary. Up to 100 copies of INPUT.txt may be created *via* this method of automatic copying *via* the file Copy_input.txt.

4. Folder [*material name*]

Folders with material parameters, named exactly as the material name given above in the file INPUT_MATERIAL.txt (or INPUT.txt), contain several files describing necessary material parameters for the simulation.

Do not change these files, unless you want to change the properties of the material!

Folders with the files for already created materials are typically already set, and the user does not need to worry about them. If you want to create a new material, create it by example of already existing folders.

a) [*A*]_[*A*]_TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt and [*A*]_[*A*]_TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt

These files contain all the parameters used in the tight-binding Hamiltonian for each pair-wise interaction of atoms [*A*]. These files contain attractive and repulsive parts, correspondingly. For instance, in the case of a diamond, we only have carbon atoms, thus only files C_C_TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt and C_C_TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt should be in the folder. In the case of GaAs, the combination of each interaction should be present in the files: Ga-Ga, Ga-As, and As-As.

In case identical parameters are used for multiple combinations of elements (this is possible within DFTB parameterization files as they only contain links to databases), one can use files: TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt and TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt. In a case XTANT-3 cannot find files [*A*]_[*A*]_TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt or [*A*]_[*A*]_TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt, it will look up the files without "[*A*]_[*A*]_" prefix.

This also means that one can set default parameterizations in the files without prefixes, and for specific elements use the files with the prefix to specify exceptions.

The first line of the files defines which TB model will be used. The models supported can be specified by the following code words:

- 3TB : ThreeBodyTB model for elemental solids and binary compounds (*only standard 2-body TB is implemented currently, the three-body contribution is unfinished, see below*)
- BOP : a bond-order potential model for dimers [121] (*unfinished, no forces, do not use!*)
- DFTB : one of the s-, sp^3- or sp^3d^5-basis set according to DFTB [122,137]
- DFTB_no_repulsion: one of the s-, sp^3- or sp^3d^5-basis set according to DFTB [122,137], but without the repulsive potential in the file
- Fu : sp^3-basis set according to Fu [127] (*unfinished, do not use!*)
- Mehl : sp^3d^5-basis set according to NRL model [138]
- Molteni : sp^3s^*-basis set according to Molteni [128]
- Pettifor : sp^3-basis set according to Pettifor [130]
- xTB : extended tight binding [89] (*unfinished, do not use!*)

Thus, the first line in the file must contain one of the possible names of the parameterization. Depending on that, the further lines will define one or another parameterization:

1) 3TB parameterization

```
3TB
9.0     0.1     ! cut off [A], smoothing [A]
1.06            ! rc, rescaling coefficient
F               ! include 3-body terms or not (true, false)
T               ! exclude diagonal part of crystal field
```

Figure VI.7. 3TB TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt

```
3TB
```

Figure VI.8 3TB TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt

The files contain the parameters, according to ThreeBodyTB[28] parameterization, which may be s, sp^3, or sp^3d^5, depending on the element.

Line 1 specifies the model name, which must be "3TB"

Line 2 defines embedding cut-off function parameters, ensuring the interaction is short-ranged

Line 3 defines the rescaling coefficient *rc* in the Laguerre polynomials for the TB radial function: *L*(*d***rc*), which shifts the location of the potential minimum, allowing adjustment of the minimum to a desired value. A typical value here is between 1 and 1.1.

[28] https://pages.nist.gov/ThreeBodyTB.jl/

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Important note: In certain cases, it is important to adjust it before productive calculations. Additionally, rigorous tests must be performed for each material: the shape of the cohesive energy curve and the stability of the lattice must be checked since the parameterization was not designed for MD runs (especially in highly excited systems), and not all materials are stable and behaving well dynamically.

Line 4 currently must have option *F*, meaning three-body interactions must be excluded because this option is not yet fully implemented in XTANT.

Line 5 must have the value *T* since the diagonal part of the crystal field should be excluded in calculations.

2) BOP parameterization

```
1  BOP
2  40.0e0  0.5e0        ! rcut [A], dcut [A]
```

Figure VI.9. BOP TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt

```
1  BOP
```

Figure VI.10 BOP TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt

The files contain the following lines, see for example Figure VI.9 and Figure VI.12.

3) DFTB parameterization

```
1  DFTB
2  matsci-0-3      ! DFTB parameterization
3  3.5d0   0.1d0          ! cut-off radius and smoothing dist
```

Figure VI.11. TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt

```
1  DFTB
2  matsci-0-3      ! DFTB parameterization
3  1               ! Type of repulsive: 0=polinomial, 1=spline
```

Figure VI.12 TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt in DFTB format

The files contain the following lines, see for example Figure VI.11 and Figure VI.12 of C interaction with C (e.g. in diamond). There are two ways to set the path to the skf-files, *via* specifying the parameter in the second line. In the Hamiltonian file, the following lines must be specified (Figure VI.11):

d. Line 1: The first line sets the parameterization type (DFTB).

e. Line 2: The second line sets the path to the skf-files.

   a) If in this line only the name of the SK parameters is provided, the default directory is assumed ("DFTB" inside of the directory "INPUT_DATA": INPUT_DATA/DFTB under Unix system, or INPUT_DATA\DFTB under Windows).

   b) If the marker "Path" (acceptable forms: PATH, Path, path) is listed in this line, the next line must specify the path to the skf file or a directory with the skf file: one can use either relative path inside the INPUT_DATA directory, or a full path in your system. XTANT-3 first checks if there is a file with the given name in this line and if such a file is not found, it assumes that it is a full path to a directory, constructs the default filename (X_Y.skf, where X and Y are the elements), and looks for it in the provided directory.

f. Line 3: The third (or fourth, if "PATH" is specified in the second line and the full path in the third) line defines the soft cut-off radius in [Å] and its smoothing in [Å]. Those can be adjusted empirically, but should not be larger than ~10 Å, as this is typically the limit in the

SK files of DFTB. It usually makes sense to set the cut-off radius somewhere after the second or third nearest neighbor.

DFTB SK parameter files for various materials can be found, e.g., here:

1. https://dftb.org/parameters/download - official DFTB parameterizations distribution, contains most of the well-tested parameters (but does not have newly developed ones)
2. https://zenodo.org/records/14289468 - PTBP, universal set of DFTB parameters across the periodic table [139]
3. http://kiff.vfab.org/dftb - alternative distribution of parameter files
4. https://github.com/by-student-2017/Slater-Koster-parameters-no-repulsion_v1 - untested parameters across the periodic table *without* repulsive potential fitted (with no documentation but apparently came from here https://www5.hp-ez.com/hp/calculations/page441). It may (and in most cases does) require the manual fitting of the repulsive potential, for which one may use the function of TB_short below. In the case of compounds, it may also require manual adjustment of the on-site energies of elements to match those expected in compounds.

Apart from the SK-parameters from the official DFTB website, XTANT-3 has the following parameterizations included:

1) PTBP from https://zenodo.org/records/14289468
2) PtRu containing parameters for Ru-Pt compounds from [140]
3) TransMet containing Ag-Ag, Au-Au, Cu-Cu, Ni-Ni, Pd-Pd, Pt-Pt (for nanoclusters) from [141]
4) trans3d-LANLFeC for Fe-C-O from [142]
5) Al2O3 containing files Al-Al, Al-O, O-O, optimized for solid Al_2O_3 from [143]
6) Ga2O3 containing files Ga-Ga, Ga-O, O-O, optimized for solid Ga_2O_3 from [144]
7) BC containing B-C from https://github.com/tlyoon/BC_SKfiles
8) 3ob_cnoh containing parameters for C-H-N-O-P-S interactions from https://bitbucket.org/solccp/adpt_core/src/master/erepfit/example/3ob_cnoh/
9) Verners_2023 containing parameters for a range of materials (similar to pbc parameterization) from http://dx.doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.28507.54564
10) Li-C containing data for Li-graphite interaction from [145]
11) Al-C containing improved Al-C interaction based on matsci-parameters from https://apps.dtic.mil/sti/tr/pdf/AD1026685.pdf
12) dataset_Ru_RuO for Ru-O from https://doi.org/10.17617/3.CRSJQV (requires specifying full path in the parameters file, because it contains separate subdirectories for Ru and Ru-O)

And some others (see the directory DFTB in the INPUT_DATA), the references for which are provided within the corresponding folders.

- List of tools that can be used to create your own SK-parameters:

https://github.com/dftbplus/skprogs
https://github.com/pekkosk/hotbit (Instruction for creation of parameterizations: https://github.com/pekkosk/hotbit/wiki/Parameters-and-parametrization)
https://www.dftbaby.chemie.uni-wuerzburg.de/DFTBaby/mdwiki.html#!WIKI/main_page.md
https://bitbucket.org/solccp/adpt_core/src/master/

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

https://gitlab.com/mvdb/tango
https://github.com/v2quan89/DFTBparaopt

In the Repulsive parameters file (Figure VI.12):

Line 1: The first line sets the parameterization (DFTB). Must be the same as in the Hamiltonian file.

Line 2: The second line sets the set of SK parameters to be used according to DFTB, which must coincide exactly with the directory name existing within the DFTB directory. Must be the same as in the Hamiltonian file.

Line 3: The third line defines which form of the Repulsive term to use according to DFTB format: polynomial (0) or spline (1). It is recommended to use spline (since it contains exponential repulsion at short distances, which polynomial does not; also, apparently not in all sk-files polynomial form is given), thus 1 is the default choice.

All the parameters within the skf-files are described on the dftb-website[29]. Do not change those files (unless you know what exactly you want to change in the parameterization of TB Hamiltonian)!

Also note that currently XTANT-3 only supports zero-level DFTB, non-self-consistent calculations for productive runs (only for BO simulations with DFTB specifically).

4) DFTB_no_repulsion parameterization

This parameterization is identical to the DFTB described above, but without the repulsive potential, e.g. found in https://github.com/by-student-2017/Slater-Koster-parameters-no-repulsion_v1. In this case, there may be an additional line present in the Hamiltonian file, specifying the default inner directory: in the "2elements" directory, there are other directories with pair-wise elements, e.g. Al-X, etc.), meaning if the second line specifies the parameterization "2elements", there must be the third line specifying which subfolder to take the parameterization from (see example in Figure VI.13).

```
1  DFTB_no_repulsion
2  2elements                ! DFTB parameterization without repulsion
3  Al-X                        ! inner folder with parameters
4  5.0d0   0.1d0            ! cut-off radius and smoothing distance [A]
```

Figure VI.13. TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt

```
1  DFTB_no_repulsion
```

Figure VI.14 TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt in DFTB_no_repulsion format

In this case, the file TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt needs only one line with the name. Don't forget to use TB_short additional potential as a separate file.

5) Fu parameterization

The files contain parameters in exactly the same format as Pettifor, where only the first line should read "Fu" instead of "Pettifor". See the description below. *Unfinished, not recommended for use!*

6) Mehl parameterization

The Hamiltonian files should contain 3 introductory lines described below, and then a set of 97 parameters as defined in the NRL format. The Repulsive potential files should contain only one line "Mehl", identifying the parameterization. They are all already prepared, so no need to change anything. To set new parameters for new material, use existing files as an example (starting from the third line,

[29] http://www.dftb.org/parameters/introduction/

only the first column of parameters is used in the code, the others are comments explaining the meaning of the parameters).

NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt | INPUT_MATERIAL.txt | C_C_TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt | C_C_TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt | C_(

```
1   Mehl
2   1   0   1           ! parameterization index (1=with split between t2g and e2, or 0=without); (Sll'm 1=with
3   10.5   0.5                        (RCUT and SCREENL for 1-1 interactions)
4     0.159901905594E+01   0   1     lambda  (equation 7)
5     -.102789972814E+00   0   2     a_s     (equation 9)
6     -.162604640052E+01   0   3     b_s     (equation 9)
7     -.178884826119E+03   0   4     c_s     (equation 9)
8      .451611342028E+04   0   5     d_s     (equation 9)
9      .542619178314E+00   0   6     a_p     (equation 9)
10     .273454062799E+01   0   7     b_p     (equation 9)
11    -.671397098834E+02   0   8     c_p     (equation 9)
12     .438528831452E+03   0   9     d_p     (equation 9)
13     .100000000000E+02   1  10     a_t2g   (equation 9)
14     .000000000000E+00   1  11     b_t2g   (equation 9)
15     .000000000000E+00   1  12     c_t2g   (equation 9)
16     .000000000000E+00   1  13     d_t2g   (equation 9)
17     .100000000000E+02   1  14     a_eg    (equation 9)
18     .000000000000E+00   1  15     b_eg    (equation 9)
19     .000000000000E+00   1  16     c_eg    (equation 9)
```

Figure VI.15 File TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt in NRL format

Line 1: must be "Mehl" identifying the parameterization name

Line 3: contains three numbers:

g. First: included split between t2g (1) or excluded (0), as specified in an original NRL parameters file[30][73]

h. Second: includes the terms Sll'm with delta (1) or without (0)

i. set f_bar = 0 or not (=1)

Line 3: sets the cutoff distance in [A] and its smoothing in [A].

All these parameters must be extracted from the original NRL .par files. The rest of the lines must be just copied from NRL .par files without any changes. The available NRL .par files are saved in the directory NRL_TB_database and can be used to construct required parameterizations for chosen materials.

Note #1: that NRL parameterization often needs additional short-range repulsive potential [3], as may be defined in a short-range (or "wall") file, see below.

Note #2: NRL parameterization has only been tested in XTANT-3 with elemental materials, no compounds have been tested with this parameterizations, so may not work.

7) Molteni parameterization for sp^3s^* basis set

The files contain the following lines, see Figure VI.16 and Figure VI.17 for examples of Ga interaction with As (GaAs). All the parameters are described in [128,146]. Do not change these files (unless you know what exactly you want to change in the parameterization of TB Hamiltonian).

[30] The NRL parameters files used to be available at http://cst-www.nrl.navy.mil/bind/, and later at http://esd.spacs.gmu.edu/tb/tbp.html, but currently can be extracted by means of internet archives such as Wayback Machine: https://archive.org/web/

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

```
Molteni
-2.657d0     ! Es, on-site energy of s-orbital [eV]
3.669d0      ! Ep, on-site energy of p-orbital [eV]
6.739d0      ! Es*, on-site energy of s*-orbital [eV]
-1.613d0     ! V0 (s s sigma)
2.504d0      ! V0 (s p sigma)
3.028d0      ! V0 (p p sigma)
-0.781d0     ! V0 (p p pi)
2.082d0      ! V0 (s* p)
2.46d0       ! r0
2.0d0        ! n
3.511d0        ! rc
13.0d0       ! nc
1.3d0        ! N; rcut = N*r0
0.1d0        ! d
```

Figure VI.16. File TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt in Molteni forma

```
Molteni
1        ! NP, type of potential
2.3906d0     ! phi1
1.2347d0     ! phi2
2.46d0       ! r0
1.3d0        ! N; rcut = N*r0
0.1d0        ! d
0.3555d0     ! alpha (NP=1) or m (NP=2)
```

Figure VI.17 File TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt

8) *Pettifor parameterization*

The files contain the following lines, see Figure VI.18 and Figure VI.19 for an example of Carbon. All the parameters are described in [5,75].

```
Pettifor
-5.25d0      ! Es, on-site energy of s-orbital of Si [eV]
1.20d0       ! Ep, on-site energy of p-orbital of Si [eV]
-2.038e0     ! V0 (s s sigma)
1.745e0      ! V0 (s p sigma)
2.75e0       ! V0 (p p sigma)
-1.075e0     ! V0 (p p pi)
2.360352e0   ! r0
2.0e0        ! n
4.0e0        ! r1
4.16e0       ! rm
9.5e0        ! nc(1)
8.5e0        ! nc(2)
7.5e0        ! nc(3)
7.5e0        ! nc(4)
3.5e0        ! rc(1)
3.55e0       ! rc(2)
3.7e0        ! rc(3)
3.7e0        ! rc(4)
-6.4651e-5   ! c0(1)
0.0014704      ! c1(1)
-0.010804      ! c2(1)
0.025871     ! c3(1)
0.0026017    ! c0(2)
-0.031794      ! c1(2)
0.092548     ! c2(2)
0.028371     ! c3(2)
0.028336     ! c0(3)
-0.20485     ! c1(3)
-0.76001     ! c2(3)
5.8340       ! c3(3)
-0.011077      ! c0(4)
0.08077      ! c1(4)
0.29709      ! c2(4)
-2.2806      ! c3(4)
```

Figure VI.18. TB_Hamiltonian_parameters.txt in Pettifor format

```
Pettifor
8.7393204    ! E0_TB [eV]
1.0e0        ! phi0
6.8755e0     ! m
13.017e0     ! mc
2.360352e0   ! d0
4.0e0        ! d1
4.16e0       ! dm
3.66995e0    ! dc
1.8790e-11   ! c0
1.3221e-9    ! c1
1.4324e-8    ! c2
-4.2468e-8   ! c3
0.0e0        ! a0
2.1604385    ! a1
-0.1384393   ! a2
5.8398423e-3     ! a3
-8.0263577e-5    ! a4
```

Figure VI.19 TB_Repulsive_parameters.txt

c) [*A*]_[*A*]_TB_vdW.txt

This optional file contains the parameters used in the van der Waals (vdW) potential for each pair-wise interaction of atoms [*A*]. For instance, in the case of diamond, we only have carbon atoms, thus only files C_C_TB_vdW.txt should be in the folder. At present, the vdW potential is set according to Girifalco's model, in the shape of the (improved) Lennard-Jones potential (see e.g. [147]), smoothly cut at large (for better energy conservation, and to limit it to some reasonable distance in the spirit of TB) as well as at short distances (not to overlap with the TB covalent bonds). The cut-off may be performed in two different ways: *via* Fermi-like cut-off functions, or *via* switching to fitted polynomials as described in Ref.[87].

Line 3: The first line in the file must contain the exact name of the parameterization. The available options are:

1) LJ (or Lennard-Jones, Lennad_Jones), to use Fermi-like cutoffs:

$$V(r) = V_{LJ}(r) f_s(r) f_l(r)$$
$$f_s(r) = 1 - \left(1 + \exp\left((r - \delta d_{short})/d_{0_short}\right)\right)^{-1} \quad (80)$$
$$f_l(r) = \left(1 + \exp\left((r - \delta d_{long})/d_{0_long}\right)\right)^{-1}$$

In this case, one can use three different forms of the LJ potential[31]: 12-6 form (ε-σ form), AB form, and n-exp form (see Section V.4).

Lines 2 and 3 must specify the form and its parameters, coprrespondingly:

- SE for ε-σ form. In this case, the next line must specify two numbers:
  ε σ - in [eV] and in [Å], correspondingly;
- AB for AB form. In this case, the next line must specify two numbers:
  A B - in [eV*Å^{12}] and in [eV*Å^{6}], correspondingly;
- n-exp for n-exp form. In this case, the next line must specify three (or two) numbers:
  ε r_0 n - in [eV], in [Å], and [-] correspondingly; if the power coefficient *n* is not provided, the default value of *n*=6 is used. Note that in this representation, the coefficients have a straightforward meaning: ε is the depth of the potential well, r_0 is the position of the potential minimum, hence this form is the most convenient to use.

Line 4: in all cases must be the parameters of the cutoff at short distances:

Two numbers: d_{0_short}, δd_{short} – cutoff radius and its width, both in [Å]

Line 5: in all cases must be the parameters of the cutoff at long distances:

Two numbers: d_{0_long}, δd_{long} – cutoff radius and its width, both in [Å]

2) ILV, to use improved LJ potential (see Section V.4), which has the same general form as in Eq.(80), but with $V_{LJ}(r)$ replaced with $V_{ILJ}(r)$. In this case, three more lines are required:

Line 2: Four numbers specifying the parameters of $V_{ILJ}(r)$:

ε r_0 n m - in [eV], in [Å], and [-], [-] correspondingly.

Line 3: in all cases must be the parameters of the cutoff at short distances:

Two numbers: d_{0_short}, δd_{short} – cutoff radius and its width, both in [Å].

Line 4: in all cases must be the parameters of the cutoff at long distances:

Two numbers: d_{0_long}, δd_{long} – cutoff radius and its width, both in [Å].

3) Girifalco, to use polynomial cutoffs.

Examples of the files are shown in Figure VI.20. This type of parameterization assumes LJ potential in AB form, which switches to polynomials at short and at large distance. All polynomial coefficients

[31] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lennard-Jones_potential

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

must be provided. The coefficients must be set such that the potential, its first derivative (and long distances) and second derivatives (at short distances) all coincide with those of the LJ potential at the chosen distances, and goes to zero at the chosen short distance.

Note: since this requires careful fitting, it is more convenient to use LJ-type potential instead.

If the file is absent, the calculations will proceed without vdW forces. So, this module will not affect the materials for which there is no vdW force or parameterization.

```
LJ
n-exp
0.03d0  3.5d0   6.0d0          ! epsylon, r0, n            ! [eV], [A], [-]
3.2d0   0.03d0      ! d0_short, dd_short    ! [A] short-range cutoff radius, [A] cutoff width
6.0d0   0.1d0       ! d0_cut, dd_cut        ! [A] long-range cutoff radius, [A] cutoff width
```

```
Girifalco
22.5d3          ! C12 [eV*A^12] Lenard-Jones C12
15.4d0          ! C6 [eV*A^6] Lenard-Jones C6
5.0d0           ! dm [A] radius where to switch to polinomial
6.0d0           ! d_cut [A] cut-off radius
-0.8253440000d-3        ! a, fitting polinomial coefficients: a*x^3+b*x^2+c*x+d
0.1313740800d-1         ! b
-0.6851174400d-1        ! c
0.1163980800d0          ! d
3.4d0           ! dsm [A] radius where to switch to polinomial at small distances
2.5d0           ! ds_cut [A] cut-off radius on small distances
0.1286478847d0          ! as, fitting polinomial coefficients: a*x^3+b*x^2+c*x+d
-1.858707955d0          ! bs
10.66718892d0           ! cs
-30.40360058d0          ! ds
43.05091787d0           ! es
-24.23710839d0          ! fs
```

Figure VI.20 Examples of vdW files: with Lennard-Jones-type parameters (top), and with Girifalco-type parameters (bottom).

d) [*A*]_[*A*]_TB_Coulomb.txt

This optional file contains parameters of the softly-cut Coulomb potential, softly cut according to [87]. It is only used in the case we have electron emission included in the simulation (e.g. modeling thin films). An example of the file is shown in Figure VI.21.

If the file is absent, the calculations will proceed without Coulomb forces. So, the Coulomb module will not affect the materials for which there is no Coulomb force or parameterization.

```
Coulomb_cut
20.0d0          ! dm
0.1d0           ! dd
```

Figure VI.21 File C_C_TB_Coulomb.txt for C_{60}.

e) [*A*]_[*A*]_TB_short.txt or [*A*]_[*A*]_TB_wall.txt

This optional file contains parameters of the short-range repulsive potential, *in addition* to the repulsive potential included in the used TB parameterization. E.g., it is to be used in case we have kinetic energies of atoms higher than the TB-provided barrier at short distances (in such a case, it is necessary to make the system stable at short distances); or in TB parameterizations where the repulsive part is not provided. The current parameterization may combine a few functional shapes described below (the obsolete version called “exponential wall” only includes the inverse exponential).

Generally, the repulsive potential is expressed in the form:

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

$$E_{SR} = F_{SR} f_{cut}, \quad (81)$$

Where F_{SR} is the short-range function, and f_{cut} is the cut-off function in the shape of the Fermi-function: $f_{cut} = f_l$ (from Eq.(80)).

This function is always included, independently of the choice of F_{SR}, thus, its parameters must be always listed in the file, if additional short-range potential to be included. If unspecified, zero potential will be used (cut off at zero radii).

Line 1: The first line in the file must specify either the path to the file with the parameter, or the parameterization name. This means, it can be either:

"Path", or parameterization name:

"General" – to specify the new format described above, or

"Simple_wall" – to specify the obsolete format which includes only the inverse exponential function.

An example of the new and the obsolete files containing the parameters in the same notations is shown in Figure VI.22.

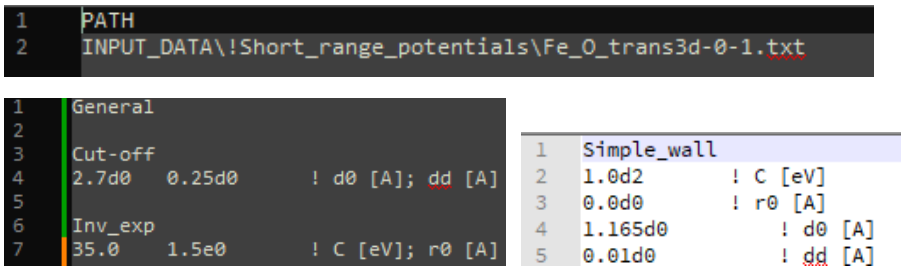


Figure VI.22 Equivalent presentation of inverse exponential short-range (exponential wall) function in three possible formats: specifying path to the file with the parameter (top); the new format (left) and in the obsolete format (right).

If the flag "Path" is specified, the next line (Line 2) must contain the path to the file with the short-range potential parameters. Note that it does not matter what path separator is used in the path (slash or backslash), the program will automatically correct it to the one used in Windows or Linux. The specified file, then, must contain one of the allowed flags: "General" or "Simple_wall", as described below.

If the file is absent or anything else but "General" or "Simple_wall" is specified in the first line, the calculations will proceed without an additional short-range repulsive potential.

The short-range repulsive function, F_{SR}, may assume the following shapes, summed up pairwise for all the atoms in the simulation box ($F_{SR} = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{i,j}^{N_{at}} F_{SR}^{i,j}$), Line 2 (and more):

Flag	**Function**	**Parameters to be specified in the file** (must be exactly in the given order!)
Cutoff, or Cut_off, Cut-off	$\left(1 + exp\left(\frac{r - d_0}{d_d}\right)\right)^{-1}$	One line: d_0 d_d – cut-off radius [A], smoothing distance [A]
Exp, Exponential	$\phi \exp\left(-\frac{r - r_0}{a}\right)$	One line:

		Φ r_0 a – Energy [eV], characteristic radius [A], characteristic distance [A]
InvExp, Inv_Exp	$C \exp\left(\frac{1}{r - r_0}\right)$	One line: C r_0 – Energy [eV], characteristic radius [A]
Pow, Power	$F_{SR} = \Phi\left(\frac{r}{r_0}\right)^m$	Two or more lines: N – number of power functions (integer) N more lines each with three numbers for each power-function: Φ r_0 m – Energy [eV], characteristic radius [A], power
ZBL	Ziegler-Biersack-Littmark potential [85]	*No additional lines required, all parameters are fixed and included in the code*
NLH	Nordlund-Lehtola-Hobler potential [86]	*No additional lines required, all parameters are fixed and included in an input file nlh_coeffs.dat in the directory INPUT_DATA/!Short_range_potentials*
TAB, Tab, TABLE, Table, Tabulated	Tabulated potential	Line 1: must specify the number of points, and may (optionally) specify the type of integration of this potential; thus, the line must contain at least one number, but may contain a number and a text variable: N (integer) – number of grid points in the tabulated potential; text marker: "diff" or "spline". The marker "diff" sets the finite difference method for evaluation of the potential and forces between the tabulated points. The marker "spline" sets the cubic spline method for calculations of potential and forces (similar to the DFTB repulsive potential). Note that the default option is "diff", which is used if no text marker is specified in this line. Note #2: finite difference method works better for dense grids in the potential, spline works better for spars grids. Lines 2-N+1: Tabulated potential in two columns: Column 1: (real) interatomic distance [Å] Column 2: (real) potential energy [eV]
Simple_wall (*obsolete, cannot be combined with other functions!*)	$C \exp\left(\frac{1}{r - r_0}\right) f_{cut}$	Four lines: C – Energy [eV], r_0 – characteristic radius [A] d_0 – cut-off radius [A] d_d – smoothing distance [A]

It is allowed to use a few power functions to construct a polynomial (or inverse fractions, using negative powers "m", such as those used in [128]).

f) Setting initial atomic configuration

The following formats may be used in setting the initial atomic configuration, in the following priorities:

1) Files with reaction coordinate path (using internal XTANT-3 SAVE-files format, see below) between two different phases of material (instead of full MD simulation); if the coordinate-path files are absent, the next option is checked.
2) SAVE-files (internal XTANT-3 format for setting the supercell parameters, atomic coordinates, and atomic velocities); if SAVE-files are absent, the next option is checked.
3) XYZ-file (in extended XYZ format): user-specified name with XYZ-file is allowed (must be a file with the extension ".xyz"). If the user did not provide the name with the file, the default filename is checked: Cell.xyz. If this file is absent, the next option is checked.
4) POSCAR format[32] file: user-specified name with poscar-file is allowed (must be a file with the extension ".poscar"). If the user did not provide the name, the default file is check: Cell.poscar. If this file is absent, the next option is checked.
5) mol2 format[33] file: user-specified name with mol2-file is allowed (the file must have the extension ".mol2"). If the user did not specified the name, the default filename is checked: Cell.mol2. If this file is absent, the next option is checked.
6) Unit-cell parameters and atomic coordinates in it (internal XTANT-3 format).

All the formats are described below.

i. Files PHASE_[*i*]_atoms.dat and PHASE_[*i*]_supercell.dat

The user can set the initial and final states of the simulation cell for calculation of the free-electron along a reaction coordinate path. Here [*i*] runs from 1 to 2, the index of the initial and the final phase. It can be done in the following way:

Calculation of free-energy along reaction coordinate path

Set initial atomic configuration in the files PHASE_1_atoms.dat and PHASE_1_supercell.dat

Set final atomic configuration in the files PHASE_2_atoms.dat and PHASE_2_supercell.dat

Run XTANT. If these files are present in the folder with the material data, XTANT-3 will linearly interpolate coordinates from the first to the second phase (accounting for periodic boundaries) and save all the output data along this coordinate path. The free energy will be calculated for the electronic temperature provided in the INPUT_MATERIAL.txt (or INPUT.txt) file (see above).

ii. Files SAVE_[*something*]

An alternative way to set the initial configuration of the atoms and supercell is to have the files SAVE_supercell.dat and SAVE_atoms.dat in the directory (in the internal XTANT format); or, alternatively, files SAVE_coordinates.dat and SAVE_velocities.dat (in the XYZ format; see below description of these files, and the format).

[32] https://www.vasp.at/wiki/index.php/POSCAR
[33] https://www.structbio.vanderbilt.edu/archives/amber-archive/2007/att-1568/01-mol2_2pg_113.pdf

If these files are present, the program will use them instead of the 'Unit_cell_atom_relative_coordinates.txt' and 'Unit_cell_equilibrium.txt' files described above. With these files, you can add any desired atomic configuration, not only perfect periodic crystalline lattice.

The file SAVE_el_distribution.dat sets the electron distribution function. It must be present in the folder if the given electronic distribution needs to be used (e.g., to restart calculations with exactly the same parameters). In the absence of this file, the Fermi function with the given temperature will be used. This file allows to restore a nonequilibrium electronic distribution. The presence of the file supersedes the electronic temperature given in the input file: if the file is present, this distribution is used, and the electronic temperature specified is ignored.

The file 'SAVE_atoms.dat' must contain the data in the same format as the file 'OUTPUT_coordinates_and_velosities.dat' (see below).

The format of the file 'SAVE_supercell.dat' must coincide with the format of the file 'OUTPUT_supercell.dat' (see below).

If these files are present, XTANT-3 will ignore the number of unit-cells specified in the NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS file, and use the atomic coordinates and the supercell provided here.

These files can be used, e.g., for simulation of amorphous materials, and relaxation process before productive runs. They must be constructed separately as follows:

Creation of initial configuration of an amorphous material

1) Choose a material you'd like to construct (e.g. carbon or silicon-based)
2) Choose a number of atoms in the simulation box, which will be used for all further simulations of the amorphous state (each number of atoms chosen requires separate preparation of the initial state!)
3) Set the proper density of the desirable amorphous material by adjusting the volume in the file 'Unit_cell_equilibrium.txt' of the material we will start from the melt
4) Set parameters for quenching in the NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS input file as follows:

1 1000.0 10.0

The first parameter tells to include material cooling (quenching), which is made by setting atomic velocities to zero starting from the time, given in the second number (e.g. 1000.0 fs, after the melting), then propagates the atomic trajectories and repeats the procedure every (~10.0) femtosecond (e.g. for silicon-based material, chose here ~30.0 as an optimal time). Set initial conditions that would create a melted state (e.g., by setting high atomic temperature or irradiation with a high deposited dose). Run this simulation for a few picoseconds, until the total energy stops dropping. This means the material is relaxed into its equilibrium amorphous state.

Don't forget to switch this off (by setting the first parameter to 0) for further real simulations!

5) The files 'SAVE_atoms.dat' and 'SAVE_supercell.dat' are created during the simulation run in the output folder, and are updated at each saving time step; thus, the data in them after the simulation has finished correspond to the last time-step of the simulation and can be just copied into the input file, provided the simulation delivered desired quality of results. Place these files into the folder with the new material name, see next step.

6) Place both files into the folder 'Amorphous_[material_name]'. Copy all other input files from the directory of 'parental' material (ideal material that you just melted) into the same folder, and set the name of the folder the same as the material name in the file 'INPUT_FILE.txt'.

7) Place the files 'SAVE_atoms.dat' and 'SAVE_supercell.dat' into the same directory.

8) Check if there is no artificial void in the new created state, and the density is uniform (and any other properties that are needed to be reproduced well in your amorphous material). If the amorphous material looks good, these files with the relaxed amorphous atomic state can now be used for further simulations of amorphous material. If not, repeat the procedure from the beginning until the quenched state is produced to satisfy your conditions.

iii. Extended XYZ files

Another alternative way to set the initial conditions is to use a file Cell.xyz (or a name of the file with the extension xyz specified in the input file), which uses extended XYZ format[34], where the extended format means that instead of the comment-line, line #2 specifies important parameters not included in the simple XYZ format. The format is as follows:

Line 1: number of atoms (integer)

Line 2: Specifiers. For the usual XYZ format, the following specifiers are needed[35]:

Lattice="ax ay az ba by bz cx cy cz" Properties=species:S:1:pos:R:3

Note: the option "Properties" must be the last one in the line; anything after that will *not* be read.

- "Lattice" sets the unit- or super-cell vectors; the values are specified after this marker.
- "Alloy" or "Mixture" sets the option for the atomic system to be defined as atoms randomly placed in the given coordinates. So, the atomic coordinates specified in the next lines are used, but the chemical elements, occupying these coordinates, are reshuffled randomly in the supercell. This marker must be followed by a word in the quotation marks: "x", e.g. Alloy="true".

  In this case, lines 3 and all the lines with definition of the atomic coordinates may contain the minus sign instead of the chemical element name (or index). Places with minus sign will be assigned a random element from the chemical formula defined in the INPUT file, with the probability defined by the stoichiometry of the chemical formula.

  I.e., for setting a completely random placements of all atoms (such as, stainless steel or high-entropy alloy), set minus signs in places of all element names. For setting a partially random mixture/alloy (e.g., high-entropy oxides), those elements that have definitive places must be specified, while only those to be placed randomly should have minus signs, e.g.:

  ```
  2
  Lattice="3.69 0.0 0.0  0.0 3.69 0.0 0.0 0.0 3.69" Alloy="true" Properties=species:S:1:pos:S:3
  -  0.0  0.0  0.0
  O  0.0  0.5  0.5
  ```

[34] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/XYZ_file_format
[35] https://www.ovito.org/manual/reference/file_formats/input/xyz.html

Specifies that in the positions (0, 0.5, 0.5) will always be an oxygen atom, whereas all the (0,0,0) positions will be populated with random atoms chosen from those given in the chemical formula.

- "Substitute" sets the option to replace a certain group of atoms of the chosen element with another element, e.g. to create solid solutions. This option must follow with the 3 descriptors: which elements to substitute (char*3), what elements to substitute them with (char*3), and what fraction of elements to be substituted (real between 0 and 1). For example, for ITO solid solution, the following substitution of 10% of In atoms with Sn atoms is used: Substitute="In Sn 0.1".
- "Properties" define in which format the next lines are specified:
  - "species" indicates that the first column will be defining the element type; if after the column "S" is specified then the symbol of the element from the Periodic Table must be in the first column; if "I" is specified then the index corresponding to the order in the provided chemical formula (in the INPUT file) must be in the first column.
  - "pos" defines that in the next 3 columns, atomic coordinates will be provided: if "R" is defined here, then absolute coordinates in [Å] must be given; if "S" is specified then relative coordinates within the supercell must be provided.
  - "vel" or "velo" specifier identifies that columns 5-7 will be defining atomic velocities; if "V" is defined here, absolute velocities in [Å/fs] must be given; if "S" is specified, then relative velocities within the supercell must be provided.
  - "mass" specifies that the column will contain the atomic mass (in [kg]); this option is only used in the output XYZ file, but not read in case of the input XYZ file.
  - "charge" specifies that the column will contain atomic charge (in the units of electron charge; currently only Mulliken charge is supported); this option is only used in the output XYZ file, but not read in case of the input XYZ file.
  - "kinetic_energy" specifies that the column will contain atomic kinetic energy (in [eV]); this option is only used in the output XYZ file, but not read in case of the input XYZ file.

Line 3: and further until the number of atoms specified in line #1: Element name or atomic type; Coordinates.

In the second line, instead of the standard specifiers "Lattice" and "Properties", the user may choose to set a random atomic arrangement with the given material density. For that, the following identifier must be used:

"Random" (Note that it is not a part of the standard extended XYZ format, but specific to XTANT-3). If only the flag Random is set, then the unit-/super-cell will be cubic, with the size chosen to reproduce the density specified in the next lines. Alternatively, the user may set the X and Y dimensions of the supercell, while the Z dimension will be chosen to reproduce the density of the material. E.g.:

Random - cubic cell

Random="X 15.0 Y 14.0" – X dimension is set to be 15.0 Å, Y dimension is set to be 14.0 Å.

In this format, inside the quotation marks, 4 values must be set: character "X" (or "Y"), value (real) of the supercell in the dimension specified, character "Y" (or "X"), value (real) of the supercell in the dimension specified.

If this specifier is used, the next lines must define the following parameters:

Element name from the periodic table (character); density (real) [g/cm^3]; the number of atoms (integer)

E.g., for a single aluminum cell with 100 atoms, one should write:

Al 2.7 100

For a multilayer system, containing, e.g., Al (100 atoms) and Cu (80 atoms) layers, the following should be set:

Al 2.7 100

Cu 8.96 80

The layers will be stacked along the Z direction.

The elements set in this file *must* be included in the chemical formula set in the INPUT_MATERIAL.txt file (see above).

Note #1: that the XYZ file sets a "unit cell", and a supercell will be constructed, according to the number of images set in the NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt file.

Note #2: similar to setting a molecule in water, such random placing of atoms requires two-step relaxation: first, quenching to the ground state is required, and after that, setting the required temperature (e.g., room temperature) may be done with help of Berendsen thermostat.

iv. POSCAR file

A file must have the extension ".poscar" (the default file name is "Cell.poscar"); the format is the standard[36] with no modifications.

v. mol2 file

A file with the input atomic and supercell data may also be provided in the format mol2, which then must have an extension ".mol2" (the default file name is "Cell.mol2"). The format is standard[37] with no modifications. May be useful for files with molecules in SYBYL format[38].

vi. Unit_cell_atom_relative_coordinates.txt and Unit_cell_equilibrium.txt

The file Unit_cell_atom_relative_coordinates.txt contains the coordinates of atoms inside of the equilibrium unit-cell in relative coordinates. The number of lines in this file defines how many atoms we have in the unit cell of the material. For example, it is 8 atoms for GaAs; see Figure VI.23. These 8 lines contain the following information:

[36] https://www.vasp.at/wiki/index.php/POSCAR

[37] https://www.structbio.vanderbilt.edu/archives/amber-archive/2007/att-1568/01-mol2_2pg_113.pdf

[38] E.g., from the CCDC molecular structures database: https://www.ccdc.cam.ac.uk/structures/

The first number stands for the kind of atom according to its chemical formula given in the input file. For example, for GaAs number 1 stands for Ga, and number 2 stands for As. *Make sure your order of elements in the chemical formula in the file matches the order of elements in this file!*

The next 3 numbers in each line represent the initial relative coordinates S_x, S_y, S_z of 8 atoms inside the unit cell (normalized from 0 to 1).

Unit_cell_atom_relative_coordinates.txt

```
1   1   0.0e0   0.0e0   0.0e0
2   1   0.5e0   0.5e0   0.0e0
3   1   0.5e0   0.0e0   0.5e0
4   1   0.0e0   0.5e0   0.5e0
5   2   0.25e0  0.25e0  0.25e0
6   2   0.75e0  0.75e0  0.25e0
7   2   0.75e0  0.25e0  0.75e0
8   2   0.25e0  0.75e0  0.75e0
```

Figure VI.23 File Unit_cell_atom_relative_coordinates.txt for GaAs.

The file Unit_cell_equilibrium.txt contains the initial vectors of the unit cell in angstroms [A], to be later evolved according to the Parrinello-Rahman method [92] (for P=const simulation). The file contains three vectors (as columns), see Figure VI.24.

Unit_cell_equilibrium.txt - Notepa

File Edit Format View Help

```
5.431d0  0.0d0    0.0d0
0.0d0    5.431d0  0.0d0
0.0d0    0.0d0    5.431d0
```

Figure VI.24 File Unit_cell_equilibrium.txt for silicon

f) File with Ritchie CDF coefficients: [*Material*].cdf

The file with cdf-coefficients fitted within the Ritchie-Howie formalism [51]. The name (and the path to) of the file may be defined by the user, or the default name may be used: [*material*].cdf. This file contains all parameters needed for Monte Carlo calculations of the electron cross-sections within the Ritchie-Howie complex dielectric function formalism [51]. The file format is compatible with that used in TREKIS-3 code[39]. It contains the following lines, see Figure VI.25, described below.

Only used if the cdf-cross sections are chosen, not used for BEB cross sections. Also unused for single-pole approximation in the cdf; in this case, the coefficients of a single pole are obtained automatically, see the model description above (Section II.3.a) and in Ref. [53].

[39] The code TREKIS-3 and cdf-files for many materials may be found at: https://github.com/N-Medvedev/TREKIS-3

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Silicon.cdf

```
1  Silicon
2  Si
3  2.3290  8430.0  ! density [g/cm^3], speed of sound [m/s]
4                  ! number of shells of the first element: Si
5  1   1   1838.9e0    2.0 1.66e0       ! number of CDF , shell-designator, ionization potential, num
6  1579.84393e0    236.1525e0  1192.8108e0 ! E0, A, Gamma coefficients
7  1   3   148.7e0 2.0 0.375e0          ! number of CDF functions, shell-designator, ionization poten
8  219.31853e0 223.14459e0     199.22160e0 ! E0, A, Gamma coefficients
9  1   4   99.2e0  6.0 16.06e0          ! number of CDF functions, shell-designator, ionization poten
10 100 685 145                            ! E0, A, Gamma coefficients
11 2   63  1.12    4.0 1.0e23           ! number of CDF functions, shell-designator, ionization poten
12 15.9504e0   113.883e0   3.212e0         ! E0, A, Gamma coefficients
13 17.499583e0 135.1805e0  3.0291e0        ! E0, A, Gamma coefficients
```

Figure VI.25 Example file [*Material*].cdf (Silicon)

Line 1: material name

Line 2: chemical element name(s), according to the rules described above

Line 3: density of the material in [g/cm^3] (this number is the default value, which may be overwritten by the input file, see above), its speed of sound (not used in this version of MC), and the Fermi-level in [eV] (also unused in the current implementation)

Line 4: number of shells of the first element in the compound

Line 5: for the first shell, the next five numbers in the line:

1) Number of complex dielectric function (CDF) oscillators used in the formalism [52]
2) Shell designator according to the EADL[40] database (see a copy in Table VI below), with an additional notation of shell number 63 corresponding to the valence band.
3) The ionization potential of this shell in [eV]
4) Number of electrons in this shell
5) Time of Auger-decay in [fs]; for the valence band set here a huge number such as 1.0d23.

[40] See details of this library here: https://www-nds.iaea.org/epdl97/libsall.htm, physical details and references for the library are here: https://www-nds.iaea.org/epdl97/document/epdl97.pdf

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

Table VI. Atomic Subshell Designators

Designator	Subshell	Designator	Subshell	Designator	Subshell
1.	K (1s1/2)	21.	N4 (4d3/2)	41.	Pl (6s1/2)
2.	L (2)	22.	N5 (4d5/2)	42.	P23 (6p)
3.	Ll (2s1/2)	23.	N67 (4f)	43.	P2 (6p1/2)
4.	L23 (2p)	24.	N6 (4f5/2)	44.	P3 (6p3/2)
5.	L2 (2p1/2)	25.	N7 (4f7/2)	45.	P45 (6d)
6.	L3 (2p3/2)	26.	O (5)	46.	P4 (6d3/2)
7.	M (3)	27.	O1 (5s1/2)	47.	P5 (6d5/2)
8.	Ml (3s1/2)	28.	O23 (5p)	48.	P67 (6f)
9.	M23 (3p)	29.	O2 (5p1/2)	49.	P6 (6f5/2)
10.	M2 (3p1/2)	30.	O3 (5p3/2)	50.	P7 (6f7/2)
11.	M3 (3p3/2)	31.	O45 (5d)	51.	P89 (6g)
12.	M45 (3d)	32.	O4 (5d3/2)	52.	P8 (6g7/2)
13.	M4 (3d3/2)	33.	O5 (5d5/2)	53.	P9 (6g9/2)
14.	M5 (3d5/2)	34.	O67 (5f)	54.	P1011 (6h)
15.	N (4)	35.	O6 (5f5/2)	55.	P10 (6h9/2)
16.	Nl (4s1/2)	36.	O7 (5f7/2)	56.	P11 (6h11/2)
17.	N23 (4p)	37.	O89 (5g)	57.	Q (7)
18.	N2 (4p1/2)	38.	O8 (5g7/2)	58.	Ql (7s1/2)
19.	N3 (4p3/2)	39.	O9 (5g9/2)	59.	Q23 (7p)
20.	N45 (4d)	40.	P (6)	60.	Q2 (7p1/2)
				61.	Q3 (7p3/2)

The number of next lines depends on the number of CDF-oscillators specified. For each oscillator, there will be a separate line, containing the following E_0, A, Γ coefficients of the CDF [52].

Then, for each shell, there will be the same set of lines with its own parameters.

If there is more than one element in the compound (e.g. GaAs), the same lines from 5 and further must be present for the second element. However, the last orbital (energy level) must be skipped, because it forms the valence band, and the valence band was already described in the first element. Thus, for all the next elements the number of shells must be one less than for the case of an elemental material (first element).

In case one uses BEB cross sections (by setting the EADL option in the input file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt), the file [*Material*].cdf is unnecessary. And vice versa, if you do not have cdf data and the corresponding file, switch to the EADL option for the cross sections.

g) Files with electron mean free paths

[*Matter*]_Total_Electron_IMFP.txt contains the total electron mean free path in the material. The first column is the electron energy in [eV], and the second one is the mean free path in [Å].

Files named as [*A*]_[*CS*]_Electron_IMFP_Ip=[*Ip*]eV.txt specify in the same format electron mean free paths for each shell of each kind of atom.

Here [*A*] represents the atomic species (Si, C, Ga, As…);

[*CS*] represents within which formalism the cross-section (and, correspondingly, mean free path) is calculated: CDF (for CDF read from a file), CDFsp (for single-pole approximation to CDF) or BEB (for atomic cross-section);

[*Ip*] is the ionization potential of the shell, the given value of *Ip* must coincide with the ionization potential specified in the cdf-file.

If these files are not present in the folder, at the first XTANT-3 run it will automatically calculate them for the given choice of the cross-section (CDF or BEB), and save. Next time, it will read from the saved files, instead of recalculating them again. This means, if you modify something in the atomic parameters or the cdf, you have to delete the mean free paths files and let the program recalculate the new ones at the next run.

At the first run with CDF, the code also informs you about the corresponding sum-rules for the cdf you provided or the single-pole approximation [48,53].

h) Files with photon attenuation lengths

The files are constructed in exactly the same way as the files for electrons described above, named similarly: [*Matter*]_Total_photon_IMFP.txt. In the case of the given cdf, the photon attenuation lengths (mean free paths) are calculated from the cdf; in the case of chosen EADL (or BEB) cross sections, the photoabsorption cross sections are extracted from the EADL (part of EPICS) database.

i) K-points grid

File k_grid.dat may contain several lines with 3 values in each specifying the grid points (k_x, k_y, k_z) in the reciprocal space for calculations of the CDF and/or DOS (if the corresponding options are set in the input file; otherwise, this file is ignored). See an example in Figure VI.26.

If no such a file is present, the Monkhorst-Pack[132] sampling of k-space points is used.

```
0.0d0   0.0d0   0.0d0
0.0d0   0.0d0   0.1d0
0.0d0   0.0d0   0.2d0
0.0d0   0.0d0   0.3d0
0.0d0   0.0d0   0.5d0
0.1d0   0.0d0   0.5d0
0.2d0   0.0d0   0.5d0
0.3d0   0.0d0   0.5d0
0.4d0   0.0d0   0.5d0
0.5d0   0.0d0   0.5d0
```

Figure VI.26. Example of k_grid.dat file

VII. Output Files

XTANT-3 produces several output files.

1) OUTPUT_Error_log.dat

file must be empty if there were no errors during the execution of the code. In this case, it is automatically deleted after the execution is finished. If it's not empty and not deleted at the end, have a look inside for the description of a known error that you would have to find later in the code and figure out why it occurred. Known types of errors and their meaning:

- Error #1: file not found
- Error #2: file could not be opened
- Error #3: file could not be read on the line number given
- Error #4: some problem with databases (EADL, EPDL, periodic table file)
- Error #5: inconsistent TB parameterization (only the same type of parameterization is allowed for all kinds of atoms within the compound)
- Error #6: diagonalization subroutine with LAPACK failed (uses MKL library)

- Error #7: some errors in low-energy electrons (probably in temperature or chemical potential calculation)
- Error #8: error in optical coefficients (probably in complex Hamiltonian)
- Error #9: error in conversion between the fluence and the dose

This file may also contain warnings that are not critical for execution of the program but remarking that the results may need to be interpreted with caution.

2) OUTPUT_Energy.dat

In case you included an additional option size, the code produces this file with the following information:

Column 1 is the nearest neighbor distance in [Å]

Column 2 is the total energy [eV/atom]

Column 3 is the repulsive part of the energy [eV/atom]

Column 4 is the attractive part of the energy [eV/atom]

Column 5 is the van der Waals contribution in [eV/atom]

Column 6 is the ZBL potential in [eV/atom] (unused in real calculations but may be useful for creating repulsive potential or checking short-range potential)

3) Directory OUTPUT_[*material*]_hw=[*hw*]_t=[*t*]_F=[*F*]

This is the default name of the directory that contains all output files with the results of the code execution.

a) If the user provided an optional name of the output in the INPUT_MATERIAL file, the directory will be named OUTPUT_[*material*]_[*output_name*] (see description of the optional options in the input file, Page 47).
b) If user did not provide the name, the default name itself contains details of the parameters of the run.

Note #1: In Windows, all the symbols "=" in the directory name will be replaced with the underscores "_": OUTPUT_[*material*]_hw_[*hw*]_t_[*t*]_F_[*F*]_[*N*]_pulses

[*material*] is the name of the material used (diamond, silicon, etc.). If the option "water" was specified in the INPUT_MATERIAL file, then the name will be augmented with the words "in_water" (e.g. it will be *material* = "diamond_in_water")

[*hw*] is the photon energy of the FEL pulse used [eV]

[*t*] is the duration of the FEL pulse [fs]

[*F*] is the pulse fluence in terms of the absorbed dose in [eV/atom]

For the case of more than one FEL-pulse modeled, these parameters are shown for the *first* pulse, but the directory-name is appended with the following:

OUTPUT_[*material*]_hw=[*hw*]_t=[*t*]_F=[*F*]_[*N*]_pulses

Where *N* shows the number of pulses specified in the input file. For a single pulse, the part of _[*N*]_pulses is omitted in the name.

c) Alternatively, for no pulse calculations (*F*=0), the name will be OUTPUT_[*material*]_Te=[*Te*]_Ta=[*Ta*]_[*coupling*] where

[*Te*] is the initial electron temperature [K]; in case if electron distribution is read from the file (instead of Fermi distribution with a given temperature), then here "-1.0" will be used, to indicate that the distribution may be out of equilibrium and the electronic temperature is undefined.

[*Ta*] is the initial atomic temperature [K]

[*coupling*] will be either "no_coupling" (if no electron-phonon coupling is included), or "with_coupling" if the nonadiabatic coupling is switched on.

d) If a run with the same parameters already was performed, and the data directory with the same name already exists, the new file folder be created with a number at the end, e.g.

OUTPUT_[*material*]_hw=[*hw*]_t=[*t*]_F=[*F*]_v1

An output directory will also contain several files, including a copy of the INPUT_MATERIAL.txt (or INPUT.txt) and, if exists, NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt for your records, and the file

!OUTPUT_[*material*]_Parameters.txt with essentially the same information, plus the atomic data that are extracted from either cdf-file, or EADL database, and duration of execution of the program. Also, if you use a communication file (see the next subsection), its results will be saved here for your information.

4) SAVE_[*something*]

Files with the atomic coordinates SAVE_atoms.dat, with supercell vectors SAVE_supercell.dat, and SAVE_el_distribution.txt containing electronic distribution.

Or the files in the standard XYZ format, if the user specified it: SAVE_coordinates.xyz and SAVE_velocities.xyz. The file with coordinates contains the supercell vectors in its second (comment) line. The file with coordinates contains the supercell vectors velocities in its second (comment) line.

These files are updated at each printout-MD-step and can be used to restart the simulation from the current step (including the last step). They can be used to restart the simulation from the last available timestep, especially useful in the case of unforeseen interruption of the calculations.

5) Communication with the program on-the-fly

In the output folder, XTANT-3 creates a text file named Comunication.txt. This file is checked by the program at each saving-time-step. You can send the following messages to the program that it will interpret and act upon:

- time "number" : to change the total duration of the simulation (type 'time' and the new number in [fs], without quotation marks, e.g. time 10000, or Time 2e3)
- SAVEdt "number" : to change how often outputs are saved (type the new number in [fs], e.g. SAVEdt 2.0 – will make the program save output data with the time step of 2 fs)

- MDdt “number” : to change the timestep of MD simulation (type the new number in [fs], e.g. MDdt 0.01).
- OMP “number” : to change the number of OpenMP threads in the parallel calculations (integer). Setting here a zero or negative number will set the number of threads equal to the maximum number of threads on your machine.
- Thermostat_Ta “number” : to change the temperature of the atomic Berendsen thermostat. The number sets the new atomic temperature in [K]. A negative number switches off the atomic thermostat.
- Thermostat_dt_a “number” : to change the characteristic time of the atomic Berendsen thermostat. The number sets the new characteristic time of the thermostat in [fs]. A negative number switches off the atomic thermostat.
- Thermostat_Te “number” : to change the temperature of the electronic Berendsen thermostat. The number sets the new atomic temperature in [K]. The negative number switches off the electronic thermostat.
- Thermostat_dt_e “number” : to change the characteristic time of the electronic Berendsen thermostat. The number sets the new characteristic time of the thermostat in [fs]. The negative number switches off the electronic thermostat.
- Verbose : switches the *verbose* option on (see Section IV.6).
- verbose_off : switches the *verbose* option off.

For example, the following lines in the file shown will reset (1) the duration of simulation to 1000 fs, (2) the printout timestep to 10 fs, (3) the atomic thermostat to the temperature of 300 K, (4) the characteristic time of the atomic thermostat to 150 fs, and (5) switch off the electronic thermostat, see Figure VII.1.

```
1  time 1000
2  SAVEdt  10.0
3  thermostat_Ta   300.0e0
4  Thermostat_dt_a 150.0
5  Thermostat_Te   -1
```

Figure VII.1 Example of the communication file.

At the end of the simulation, this file is deleted.

6) Plotting: OUTPUT_Gnuplot_all.sh or OUTPUT_Python_PLOT_ALL.py

Execute this file to create all the plots of all results of calculations. You can do that even if XTANT-3 is still running, then it will give you transient results. At the end of the simulation run, this command will also be executed automatically.

If the user set ‘gnu’ in the input file to use gnuplot for creation of the plots, OUTPUT_Gnuplot_all.sh will be created, collecting inside all other sh scripts for each individual plot (note that in Windows, the extension of files will be .cmd).

If the 'py' option is set in the input file, OUTPUT_Python_PLOT_ALL.py python script will be created, collecting all other python scripts for plotting.

The following scripts for individual plots are created (for all of them, the extensions may be sh, cmd, or py):

OUTPUT_atoms_distribution_Gnuplot.sh – plots the atomic distribution of kinetic energies, if requested in the input file. Also, Maxwellian distribution function is plotted for comparison.

OUTPUT_atoms_distribution_pot_Gnuplot.sh – plots the atomic distribution of potential energies, if requested in the input file. Also, generalized Maxwellian distribution function is plotted for reference. *Note* that the potential energy distribution *is not* supposed to follow the generalized Maxwellian distribution even in thermal equilibrium (it's plotted only for testing purposes)!

OUTPUT_atoms_distribution_tot_Gnuplot.sh – plots the atomic distribution of their total (kinetic + potential) energies, if requested in the input file (not physically meaningful; it's plotted only for testing purposes).

OUTPUT_atomic_entropy.sh – plots the entropy of atomic (contains nonequilibrium transient entropies, equivalent equilibrium one calculated analytically, and equivalent one calculated numerically which is useful to estimate the quality of the automatically used grid parameters).

OUTPUT_atomic_tempereatures.sh – plots the atomic temperatures according to various definitions, if requested in the input file. See definition of various temperatures in Section VI.5.

OUTPUT_atomic_tempereatures_partial.sh – plots the projections of the kinetic and virial atomic temperatures, if requested in the input file.

OUTPUT_bands_Gnuplot.sh – plots the bottom of the valence band (VB), top of the VB, bottom of the conduction band (CB), and top of the CB, and chemical potential.

OUTPUT_CB_electron_Gnuplot.sh – plots the density of conduction band electrons.

OUTPUT_coupling_parameter_Gnuplot.sh – plots the electron-phonon coupling parameter.

OUTPUT_coupling_parameter_Gnuplot.sh or OUTPUT_coupling.py – plots the electron-phonon coupling parameter.

OUTPUT_coupling_by_element.sh – plots the partial electron-phonon coupling parameter for all elements of the compound pairwise.

OUTPUT_coupling_by_orbital.sh – plots the partial electron-phonon coupling parameter for all orbitals of elements of the compound pairwise.

OUTPUT_Debye_temperatures_Gnuplot.sh – plots the estimated Debye temperature in the material, extracted from the diffraction peaks analysis.

OUTPUT_deep_shell_holes_Gnuplot.sh – plots the density of deep shell holes in each shell of each atom of the compound.

OUTPUT_DOS_Gnuplot.sh – plots the total and orbital-resolved electron DOS as an animated gif, or other video format set in the input file (for python scripts).

OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks_Gnuplot.sh – plots the normalized intensities of the selected diffraction peaks for the user-defined Miller indices.

OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks_[*element*]_Gnuplot.sh – plots the intensities of the selected diffraction peaks for each element in the compound (only if there is more than one) for the user-defined Miller indices; data normalized to the initial *total* (not element specific) diffraction peak intensity.

OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks_DW_Gnuplot.sh – plots the normalized intensities of the selected diffraction peaks within the Debye-Waller approximation for the user-defined Miller indices.

OUTPUT_diffraction_powder_Gnuplot.cmd – plots powder diffraction spectrum (vs. 2 theta) as an animated gif, or other video format set in the input file (for python scripts).

OUTPUT_displacement_[*maskname*]_Gnuplot.sh – plots the (mean atomic displacements)^N with respect to the initial positions for the atomic mask defined by the user (if any, see INPUT.txt definition).

OUTPUT_displacement_[*maskname*]_partial_Gnuplot.sh – plots the (mean atomic displacements)^N with respect to the initial positions partial for all elements in the compound (if there are more than one) for the atomic mask defined by the user (if any, see INPUT.txt definition).

OUTPUT_Egap.sh – plots the band gap (will be near zero for metals).

OUTPUT_electron_Ce.sh – plots the heat capacity of electrons.

OUTPUT_electron_chempotentials.sh – plots band-resolved electron chemical potentials (only if separate thermalization times for VB and CB are used).

OUTPUT_electron_entropy.sh – plots the entropy of electrons (may contain entropies for VB and CV, if separate thermalization times for VB and CB are used).

OUTPUT_electron_distribution_Gnuplot.sh – plots the electron distribution function as an animated gif, or other video format set in the input file (for python scripts). Note that the points are plotted in the position of the current energy levels (molecular orbitals), so the shifts of the points reflect the shifts of the orbitals. In case nonequilibrium distributions are used, such as BO or relaxation-time approximation, also the equivalent Fermi distribution will be plotted for comparison. If separate thermalization times for VB and CB are used, there will be also equivalent distributions for the separately thermalized valence and conduction band.

OUTPUT_electron_distribution_on_grid_Gnuplot.sh – plots the electron distribution function on the user-defined grid (*not* the energy levels) as an animated gif, or other video format set in the input file (for python scripts). The full distribution is plotted (low- and high-energy electrons), multiplied by the DOS; free-electron DOS is assumed for high-density electrons. Thus, this plot is energy-resolved electron density, a.k.a. electron spectrum. It also includes the contributions of the photo-electrons, impact-ionized secondary electrons, and Auger-electrons forming the high-energy electron fractions.

OUTPUT_electrons_and_holes_Gnuplot.sh – plots the high-energy electrons and core holes densities.

OUTPUT_electrons_high_energy.sh – plots the high-energy electrons of different types: total number of them, photo-electrons, Auger-electrons, impact-ionized secondary electrons, and error in the total number of high-energy electrons.

OUTPUT_electron_temperatures.sh – plots band-resolved electron kinetic temperatures (only if separate thermalization times for VB and CB are used).

OUTPUT_energies_Gnuplot.sh – plots the total, potential, and atomic energies.

OUTPUT_energy_levels_Gnuplot.sh – plots the electron energy levels (eigenvalues of the TB Hamiltonian). Mau take a few minutes to plot.

OUTPUT_fragments_Nat.py – plots the numbers of atoms in each fragment (if fragment analysis was specified in the input and the number of fragments is larger than 1). *Note: plotted only for py, not gnu option.*

OUTPUT_fragments_Ne.py – plots the numbers of electrons in each fragment (if fragment analysis was specified in the input and the number of fragments is larger than 1). *Note: plotted only for py, not gnu option.*

OUTPUT_fragments_Ta.py – plots kinetic and fluctuational temperatures of atoms in each fragment (if fragment analysis was specified in the input and the number of fragments is larger than 1). *Note: plotted only for py, not gnu option.*

OUTPUT_fragments_q.py – plots the total charge of each fragment (if fragment analysis was specified in the input and the number of fragments is larger than 1). *Note: plotted only for py, not gnu option.*

OUTPUT_MFP_electron.sh – plots the mean free paths of electron (elastic and inelastic). Only if requested to print MFPs by the user.

OUTPUT_MFP_photon.sh – plots the mean free paths of photon (attenuation length). Only if requested to print MFPs by the user.

OUTPUT_mean_displacement_Gnuplot.sh – plots the (mean atomic displacements)^*N* with respect to the initial positions (default, without atomic masks).

OUTPUT_neighbors_Gnuplot.sh – plots the fractions of the mean nearest neighbors of the atoms.

OUTPUT_neighbors_[*element*]_Gnuplot.sh – plots the element-specific number of nearest neighbors of the atoms of the given element. Only if requested to plot element-specific numbers.

OUTPUT_mu_and_Ne.sh – plots the electron chemical potential and the density of low-energy electrons (populating the valence/conduction band).

OUTPUT_Mulliken_charges_Gnuplot.sh – plots charges of different types of atoms.

OUTPUT_optical_coefficients.sh – plots optical R, T, A for specified probe pulse wavelength.

OUTPUT_optical_n_and_k.sh – plots corresponding real and imaginary parts of the refractive index.

OUTPUT_orbital_resolved_Gnuplot.sh – plots the orbital-resolved electron densities.

OUTPUT_orbital_resolved_fe_Gnuplot.sh – plots the orbital-resolved electron distribution function as an animated gif, or other video format set in the input file (for python scripts).

OUTPUT_pair_correlation_Gnuplot.sh – plots full and element-resolved pair correlation functions as an animated gif, or other video format set in the input file (for python scripts).

OUTPUT_photon_spectrum.sh – plots photon energy spectra (incoming, absorbed; for the *first* laser pulse, also the MC-sampled spectrum).

OUTPUT_pressure_Gnuplot.sh – plots total pressure in the atomic system in the simulation box.

OUTPUT_stress_tensor_Gnuplot.sh – plots components of the atomic pressure tensor.

OUTPUT_temperatures_Gnuplot.sh – plots the electron and atomic temperatures.

OUTPUT_volume_Gnuplot.sh – plots the volume of the supercell and of the sample (defined in Section VI.9).

In case you set a probe-pulse to be included, additional gnuplot files of the convolved data will be created (see below), that will be named exactly the same way with the word 'CONVOLVED' added at the end, e.g. convolved electron heat capacity would be in a file named

OUTPUT_electron_Ce_CONVOLVED.sh

Note that in the case of the Windows operating system, instead of shell scripts the program will create cmd batch files (with the same name, just a different extension: .cmd instead of .sh). They will need a Windows version of Gnuplot installed[41], and proper paths written in the environment variables[42].

7) Output data files

OUTPUT_[*material*]_Electron_EMFP.dat – contains the electron elastic mean free paths in the material. The first column is the electron energy [eV], the other columns are elastic mean free paths [A] for scattering on each element of the target compound, and the last column is the total elastic mean free path. Only created if requested by the user (option Print_MFP in the input file).

OUTPUT_[*material*]_Electron_IMFP.dat – contains the electron inelastic mean free paths in the material. The first column is the electron energy [eV], the other columns are inelastic mean free paths [A] for scattering on each shell of element of the target compound, and the last two columns are the mean free path for scattering on the valence band, and the total one. Only created if requested by the user (option Print_MFP in the input file).

OUTPUT_[*material*]_Photon_IMFP.dat – contains the photon inelastic mean free paths (attenuation length for photon absorption) in the material. The first column is the electron energy [eV], the other columns are attenuation lengths [A] for photon absorption by each shell of element of the target compound, and the last two columns are the lengths for absorption by the valence band, and the total one. Only created if requested by the user (option Print_MFP in the input file).

OUTPUT_atomic_coordinates.xyz – contains the atomic positions at each time-step in [A] (saving time-step specified in the input file, not the numerical time-step used in the MD) in the extended XYZ format. The comment line is used to save the supercell vectors, which can be read by many MD visualization programs, such as OVITO[43]. Some optional atomic properties may also be listed in this file to be read by OVITO[44].

[41] http://www.gnuplot.info/
[42] This, and many other useful things, can be done with help of Cygwin: https://www.cygwin.com/
[43] https://www.ovito.org/windows-downloads/
[44] https://www.ovito.org/manual/reference/file_formats/input/xyz.html

OUTPUT_atomic_velocities.xyz – contains the atomic velocities at each time-step in [A/fs] (saving time-step specified in the input file, not the numerical time-step used in the MD) in the extended XYZ format. The comment line is used to save the supercell vectors.

OUTPUT_atomic_coordinates.cif – contains the atomic positions at each time-step in [A] (saving time-step specified in the input file, not the numerical time-step used in the MD) in the CIF format, which can be used to construct powder diffraction patterns by standard visualization software such as Mercury[45].

OUTPUT_coordinates_and_velosities.dat – contains the relative atomic coordinates and velocities for all atoms at each timestep. The columns are as follows:

1) kind of atom (index in the chemical formula)
2-4) relative coordinates in the supercell
5-7) relative coordinates in the supercell on the previous timestep
8-10) relative velocities of the atom
11-13) relative velocities of the atom on the previous timestep

After all atoms' data for one timestep, there are two empty lines. After that, the next timestep is starting.

This file is used for calculations of atomic velocity autocorrelators and phonon spectra (see below).

OUTPUT_atomic_distribution.dat – contains atomic distribution function of kinetic energies for each timestep separated by the double empty line. The first column is the energy level in [eV], the second column is the distribution function (1/eV), the third column contains equivalent Maxwellian distribution (Maxwellian function for equivalent or kinetic atomic temperature). This file is only created if requested in the input file.

OUTPUT_atomic_distribution_pot.dat – contains atomic distribution function of potential energies for each timestep separated by the double empty line. The first column is the energy level in [eV], the second column is the distribution function (1/eV), the third column contains equivalent Maxwellian distribution (*via* generalized Maxwellian function defined for "*potential*" atomic temperature). This file is only created if requested in the input file.

Note that the generalized Maxwellian distribution is printed out for reference only, the potential energy distribution *is not* expected to follow the Maxwellian distribution even in thermal equilibrium!

OUTPUT_atomic_distribution_tot.dat – contains atomic distribution function by their total (kinetic+ potential) energies for each timestep separated by the double empty line. The first column is the energy level in [eV], the second column is the distribution function (1/eV). This file is only created if requested in the input file.

[45] https://www.ccdc.cam.ac.uk/solutions/software/mercury/

OUTPUT_atomic_entropy.dat – an instantaneous atomic entropy (without time or ensemble averaging, see definition in Section VI.5). Contains the following 4 columns:
1) Time [fs];
2) transient atomic entropy [K/eV];
3) equivalent atomic electronic entropy [K/eV] (corresponding to Maxwell-Boltzmann distribution, i.e. maximal possible entropy for the given particle and energy content, calculated analytically).
4) equivalent atomic electronic entropy [K/eV] (corresponding to Maxwell-Boltzmann distribution, i.e. maximal possible entropy for the given particle and energy content, calculated numerically for the equivalent distribution function).
5) Configurational entropy, defined from the distribution of atoms by their potential energy [K/eV]
6) Total entropy, defined from the distribution of atoms by their total (kinetic + potential) energy [K/eV]

OUTPUT_atomic_temperatures.dat – atomic temperatures calculated according to various definitions. Contains the following columns:

1) Time [fs]
2) Kinetic atomic temperature [K]
3) Kinetic temperature from numerical integration of distribution [K] (may be ignored)
4) Entropic atomic temperature [K]
5) Distributional atomic temperature (kinetic temperature numerically extracted from the equivalent Maxwell-Boltzmann distribution) [K]
6) "Potential" atomic temperature [K], defined from the generalized Maxwell-Boltzmann distribution of the potential energies of atoms (printed for general purposes only, does not coincide with other real temperatures!)
7) Virial temperature [K], associated with the potential energy of atoms (which should obey equipartition theorem in case of thermal equilibrium)
8) Sin^2-configurational temperature [K] (may be ignored)
9) Configurational temperature [K] (running average over 10 MD steps)

See definition of various temperatures in Section VI.5.

This file is only created if options print_Ta used in the input file.

OUTPUT_atomic_temperatures_partial.dat – projections of the kinetic and virial atomic temperatures on X, Y, Z:

1) Time [fs];
2) Kinetic temperature along X [K];
3) Kinetic temperature along Y [K];
4) Kinetic temperature along Z [K];
5) Virial temperature along X [K]
6) Virial temperature along Y [K]
7) Virial temperature along Z [K]

See definition of various temperatures in Section VI.5.

This file is only created if options print_Ta used in the input file.

OUTPUT_Ritchie_CDF_[*material*].cdf – the Ritchie-Howie CDF coefficients used in this material. The file has the format of cdf-file (described above in Section f). The file is only created, if requested by the user with the option 'print_CDF' in the input file. The file contains the following columns:

1) Electronic temperature [K]
2) Electronic heat conductivity [W/(K*m)]
3) Electron-phonon contribution to electronic heat conductivity [W/(K*m)]
4) Electron-electron contribution to electronic heat conductivity [W/(K*m)]
5) Electronic chemical potential [eV]
6) Electronic heat capacity [J/(m^3*K)]

These data are printed out at each timestep; the timestep blocks are separated by two empty lines.

OUTPUT_coupling.dat – electron-ion coupling parameter. Contains the following lines:

1) Time [fs]
2) Total coupling parameter [W/m^{3}K]
3) and further: Partial coupling parameter for each type of pair atoms [*A*]-[*B*] in the compound. For example, for elemental Al targets, there will be one column Al-Al. For compound AlCu, there will be 4 columns: Al-Al, Al-Cu, Cu-Al, and Cu-Cu. Etc.
4) The next columns will be partial coupling for each type of orbital (defined by the basis set) for each kind of atom in the compound. For example, for the sp^{3}d^5 basis set, there will be couplings for the pairs of levels: s-s, s-p, s-d, p-s, p-p, p-d, d-s, d-p, d-d (for each kind of element [*A*]-[*B*] in the compound).

OUTPUT_Debye_temperature_from_DW.dat

The file contains the Debye temperatures estimated from the selected diffraction peaks, if "Diffraction" *and* "DW" keywords are used in the INPUT.txt file. The file contains two comment lines:

a) Values (Time, Miller indices for the diffraction peaks)
b) Their units: [fs] and [K]

After these lines, the data are stored. The file contains the number of columns, defined by the number of diffraction peaks specified by the user. The columns have the following data:

1) Time [fs]
2) All other columns are the Debye temperatures extracted from the intensities of each diffraction peak. The Miller indices of the peaks are specified in the first comment line.

OUTPUT_deep_shell_holes.dat – contains timestep [fs], the number of holes in each shell of each kind of atom in the compound in the next columns (normalized to the number of atoms).

OUTPUT_DOS.dat – contains blocks of data separated by two empty lines. Each block contains a few columns:

1) energy in [eV]

2) total DOS in [states/eV]
3) partial DOS (PDOS) for the first atomic shell of the first element in the compound [states/eV]
4) PDOS for the next shell of the first element, etc.

PDOS corresponding to atomic orbital contributions into DOS will be printed out only if the user set the PDOS parameter to 1 (see input file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS above). The number of columns will depend on the number of elements in the compound and the basis set used. E.g., for one element with a sp^3d^5 basis set, there will be three columns with PDOS, corresponding to s, p, and d PDOS. For N_{elem} elements in the compound and sp^3d^5 basis set, there will be $3xN_{elem}$ columns; for the sp^3 basis set, there will be 2 columns per element: with s and p PDOS, etc.

The file is created only if printing out DOS is set by the user.

OUTPUT_dielectric_function.dat – contains blocks of data separated by two empty lines. Each block contains 16 columns:

1) energy in [eV]
2) the real part of CDF
3) the imaginary part of CDF
4) loss function
5) reflectivity
6) transmission
7) absorption
8) optical n (real part of the refraction coefficient)
9) optical k (imaginary part of the refraction coefficient)
10) dc-conductivity
11) The real part of the (x,x) component of the CDF
12) The imaginary part of the (x,x) component of the CDF
13) The real part of the (y,y) component of the CDF
14) The imaginary part of the (y,y) component of the CDF
15) The real part of the (z,z) component of the CDF
16) The imaginary part of the (z,z) component of the CDF

File created only if printing out the spectrum of optical coefficients is set by the user. From this file, parameters for a chosen photon energy may be extracted in post-processing (see below).

OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks.dat

The file contains the intensities of the selected diffraction peaks, if “Diffraction” keyword is used in the INPUT.txt file. The file contains 4 comment lines:

a) Values (Time, Miller indices for the diffraction peaks)
b) Their units
c) Angles corresponding to each Miller index [deg]
d) q-vectors corresponding to each Miller index [1/A]

After these lines, the data are stored. The file contains the number of columns, defined by the number of diffraction peaks specified by the user. The columns have the following data:

3) Time [fs]
4) All other columns are the normalized intensities for each peak. The Miller indices of the peaks are specified in the first comment line. The intensities are normalized to the initial value of the peak at the first step of the simulation.

OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks_[*element*].dat

The files contain the intensities of the selected diffraction peaks, if "Diffraction" keyword is used in the INPUT.txt file, for each element of the compound (if there is more than one; otherwise, these files are not created). The files have identical structure to the file OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks.dat.

OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks_DW.dat

The file contains the intensities of the selected diffraction peaks calculated within the Debye-Waller harmonic approximation, if "Diffraction" *and* "DW" keywords are used in the INPUT.txt file. The file has exactly the same format as the file OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks.dat described above.

OUTPUT_diffraction_powder.dat

The file contains the block-data with the powder diffraction spectra as a function of two-theta scattering angle (if "Diffraction" keyword is used in the INPUT.txt file).

Each block of data, prefaced with the comment line indicating the time stamp, contains two columns:

1) Two theta angle [deg]
2) Intensity [arb. units]
3) and further columns (if any): [*El*]-[*El*] diffraction spectra contribution from each pair of elements in the compound.

OUTPUT_displacements_[*maskname*].dat

Files containing atomic displacements, defined with the mask option (see INPUT.txt file definition). If atomic masks are used, output files containing the mask names provided will be created, for each mask used. Each such file will contain the number of columns, defined by the number of species in the target compound.

The first two lines are comment lines containing the definition of the columns and units. The following lines are present in the files:

5) Time [fs]
6) (Mean atomic displacement)^N [A^N]: the average of all atoms included in this mask (may be all, or a section of atoms)
7) Columns 3-5: Atomic displacements (in the same power) along X, Y, and Z axes.
8) Next columns: mean and axis-resolved displacements (in the same power) for each element of the compound.

OUTPUT_electron_Ce.dat – electronic heat capacity. Contains the following lines:

1) Time [fs]
2) Total electronic heat capacity [J/m^{3}K]
3) and further: partial electronic heat capacities for each type of orbitals (defined by the basis set) for each kind of atom in the compound.

For example, for the elemental Al target, there will be 3 columns with partial C_e: Al_s, Al_p, and Al_d, corresponding to 3s, 3p, and 3d shells.

OUTPUT_electron_chempotentials.dat – this file is created only if separate valence and conduction band thermalizations are used, and contains the following:

1) Time [fs]
2) Global electronic chemical potential [eV]
3) Valence-band electronic chemical potential [eV]
4) Conduction-band electronic chemical potential [eV]

OUTPUT_electron_entropy.dat – electronic heat capacity. Contains the following 3 columns:
1) Time [fs];
7) transient electronic entropy [K/eV];
8) equivalent equilibrium electronic entropy [K/eV] (corresponding to Fermi-Dirac distribution, i.e. maximal possible entropy for the given particle and energy content).

If separate thermalization times for the valence and conduction bands are used, this file will contain additional data for the partial entropies:
9) transient electronic entropy in the valence band [K/eV]
10) equivalent equilibrium electronic entropy in the valence band [K/eV]
11) transient electronic entropy in the conduction band [K/eV]
12) equivalent equilibrium electronic entropy in the conduction band [K/eV]

OUTPUT_electron_distribution.dat – contains electron distribution function on the current energy levels, for each timestep separated by the double empty line. The first column is the energy level in [eV], and the second column is the distribution function. In case nonequilibrium distributions are used, such as BO or relaxation-time approximation, there is the third column, containing equivalent Fermi distribution (Fermi function for equivalent or kinetic electron temperature and chemical potential).

If separate thermalization times for VB and CB are used, there will be also columns containing equivalent distributions for the separately thermalized valence and conduction band.

If orbital-resolved calculations are requested, there will be more column for distributions resolved over the orbitals: each type of atom of the compound and each orbital momentum used in the basis set. E.g. for Al_2O_3 with the sp^3d^5 basis set, there will be 6 more columns: for s, p and d orbitals of Al, and the same for O.

OUTPUT_electron_distribution_on_grid.dat – contains full electron distribution function (energy-resolved density of electrons of both, low- and high-energy electrons, from Boltzmann and MC fractions) on the user-defined grid (*not* current energy levels), for each timestep separated by the double empty line. The column #1 is the energy grid in [eV]; the column #2 is the electron density in

[1/(V*eV)] (where V is the volume of the supercell). The column #3 is the electron distribution function (the second column divided by the density of states; for MC electrons, the free-electron DOS is assumed with the mass equal to the free-electron mass, whereas for the low-energy electrons, the DOS is counted as the number of energy levels (at the gamma-point) within the given grid interval). The column #4 is the distribution of the photo-electrons among the high-energy fraction of electrons. The column #5 is the impact-ionized secondary electron distribution. The column #6 is the Auger-electron distribution.

OUTPUT_electron_heat_conductivity.dat – contains blocks of data for each timestep, separated by two empty lines; each block is made of 4 columns:

1) Electronic temperature [K]
2) Electronic heat conductivity [W/k/m]
3) Electronic chemical potential [eV]
4) Electronic heat capacity [J/K/m^3]

OUTPUT_electron_hole_numbers.dat – contains the following data:

1) Time [fs]
2) Number of valence band electrons (below E_{Fermi}) [1/atom]
3) Number of conduction band electrons (above E_{Fermi}) [1/atom]
4) Number of high-energy electrons (above E_{cutoff}) [1/atom]
5) Total number of core holes (in all shells summed up) [1/atom]
6) Error in the particle conservation (all electrons - all holes) [1/atom]
7) Number of photons as sampled [1/atom]

OUTPUT_electrons_high_energy.dat – contains the data on high-energy electrons of different types:

1) Time [fs]
2) total number of high-energy electrons [1/atom]
3) photo-electrons [1/atom]
4) Auger-electrons [1/atom]
5) impact-ionized secondary electrons [1/atom]
6) error in the total number of high-energy electrons [1/atom]

OUTPUT_electron_properties.dat – contains the following data:

1) Time [fs]
2) Total number of low-energy electrons (below E_{cutoff}) [1/atom]
3) Chemical potential [eV]
4) Band gap [eV]
5) Electrons heat capacity [J/m^{3}K]
6) Electron-phonon coupling parameter [W/m^{3}K]
7) Bottom of the VB [eV]
8) Top of the VB [eV]
9) Bottom of the CB [eV]
10) Top of the CB [eV]

11) Mulliken charges for all types of atoms in the modeled compound [electron charge]

OUTPUT_electron_temperatures.dat – this file is created only if separate valence and conduction band thermalizations are used, and contains the following:

1) Time [fs]
2) Global electronic kinetic (equivalent) temperature [K]
3) Valence-band electronic kinetic temperature [K]
4) Conduction-band electronic kinetic temperature [K]

OUTPUT_energies.dat – contains the following data:

1) Time [fs]
2) The energy of electrons [eV/atom]
3) The energy of all core holes [eV/atom]
4) The potential energy of atoms [eV/atom]
5) The kinetic energy of atoms [eV/atom]
6) The total energy of atoms [eV/atom]
7) The total energy of atoms and electrons [eV/atom]
8) The total energy in the system (atoms, electrons, holes) [eV/atom] – should be always conserved, except during an FEL pulse
9) Van der Waals energy (if included in the simulation) [eV/atom]
10) Additional short-range repulsion energy (if included) [eV/atom]

OUTPUT_energy_levels.dat – contains all the eigenstates of the Hamiltonian, at each timestep, separated by two empty lines, in [eV].

OUTPUT_fragment_[*ind*].dat – a set of files with the atomic data in each fragment of the target, if fragments analysis was requested in the input file. The index *ind* is an integer number of the fragment of the target, so depending on the maximal number of fragments the target is composed of (or disintegrated into), the number of these files may be different (up to the number of atoms in the simulation box, if the target is completely atomized). The files contain the following data in columns:

1) Time [fs]
2) Number of atoms in this fragment
3) Charge of the fragment [electron charge] (calculated via Mulliken charges on each atom)
4) Kinetic temperature of atoms in this fragment [K]
5) Fluctuational temperature of atoms in this fragment [K]
6) Number of electrons in this fragment (calculated via Mulliken analysis)
7) Energy of electrons in this fragment [eV/atom] (calculated via Mulliken analysis)

OUTPUT_fragments_data.dat – file containing information on each individual fragment (number of atoms and different elements in each fragment) at each timestep, as blocks of self-explanatory data, separated by an empty line and a comment line made of asterisks.

OUTPUT_nearest_neighbors.dat – contains the average numbers of the nearest neighbors. The file has 9 columns:

1) Time [fs]
2) Average number of nearest neighbors
3) Number of atoms with 0 nearest neighbors
4) Number of atoms with 1 nearest neighbor
5) Number of atoms with 2 nearest neighbors
6) Number of atoms with 3 nearest neighbors
7) Number of atoms with 4 nearest neighbors
8) Number of atoms with 5 nearest neighbors
9) Number of atoms with 6 nearest neighbors

OUTPUT_nearest_neighbors_[*element*].dat – contains the average numbers of the element-resolved nearest neighbors, for each specified elements (optional datafile, only printed out if requested). The files for each requested element will contain a number columns, defined by the compound simulated:

1) Time [fs]
2) Total (average) number of nearest neighbors for this element
3) Average number of nearest neighbors of the first element in the compound

All further columns are the numbers of neighbors of further elements in the compound

OUTPUT_optical_coefficients.dat – Optical coefficients for the given probe photon energy, printed in the same format as 16 columns in the file OUTPUT_dielectric_function.dat, except the first column in time in [fs]. The file is created only if the probe pulse is set by the user.

OUTPUT_orbital_resolved_data.dat – Orbital-resolved electronic density and energy (for low-energy electrons). It contains the following data in columns:

1) Time [fs]
2) Total electron density (low-energy electrons) [1/atom]; (for consistency, may be compared with the same parameter from the file OUTPUT_electron_properties.dat above)
3) and further: partial electronic densities on each type of orbitals (defined by the basis set) for each kind of atom in the compound.

For example, for the elemental Al target, there will be 3 columns with partial electron densities: Al_s, Al_p, and Al_d, corresponding to 3s, 3p, and 3d orbitals forming bands.

4) After all electron densities, there will be column with the total energy of the low-energy electrons in [eV/atom].
5) and further: partial electron energy densities on each type of orbitals (defined by the basis set) for each kind of atom in the compound.

OUTPUT_pair_correlation_function.dat – optional file, printed out only if the pair correlation function (PCF) is set to be printed out in an input file. Contains a number of columns defined by the chemical composition of the material:

1) Radius [Å]
2) Total PCF for all pairs of atoms in the simulation box [arb.units]
3) and further columns (if any): [*El*]-[*El*] PCF, pair correlation function between each pair of elements in the compound.

OUTPUT_photon_spectrum.dat – optional file, printed out only if photon spectrum is used with an input file, instead of a given photon energy. Contains:

1) Photon energy [eV]
2) Incoming photon spectrum [arb.units]
3) Absorbed photon spectrum [arb.units]
4) Photon spectrum sampled in MC [arb.units]

Note: in case of multiple pulses used, the name will contain the index of the pulse with the spectrum, e.g., OUTPUT_photon_spectrum_pulse_1.dat etc.

OUTPUT_pressure_and_stress.dat – Contains:

1) Time [fs]
2) Pressure [GPa]
3) 9 columns with the components of the pressure tensor Pressure(a,b), with a=x,y,z and b=x,y,z, all in [GPa]

OUTPUT_supercell.dat – contains the data for the supercell: time, volume [$Å^3$], 9 super-cell vectors [Å], their 9 velocities [Å/fs], and sample volume [$Å^3$] (see its definition in Section VI.9).

OUTPUT_temperatures.dat – contains the following data:

1) Time [fs]
2) Electron temperature [K]

   Note that in case of BO or nonequilibrium simulation, the kinetic (or equivalent; effective; nonequilibrium) electron temperature is printed here: the temperature and chemical potential are defined for the Fermi distribution function that contains the same number of electrons and total energy as in the real simulated system.
3) Kinetic atomic temperature [K]: the first column is the average, then for each element of the compound
4) (Mean atomic displacement)^N [$Å^N$]: the first column is the average, then for each element of the compound

OUTPUT_testmode_data.dat – optional file containing the following data (normally not needed, used for testing):

1) Time [fs]
2) Center of mass velocity (3-vector) [Å/fs]
3) Total moment of inertia tensor (3x3 tensor, so 9 columns)
4) Total force in the supercell (3-vector) [N]

8) ..._CONVOLVED.dat output data files

If in the input file, you set a finite positive duration of the probe pulse, all the data from the output files mentioned above will be additionally convolved with a Gaussian function of a given FWHM. The resulting data will be saved in the new output data files under the same names with the tag 'CONVOLVED' added to them, e.g. temperatures after the convolution will be in the file:

OUTPUT_temperatures_CONVOLVED.dat

These files will be used by gnuplot to prepare convolved figures.

VIII. Post-processing

XTANT-3 package contains a few programs for post-processing of the output files if required. They are stored in the directory !XTANT_ANALYSIS_SUBROUTINES. To compile them, enter this directory and execute the Make.bat file inside (for Linux-based systems, follow the compilation examples given at the top of each file). It will compile all the post-processing subroutines listed below.

The following post-processing is possible:

1) Extracting pair correlation function

If the user did not set to printout the pair correlation function (PCF) in the input files, it can be extracted in the post-processing using the XTANT_atomic_data_analysis.exe, which must be placed into the folder with the output data.

This program requires the following output data to be present:

'OUTPUT_coordinates_and_velosities.dat'

'OUTPUT_supercell.dat'

'OUTPUT_energies.dat'

'OUTPUT_temperatures.dat'

And can be run as follows: XTANT_atomic_data_analysis.exe in the command line. It will construct and print out the pair correlation function at each time instant. It creates the output file OUTPUT_PCF.dat, where the PCF is saved in the same format as OUTPUT_pair_correlation_function.dat described above.

Note, however, that PCF can easily be obtained by standard molecular dynamics visualization software, such as VMD[46], OVITO[47], etc.

There is additional post-processing python script XTANT_PCF_plot.py for creating pictures (instead of videos) of the PCF at desired time stamps.

[46] https://www.ks.uiuc.edu/Research/vmd/
[47] https://www.ovito.org/

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

2) Calculation of velocity autocorrelation and phonon spectrum

If the data are printed out in the legacy format: file OUTPUT_coordinates_and_velosities.dat

A program for calculation of atomic velocity autocorrelation functions and phonon spectra from these data XTANT_autocorrelators.exe must be placed into the folder with the output data. To execute, simply run XTANT_autocorrelators.exe in the command line. The program will ask the user to input two parameters: alpha and time step. Alpha is the exponential factor suppressing correlation at long times *exp*(-alpha*t). The time step *tim_step* sets how often to print out autocorrelators and phonon spectra: it will divide the data into *tim_step* steps, and calculate data on them. E.g. if you had a simulation run from 0 to 1000 fs, and set *tim_step*=10, it will print 10 files, at every 200 fs.

The program will create a set of files

OUT_VAF_[*time*].dat

OUT_vibrational_spectrum_[*time*].dat

Where [*time*] is a timestamp at which the velocity autocorrelation function (VAF) and phonon spectrum are calculated. The program uses Fourier transform to get the spectrum from VAF [2].

The files OUT_VAF_[*time*].dat contain two columns:

1) Time [fs]
2) VAF [arb. units]

The files OUT_vibrational_spectrum_[*time*].dat contain two columns:

1) Phonon frequency [THz]
2) Phonon spectrum [arb. units]

3) Calculation of phonon spectrum and atomic heat capacity

If the velocities are printed out in XYZ format (new): file OUTPUT_atomic_velocities.xyz

For processing these data, the python script XTANT_Get_Phonon_Spectrum.py exists. Read its docstring for details. It allows for two damping functions, exponential or gaussian. Everything else is similar to the case above.

Additionally, it uses the calculated phonon spectrum to get the atomic heat capacity, see Section VI.12. The data are saved in the files:

OUT_vacf_windows.dat containing the velocity autocorrelation function for given time intervales.

OUT_phonon_spectra.dat containing the phonon spectrum for given time intervales.

OUT_heat_capacity.dat containing the atomic molar heat capacity for given time intervales.

And the corresponding plots are saved as:

OUT_phonon_spectra.png and OUT_phonon_heat_capacity.png.

4) Calculation of thermal MSD, Debye temperature, diffraction intensities

The script XTANT_diffraction_analysis.py uses the file OUTPUT_atomic_coordinates.xyz with the atomic coordinates in the extended XYZ format to evaluate the classical Debye temperature (Section VI.13), the thermal mean displacements (compared with the MSD with respect to the initial positions), and uses them to evaluate the diffraction intensities with respect to the original and thermal positions within the Debye-Waller (DW) model.

The various definitions of time-averaged MSDs are printed out on the screen.

If there is the file INPUT_atomic_data.dat present in the same directory, the script will also calculate the Debye-Waller (DW) diffraction intensities. For the DW calculations, the temperature is required, which is evaluated from the kinetic energies of atoms that must be saved in the extended XYZ format.

For full diffraction intensities calculations, it requires the file Atomic_form_factors.dat to be present in the same directory.

Note that the script requires the Miller indices and the number of unit-cells from which the supercell is constructed to be added manually before execution.

The output of this script is:

OUT_MSD_analysis.dat file with the various definitions of MSDs, as described in the comment line.

OUT_Debye_temperature.dat contains the Debye temperatures calculated from the thermal MSD and from the MSD with respect to the origin.

OUT_DW_origin_peak_intensities.dat contains the diffraction intensities for the given Miller indices calculated with the DW approximation using the MSD with respect to the origin.

OUT_DW_thermal_peak_intensities.dat contains the diffraction intensities for the given Miller indices calculated with the DW approximation using the thermal MSD.

OUT_full_peak_intensities.dat contains the calculated full diffraction intensities for the given Miller indices, with raw intensities printed out.

OUT_full_peak_intensities_normalized.dat the calculated full diffraction intensities for the given Miller indices, with intensities normalized to the origin (initial one, first simulation time step).

The results are plotted, correspondingly, as:

OUT_MSDs.png, OUT_Debye_temperature.png, OUT_DW_origin_peak_intensities.png, and OUT_DW_thermal_peak_intensities.png, OUT_full_peak_intensities_raw.png, and OUT_full_peak_intensities_normalized.png.

5) Calculation of electron-ion coupling parameter $g(T_e)$, $C_e(T_e)$, $\mu(T_e)$, $P_e(T_e)$

To calculate the electron-ion coupling parameter as a function of electron temperature $g(T_e)$, electronic heat capacity $C_e(T_e)$, chemical potential $\mu(T_e)$, and electronic pressure $P_e(T_e)$, the following procedure can be used [3]:

It requires several output directories to be present with slightly different simulation parameters.

- They can be automatically set in the INPUT_DATA.txt (or INPUT.txt) input file using the optional command "*Coupling*" (see the end of Section VI.1).

Alternatively, they can be set manually, following the procedure described below:

b. Set a simulation run with the fluence of ~3-5 eV/atom, duration of ~10-30 fs, and low photon energy of ~10 eV, the position of the maximum at 0 fs, and the starting time ~ -300 – -400 fs.
c. Use a small timestep (both, for MD and for printing out) during the pulse. For that, it is convenient to use a file input with the specified time grid (see description of Line 10 in Section VI.2), in which a relatively large time step may be used for the equilibration phase before the pulse arrival (e.g., 1 fs up to -20 fs, and 0.1 fs after -20 fs).
d. Create multiple simulations by either specifying in the INPUT_DATA.txt file the additional option "Coupling" (with a number of simulations recommended 5-10 or more; see for details at the end of Section VI.1), or by manually creating a few additional input files with incrementally increasing numbers to run a few simulations in a sequence (see above how to do that, Section VI.3). In each of these files, vary slightly the parameters of the first pulse, e.g., choose different fluences between 3 and 5 eV/atom, chose different pulse durations between 10-30 fs, initial electronic temperature between 100 and 300 K, and slightly different arrival times of the second pulse between -300 fs to -500 fs. This will randomize the parameters and exclude artificial correlation effects [3]. Recommended number of thusly-created simulation runs: 10 or more.

- Run XTANT-3 to create a few (e.g., 10 or more) output folders with slightly different parameters as said above. Place all output folders into a separate directory, and place the file XTANT_coupling_parameter.exe in the same directory.
- Execute it as follows: XTANT_coupling_parameter.exe alpha max_Te

The two optional parameters alpha and max_Te , and if used, must be set in this fixed order.

alpha : an optional argument meaning the time [fs] from which to start averaging the coupling parameter (used to exclude early times where atoms are not equilibrated yet). If this parameter is absent, the default value is used, which is: t_0-2*FWHM (where t_0 is the pulse center, and FWHM is its widths, read from the file INPUT_DATA.txt (or INPUT.txt)).

max_Te : an optional parameter, specifying the maximal electronic temperature for grid to span the dependence on the electronic temperature (if not specified, the default value of 25000 K is used).

For example, set alpha=-100 fs and T_e=50000 K, i.e. run XTANT_coupling_parameter.exe -100 50000, which will exclude earlier times during which the system was still equilibrating, and create output files with the electronic temperature grid up to 50000 K (note that it is meaningless to set the electronic temperature higher than those achieved in the calculations, defined by the absorbed dose set in the input file).

This program will scan through all the output folders (note that no other folders or files in this directory should start with the word 'OUTPUT', as the program will use them and crush), and use files OUTPUT_electron_properties.dat, OUTPUT_temperatures.dat, OUTPUT_coupling.dat (if exists) and OUTPUT_pressure_and_stress.dat to extract g, C_e, μ and Gruneisen parameter as functions of time, then sort them according to the electronic temperatures (T_e) at those time, interpolate on a grid of T_e, the average overall 10 (or more) simulation runs, and printout averaged values into the following files:

OUT_average_coupling.dat

Which contains 3 columns:

1) Electron temperature [K]
2) Total coupling parameter [W/(m^{3}K)]
3) The standard deviation of the coupling parameter (error bars)

OUT_average_parameters.dat

Which contains 4 columns:

1) Electron temperature [K]
2) Chemical potential [eV]
3) Electron heat capacity [J/(m^{3}K)]
4) The standard deviation of the electron heat capacity (error bars)

OUT_average_partial_couplings.dat

Which contains several columns corresponding to the number of partial couplings for each pair of elements and shells (according to the file OUTPUT_coupling.dat in the same format).

OUT_average_partial_Ce.dat

Which contains several columns corresponding to the number of partial electronic heat capacities for each shell of each element (according to the file OUTPUT_electron_Ce.dat in the same format).

OUT_average_pressure.dat

Which contains 4 columns:

1) Electronic temperature Te in [K]
2) Electron energy in [eV/atom]
3) Pressure in [GPa]
4) Electronic Gruneisen parameter, defined as dP/dE in [Pa/(J/atom)]

Note that an alternative definition of the electronic Gruneisen parameter is P/E (instead of derivative) [148], which can be calculated from columns 2 and 3 in this file. In this case, it is important to subtract the room temperature value from the pressure (since it is rarely exactly zero in the simulation). This definition is useful since the definition based on the derivative often produces too noisy results.

For convenience, it also creates the file collecting the partial electronic heat capacity and electron-ion coupling named

OUT_XTANT3_Cd_partial_Ce_G.dat

Which contains a few columns (depending on the TB basis set, and number of orbitals):

1) Electronic temperature Te in [K]
2) Total electron heat capacity in [J/m^{3}K]

The number of next columns depends on the number of orbitals in TB: for each s, p, and d orbital used, there will be a column with partial electron heat capacity.

Then comes the column with the total electron-ion coupling parameter, rescaled back to normal according to the parameter set in the file NUMERICAL_PARAMETERS.txt. After that, partial couplings for each pair of orbitals are present, where paired orbitals are added together (and rescaled by the same factor as the total one). For example, for the sp^{3}d^5 basis, there will be 6 columns, corresponding to the partial couplings of: s-s, s-p, s-d, p-p, p-d, d-d orbitals. For the calculation of s-p

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

orbital coupling, the two columns from the file OUT_average_partial_couplings.dat (above) are summed: s-p and p-s.

Additionally, two gnuplot scripts are created that use data from the last file:

OUT_gnuplot_Ce.cmd and OUT_gnuplot_G.cmd, which are executed to create the figures

OUT_XTANT3_Cd_partial_Ce.gif and OUT_XTANT3_Cd_partial_G.gif with the calculated partial electron heat capacity and electron-ion coupling.

6) Extracting optical parameters for given wavelength from the spectrum

If you run XTANT-3 simulation with printing out the optical spectrum, you can extract optical parameters as a function of time for any photon energy (wavelength) within the spectrum interval, for *s* and *p* polarizations, and given angle of probe incidence and substrate. It uses the RPA approximation for the calculations of the CDF, see Section VI.16.

To run, place the program XTANT_dielectric_function_analysis.exe into the output folder with the results which must contain the file OUTPUT_dielectric_function.dat, and simply call it as: XTANT_dielectric_function_analysis.exe *hw*, where *hw* is the probe photon energy in [eV].

It also requires the following additional input file to be present: OPTICAL_PARAMETERS.dat (place it manually into the same directory with the output data).

```
1   50.0d0      ! thickness [nm]
2   90.0d0      ! with respect to surface [deg]
3   1.0d0   0.0d0           ! n and k of the material above the target
4   3.6941d0    0.0065435d0 ! n and k of the material below the target
```

Figure VIII.1 Example of the input file for optical parameters extraction.

The lines in this file must be as follows:

1) The thickness of the target in [nm]
2) Probe incidence angle with respect to the surface [degree]
3) Optical *n* and *k* of the material above the target (typically, air)
4) Optical *n* and *k* of the substrate (substrate material below the target, may also be air)

The program will create 2 output files:

1) OUTPUT_dielectric_function_[*hw*].dat with the same format as the file OUTPUT_optical_coefficients.dat described above (just by interpolating the data from the file with the dielectric function printed out). The columns are marked in the first line of the file, as follows: time hw Re_eps Im_eps LF R T A n k. The optical coefficients are calculated for s-polarization only. *Note that it might not work well, and the file may contain just zeros!*
2) OUTPUT_dielectric_function_[*hw*]_RTA.dat with recalculated optical parameters taking into account properties of materials above and below the target, following the formalism described in [117]. The columns are marked in the first line of the file, as follows:

1. time [fs]

2. R_s – the first ray reflection for s-polarization
3. T_s – the first ray transmission for s-polarization
4. A_s – the first ray absorption for s-polarization
5. R_p – the first ray reflection for p-polarization
6. T_p – the first ray transmission for p-polarization
7. A_p – the first ray absorption for p-polarization
8. R_s_all – coherently summed all rays' reflection for s-polarization
9. T_s_all – coherently summed all rays transmission for s-polarization
10. A_s_all – coherently summed all rays absorption for s-polarization
11. R_p_all – coherently summed all rays' reflection for p-polarization
12. T_p_all – coherently summed all rays transmission for p-polarization
13. A_p_all – coherently summed all rays absorption for p-polarization

7) Spectrum of ablation fragments and displacements

If you run a simulation with open boundaries (thin layer, nanoparticle, etc.), you can construct a mass spectrum of ablated fragments. Also, you can calculate displacements of atoms, using sections with the mask, the same way as described in the INPUT.txt file (see above).

For that, place the program XTANT_fragmentation.exe and the database INPUT_atomic_data.dat (present in the directory !XTANT_ANALYSIS_SUBROUTINES) into the output folder with the results which must contain the file OUTPUT_atomic_coordinates.xyz.

If the file Atomic_masks.txt is placed there too, defining the atomic masks in the same format as described in Section VI.1.

Call the program as: XTANT_fragmentation.exe *r dt*.

Here *r* set the cut-off radius in [Å] (above which atoms are considered to be separated and belong to a different fragment), and the printout time step *dt* in [fs] (which sets how often the mass spectrum should be printed out; it does not have to coincide with the timestep used in the simulation, but cannot be smaller than that).

Execution of this utility creates the output files:

OUT_fragments_spectrum.dat containing the following columns (first line set the time instants for each column, starting from #2):

Column 1: mass of the fragments in [a.m.u.]

Column 2 and others: number of fragments with the mass, set in column 1, at the time instant, set in the first line.

And OUT_m_over_z_spectrum.dat (only if the file OUTPUT_atomic_coordinates.xyz contains atomic Mulliken charges) containing the following columns (first line set the time instants for each column, starting from #2):

Column 1: mass over charge ratio of the fragments in [a.m.u./electron charge]

Column 2 and others: weighted number of fragments with the m/z, set in column 1, at the time instant, set in the first line (see more information on weights in Section VI.14).

It also creates Gnuplot scripts OUT_fragments.cmd (or OUT_fragments.sh) and OUT_m_over_z.cmd (or OUT_m_over_z.cmd), which plot the color-map plot of the mass spectrum vs. time in the file OUT_fragments.png using the data from the created file OUT_fragments_spectrum.dat, and mass spectrum in m/z vs. time in the file OUT_m_over_z.png using the data from the created file OUT_m_over_z_spectrum.dat.

If atomic masks were specified in the file, the program will create output files with the displacements for each mask specified: OUT_displacements_[*maskname*].dat. If no masks provided, the default (with the name mask_1) is used, calculating the mean displacements for all atoms (mask option 'all'). The first two lines are comment lines containing the definition of the columns and units. The following lines are present in the files:

1) Time [fs]
2) (Mean atomic displacement)^N [A^N]: the average of all atoms included in this mask (may be all, or a section of atoms)
3) Columns 3-5: Atomic displacements (in the same power) along X, Y, and Z axes.
4) Next columns: mean and axis-resolved displacements (in the same power) for each element of the compound.

Additionally, gnuplot scripts and figures are created, named OUT_displacements_[*maskname*]_Gnuplot.cmd, and OUT_mean_displacement_[*maskname*].jpg.

8) Calculation of electron entropy

Although versions of XTANT-3 after 10.02.2023 produce output files with electronic entropy during simulation runs, legacy results may be analyzed with this post-processing utility. If the electronic distribution is printed out (file OUTPUT_electron_distribution.dat), electronic entropy can be calculated. For that, place the compiled post-processing file XTANT_entropy.exe in the folder with the output data, and execute this program. It does not require any additional input. It will create an output file with the electronic entropy OUT_entropy.dat containing three columns:

Column 1: time [fs]

Column 2: electron entropy [K/eV] for the transient distribution function read from the same file

Column 3: equilibrium (equivalent) electron entropy [K/eV] for the Fermi-Dirac distribution function (with the same particle and energy content as the transient one) read from the same file.

Since equilibrium distribution maximizes entropy, a comparison between these two functions demonstrates how far from equilibrium the transient electron distribution is.

The utility also creates and executes gnuplot script OUT_entropy.cmd, which creates a plot OUT_entropy.png with the two functions.

9) Analysis of electron distribution

If the distribution function on electronic energy levels (OUTPUT_electron_distribution.dat) or distribution on the grid was printed out (containing both, low-energy and high-energy electrons; file OUTPUT_electron_distribution_on_grid.dat), further analysis of those distributions is possible:

e. Both distributions can be averaged over time with a given temporal profile (mimicking, e.g., photo- or Auger-emission from the chosen deep-shell holes)

f. The distribution on the grid can be additionally smoothened via convolution with a Gaussian function of a given width in energy space (mimicking the spectral function of a measuring detector)

If one of these files is not present, the analysis will automatically run only for the present file.

The file XTANT_el_distribution_analysis.f90 should be compiled into the post-processing subroutine XTANT_el_distribution_analysis.exe. This subroutine should be placed in the folder with the output data, and executed. To execute, it requires the input file called EL_DISTR.txt to be placed in the same directory. This file must contain three lines with the following parameters:

Line 1: Energy width in [eV]. Set a negative number to exclude convolution in the energy space, if not needed.

Line 2: File name, providing the data on the widths in time to average the distribution with; and the index of the column to use in this file. Set a non-existing file name to exclude averaging in time, if not needed.

Line 3: Cut off for the distribution, below which the distribution is not printed (to exclude too small value, making it easier to print in log-scale, and making the output files smaller)

The results are printed in the 3 files for the distribution on the energy levels (and 3 corresponding Gnuplot scripts, which create 2 png-figure and one animated gif), and 2 output files for distribution on the grid (and 4 Gnuplot scripts to create plots from these files):

a) OUT_fe_average.dat – containing the averaged distribution on the energy levels. The first column is the averaged energy levels in [eV], second is the distribution function. Its corresponding Gnuplot script is OUT_fe_average.cmd (or .sh in Linux) and its plot is in OUT_fe_average.png.

b) OUT_fe_gridded.dat – containing the distribution put on the grid with the step defined by the user here. The first column is the energy grid in [eV], and the second column is the distribution function on this grid. Its corresponding Gnuplot script is OUT_fe_gridded.cmd (or .sh in Linux), and the plot is OUT_fe_gridded.gif.

c) OUT_fe_gridded_average.dat – containing the averaged distribution on the defined here energy grid. The first column is the grid in [eV], second is the averaged distribution function. Its corresponding Gnuplot script is OUT_fe_gridded_average.cmd (or .sh in Linux) and its plot is in OUT_fe_gridded_average.png.

d) OUT_el_distr_vs_time.dat – containing the processed electronic spectra (second column) and distribution function (third column), both convolved in energy space, if requested. In the same format as in the original file OUTPUT_electron_distribution_on_grid.dat. If no convolutions are required (line 1 in EL_DISTR.txt contains a negative number), this file is not created.

Their corresponding gnuplot scripts are: OUT_el_distr_vs_time.cmd (or .sh in Linux), executed automatically to create an animated gif plot of the evolution of the convolved electronic spectrum from the file. The second file is OUT_el_distr_vs_time_norm.cmd executed automatically to create an animated gif plot of the evolution of the convolved distribution function from the file

e) OUT_el_distr_average.dat – containing the electronic spectrum (second column) and the distribution function (third column) averaged over time with the provided weights. If no weights were provided in a file, all weights are assumed to be =1, and the function is just averaged over time.

Their corresponding gnuplot scripts are: OUT_el_distr_average.cmd (or .sh in Linux), which creates a png-plot of the time-averaged spectrum from the file; and OUT_el_distr_average_norm.cmd (or .sh in Linux), which creates a png-plot of the time-averaged distribution from the file.

Note #1: files with "fe" (constructed from the distribution on the electron levels) are best for the analysis of low-energy electrons, while high-energy electrons are missing in them. Files with "distr" (constructed from the distribution on the grid) are best for analysis of high-energy electrons, whereas low-energy electrons may need more detailed analysis than the one used in XTANT-3 calculations – the parameters of the grid may need to be changed, etc.

For example, if we want to construct the spectrum of photons emitted by the decay of L-shell holes in simulated aluminum, and measured with the detector with the spectral width of 1.5 eV, we set the following in the file:

```
1.5  0.5      ! [eV] Energy convolution parameter; [eV] energy grid for f_e
OUTPUT_deep_shell_holes.dat    5
1.0e-8        ! distribution cutoff
```

We chose this file with the core holes, and set column #5 in it, containing the data on the number of L3-shell holes. This way, the resulting output is the electronic distribution averaged with the weights, corresponding to the transient number of L-shell holes, mimicking the spectrum of photons emitted in radiative decays of these holes. The resulting distribution is convolved with a Gaussian function with a width of 1.5 eV, mimicking the detector resolution. An analogous procedure was used, e.g., in Ref.[30].

Similarly, a spectrum of emitted electrons by a probe pulse can be constructed, by setting up a file with the profile of the probe pulse (e.g., gaussian, centered at a given delay time).

10) Averaging diffraction peaks

For small simulation box sizes, the diffraction peaks intensities may fluctuate strongly. The data may need to be averaged over a number of simulations with identical irradiation conditions but different initial atomic velocities.

For averaging of the diffraction peaks, use the post-analysis utility: XTANT_average_diffraction.exe. Place it in the directory with a set of directories with output data. Several directories with output data *must* have exactly the same output format (the same diffraction peaks printed out in XTANT-3 simulations). Identical output data files with different sampled initial atomic velocities (and possibly different starting times, for thermalization of the atomic system) can be created by means of the input file Copy_input.txt (see Section VI.3.2). To simply copy the INPUT files, without altering anything inside, use "copy" command inside of Copy_input.txt, see an example of creation of 5 identical runs in Figure 2 (1 original input + 4 copies).

https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2307.03953

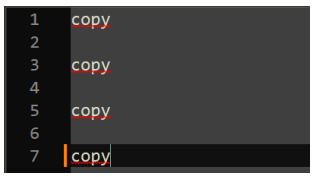


Figure 2. Example of Copy_input.txt file producing 5 identical simulation runs (with different initial atomic velocities).

Executing XTANT_average_diffraction.exe in the directory with several directories with output files will produce the output data file OUT_diffraction_peaks.dat, containing the diffraction peaks intensities in the same format as the output file OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks.dat. It will also create a gnuplot shell script OUT_diffraction_peaks.cmd, and execute it to create the plot with diffraction peaks intensities OUT_diffraction_peaks.png.

11) Comparing diffraction peaks from Miller indices and powder diffraction

Python script XTANT_diffraction_peak_comparison.py identifies the peaks in the powder diffraction data (file OUTPUT_diffraction_powder.dat), within the given window around on the exact positions from the given Miller indices, and plots their time evolution against the peaks calculated for the given Miller indices (file OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks.dat) and plots their intensities and positions.

The output is printed out as figures diffraction_intensity_comparison.png and diffraction_peak_positions.png.

Additionally, there are scripts for extracting the area under the powder diffraction peaks stored in the subfolder XTANT_diffraction_peaks_widths_analysis:

a) XTANT_diffraction_peak_fit.py – the script uses peak positions defined by the selected Miller indices to identify the peaks in the powder diffraction, then fits the corresponding peaks with the pseudo-Voigt peaks, and integrates them to get the area under the peaks. Produces the output file OUTPUT_diffraction_powder_fit_results.csv.
b) XTANT_diffraction_peak_autodetect_fit.py – the script searches automatically peak positions in the powder diffraction, then fits the identified peaks with the pseudo-Voigt peaks, and integrates them to get the area under the peaks. Produces the output file OUTPUT_diffraction_powder_fit_automatic.csv.
c) XTANT_plotting_fitting_results.py – the script to plot and make a video from the data in OUTPUT_diffraction_powder_fit_results.csv and the raw data from OUTPUT_diffraction_powder.dat. The results are the plot peak_integrated_areas_vs_time.png showing the evolution of the absolute peak areas, and peak_normalized_areas_vs_time.png showing time evolution of the normalize peak areas; the video file with powder diffraction data and fitted peaks is called peak_evolution_with_raw.mp4.
d) XTANT_plotting_fitting_autodetected_results.py – the script to plot and make a video from the data in OUTPUT_diffraction_powder_fit_automatic.csv and the raw data from OUTPUT_diffraction_powder.dat. The results are the plot peak_integrated_areas_vs_time_auto.png showing the evolution of the absolute peak areas, and peak_normalized_areas_vs_time_auto.png showing time evolution of the normalize peak areas;

the video file with powder diffraction data and fitted peaks is called peak_evolution_with_raw_auto.mp4.

The scripts must be placed into the directory with out files, containing the files OUTPUT_diffraction_peaks.dat and OUTPUT_diffraction_powder.dat

IX. Known problems

1) XTANT-3 stops working without any message

If the calculations are terminated without any message on the screen or in the Error-log file, the reason may be memory overload. This problem is known to take place especially in calculations of the electron hear conductivity, or optical coefficients, which require a lot of memory, especially in case of a large number of OpenMP threads.

Possible solutions: reducing the number of threads, increasing the allocated memory, or decreasing the number of k-points for kappa calculations.

If it stops running for multiple OpenMP threads, but works for a single thread, it may also be caused by per-thread stack exhaustion. To remedy it, set the local variable OMP_STACKSIZE to a larger than default value, e.g.:

set OMP_STACKSIZE=16M

(Execute this command in cmd in Windows before executing XTANT.exe in the same window)

Alternative solution is to compile the code with /heap-arrays option. It will slow down the execution but may work with larger arrays and thus larger number of atoms.

2) Poor energy conservation in NPH simulation

Poor energy (enthalpy) conservation may be especially pronounced in case of NPH simulation, where the simulation box vectors are allowed to evolve in time, is known to take place at high deposited doses, where material may undergo fast phase transition and even ablation.

Possible solution: decrease the MD timestep (may require a timestep smaller than 0.01 fs, depending on the dose and processes taking place).

Note #1: Before the update 25.04.2024, there were possible artificial rotations of the supercell (associated with poor energy conservation and occasional divergence and simulation collapse); solution to that is to use a version of XTANT-3 update 25.04.2024 or later, in which the bug in NPH simulation was corrected.

Note #2: Combining NPH simulation with the electron-ion coupling may result in poor energy conservation (presumably, due to velocity scaling used to deliver energy from electrons to atoms).

Currently, there is no solution to this problem, and the energy drift may have to be compensated with a thermostat.

3) Atoms accelerated to “infinity”

At high doses, the situation may occur in which atoms are suddenly accelerated to extremely high velocities, energy and temperature may jump to numerical infinities. This may be a result of an instability, due to a problem with short-range forces. Tight binding parameters are often only fitted around the crystal equilibrium atomic positions, whereas atoms coming too close may overcome the potential barrier and reach the region which is not well fitted, and the atomic potential may even decrease suddenly to large negative values (e.g., this problem is known to appear in NRL and Pettifor’s parameterizations).

Possible solutions: One of the reasons for it may be wrong starting atomic configuration, make sure there are no atoms located too close in your setting initial conditions. If the problem occurs during irradiation simulation while the dose is not too high, it may suffice to reduce the timestep, so that the atoms would not artificially “tunnel” through the barrier to too close distances with a problematic potential. If the doses are sufficient for atoms to overcome the barrier physically (not merely numerically), to block the atoms coming too close, it requires to include/create an additional short-range repulsive potential (see details on how to include additional classical repulsive potentials in XTANT-3 in Section VI.4.e).

4) Segmentation fault in multiple simulation runs as the first run of new material (in linux)

If you set multiple simulation runs (e.g., for multiple fluences, coupling, etc.) at the very first simulation run of a new material (when all the electron mean free paths (MFPs) need to be calculated the first time), only one simulation run may work, whereas the second simulation may fail with the error message of the segmentation fault (on linux).

Possible solution: to avoid it, prior to multiple runs, execute the first single run to create the files with MFPs. Once the files are stored in the INPUT/[material] directory, the segmentation fault at multiple runs should disappear.

Note that if running the code on a cluster node, the INPUT data must be copied back from the node to the server, so that the MFPs are stored.

X. References

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